ACHIEVE GREATNESS

MINDSET



BOOK 3

Achieve Greatness
(Book 3: Mindset)

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This book is dedicated to you, who opened these pages because you wanted to take the step to achieve your best.

An Introduction From Your Coach

This book is the **third** and final chapter in the Achieve Greatness Training series books.

In earlier books, we have covered nutrition, fitness, and formed the beginnings of a positive mindset.

This book takes that all to the **next level.**

For those that want to delve deeper into improving their positive mindsets, the book details all I learned as a **life coach.**

I have life coached an extensive number of clients through **various** life issues, starting my work in a charity music studio for disadvantaged youths, and moving on to

coaching many people online through various life issues.

You can use the second half of the book to gain knowledge and to help yourself, or to help others through the **common** issues faced in areas of self improvement.

It contains the life coaching **advice** I used to help work clients through issues, and acts as a short, quick and simple to read **encyclopedia** of all the most common life issues that you usually find when trying to help people with their mindsets.

Whether you want to learn how to **coach** in a fitness context or simply want to learn principles to **train** or **lead** in general, the first part of this book has you covered. If you just want to make use of the encyclopedia in the second half of this book, to find **advice and**

solutions for common mentality issues, this book is the perfect solution for you.

I welcome you to the book, and hope you use it to achieve your ultimate best, sending you positive vibes. Welcome once again to another installment of Achieve Greatness.

- Coach Tommy

Chapter 1: How To Achieve Greatness In Your Mindset

How To Upgrade Your Life In Under 2 Weeks

The **first thing** I do when I take on a new client is give them a quick training session, boost their confidence, and find out the level they are at in terms of their fitness and mentality.

After the first session, I draft out some short term goals for them and, most importantly – get them to form a basic **habit tracker**.

This can literally **upgrade your life** in 2 weeks. And it's actually very basic. You wouldn't think it would be so easy to improve your life and mental health in only 2 weeks, but it is.

The **concept is simple**, we draft out a few simple habits that are going to be part of our self improvement routine.

I have found that a habit tracker should be **simple**. Once we start to fill them with more than 5 habits, my clients don't stick to them as much.

They also don't improve your life if you fill them with meaningless habits. I have experimented a lot over the years, and I am going to give you my **non-negotiable** habits that actually make a difference. That **you** can

actually stick to. These actually work and make your day better.

I know for a fact these will **change your life** if you stick to them daily.

There are **extra habits and techniques** in later chapters that you try to work into your day but these are the bare minimum I want you to stick to. These are the **bare minimum** that you can do in a day to give yourself the time for your own mental health that you need.

Exercise 1: Self Improvement Habit Tracker

Take a look at the table below.

Habits List	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
Journalling							
Meditation							
Reading							
Exercise							

This **habit tracker** is to hold you accountable in a way that is great for your mental health.

You may be asking yourself, but all of this seems like too much to stick to consistently?

Here's the catch, and this is the **true magic** of this system, you DO NOT have to do any of these things for **hours** to tick them off. Or even minutes.

You know those complicated routines that make you feel overwhelmed and like too much is going on in your head? This is actually the opposite of that.

The rules are simple, if you do even the **minimum** for any of these, you get to tick it off. Even **10 seconds** of meditation or a page of a book.

It is **scientifically proven** that we find it more effective to build habits not based on how long we do them for. But based on how often we do them.

Our brain finds it easier and we are more likely to build a habit if we do it daily for short periods of time to begin with.

Then we can do it **longer** if we wish. But doing a habit for longer is optional based on the time you have and how you **feel.**

The point is to make it **easy** for ourselves and make it so easy to allow ourselves to do the bare minimum so that we always carve out that little bit of time every day for ourselves and for our mentality.

This technique sets you up to win by achieving *small wins* and holding yourself accountable to doing the **bare minimum** each day.

It’s not about overwhelming yourself, and doing hours of each habit, it's just about setting a realistic routine you can actually stick to.

The four non negotiable habits are:

Gratitude Journalling - Physically Write 3 Things You Are Grateful For In A Journal. Even if it's 3 short things, you can still tick the box. Write them physically because it feels healthier than using the phone.

Meditation - Close your eyes, breathe in for 4 seconds, and breath out for 7 seconds. Think positive thoughts and how grateful you are for each breath. Even if you do one repetition of this you can tick the box.

For example, lets say once per day every day, you just take the time others don't to close your eyes and breathe deeply in a relaxed manner.

You spend a couple of seconds each day bringing your thoughts away from the busy hectic day, into a relaxed state, focusing on no immediate issue or stress, just your breath, **reducing** your stress levels.

Other people let stress distract them, they live in it, they never switch off, not even for a second, they have no **sense of relaxation.**

By building the habit to calm yourself down once a day, that is still **one more time per** day that you de-stress yourself more than others.

It's something I can't explain until you consistently do this and become this type of person.

But when you see everyone else running around with so much **anxiety** at work, acting as if everything is the end of the world, and you just sit there in a state of peace, because you chill yourself out often, you realise how great this habit is to do for yourself.

The person who does this habit once a day is still going to be a way more relaxed person than a person who **never** takes the time to chill themselves out.

Once you build some days of doing this habit for a few **seconds,** there will be days where you wish to take it further to **5 or 10 minutes**.

There's **no pressure** to do this, but it will likely naturally happen on days where you have free time and wish to relax. Your brain has built up the association with meditating and as you do it daily, it is now a habit.

Reading - Even if you just read **one page** from a book, you can tick this off. Reading relaxes our brain more than watching Netflix.

It also builds our vocabulary and **raises our IQ**, meaning we will likely make more money, better business decisions, and smarter decisions overall. When you start your attention span may only be a paragraph.

There are times where you only have time for 1 page. There will be days where you read entire chapters. As long as we stay **consistent**

with this habit, we will improve our mental and cognitive health. Try your best to read from **physical books** as I believe this reduces our screen times and is therefore better for us.

Exercise - Even if you do just **one** push up, you can tick this off. The idea behind this is that if you get down to do 1 push up, you'll likely do more once you are already down there and have started.

It also just means that however you go about your day, you have that feeling like you exercised, no matter how little, you still did it. And that builds **positive momentum** for the day.

What starts as one push up can turn into levels of immense greatness. It can turn into

a great workout. That one good decision can lead to months of consistency.

Or years of consistency. A different life with career and personality changes! Remember that! **Small positive decisions and habits repeated daily are going to lead to great results.**

Try and do all of these habits in the morning. I understand that sometimes we have limited time, and often are rushing outside of our doors to get to the train station, but try and get this done before your work day starts.

Make the time to attack your morning with **self care**, because I promise you, the type of day you have when you get all 4 of these

done in the morning, is a different type of day.

This is such a simple self improvement routine, but since I started doing it, my mental health doubled in around 2 weeks, and tripled by the end of a year.

This **habit tracker** is so **low effort** to stick to, that you don't ever get that overwhelming feeling of needing to do too much in your day, you just do the bare minimum and build up a feeling of greatness within you.

Exercise 2: Visualise Your Dream Life

I get my clients to map out their **dream life,** and I will explain why in more detail in the next chapter!

This exercise boosts your mental health, and gives you a sense of direction if you do it correctly and with the special details I am going to provide you.

Once you have an idea of your dream life, you can base your habits around **achieving** this dream life, by **changing your identity** to the type of person that will achieve this dream life.

This exercise **needs** to be done in detail, so you can truly think about the person you need to become, and this will help you to see

what kind of **limiting beliefs** you currently have, that the person you need to become won't be able to have.

In 99% of cases, the kind of person someone needs to become to achieve their dream life, requires some limiting beliefs to be removed, and requires a change in habits and routines.

Once you can see who you need to **become** identity wise, you are a lot more likely to stick to your habit tracker and routines.

You are more likely to **challenge** limiting beliefs and work through the next few sections.

This is because to achieve most people's dream lives, most realise 99% of the time they need to be reliable, on the ball,

confident and organised, which many people simply disregard about themselves until they finally realise it is **necessary**.

Once they actually picture who they need to be, not to achieve their average life, not the humble: “pretty good” life they would **settle** for, but to achieve their **actual** dream, they realise who they need to be is **not** average.

It is the kind of person that is organised, serious about their habits and have way less limiting beliefs than what the person currently has!

A person is then likely to build this identity, stay consistent and take pride in this identity once they can visualise what that identity will need to be through picturing their dream life.

The Dream Life Exercise:

To carry out this exercise, I want you to set aside **half an hour** of your time in a quiet place.

I want you to download an app called **Notion** on your laptop, or use a written journal. Try and avoid your phone as people will text you and you don't want to break your focused state.

Create a document or page called My Dream Life. I want you to play a track to help you concentrate.

If you go to achievegreatness.gumroad.com, you can download this track called "Music For Dream Life Exercise."

It is engineered by Brain.fm. Brain.fm is a company that engineers music specifically designed to help boost your concentration and get you to focus at work or when creating.

I like to put it on the creativity setting and select **low neural activation** on this app whilst I work, but on YouTube you can find some free tracks by the company.

Now I want you to **visualise your dream life** to these questions. I don't want you to be humble when you think of your dream life. I want you to think of what you **really really** want.

If you truly could get it. Not a "good life," not a "humble life" but the **very best of everything that you could possibly get.** You need to picture this dream life in DETAIL.

As you see down below, we are picturing things in such **vivid detail**, down to the **food** you will have in your fridge and **who** you spend your time with.

Answer these questions below: (I've included my own answers from when I originally did the exercise)

What would I do if I had all the money in the world?

What would my house(s) look like?

Do I have a business?

My fridge is full of?

Who am I in a relationship with?

What are my dream day to day activities?

Who am I bringing with me?

What shape am I in?

What would I do if I had all the money in the world?

I would travel the world.

I would buy a house in Phuket.

My house will have a balcony view overlooking the city.

What would my house(s) look like?

My dream house has a swimming pool on the roof. And an astroturfed section of the roof for boxing training. A nice restaurant in the house for parties with friends with a nice selection of healthy food.

I will have a music studio in my house, with a piano, saxophone, and vintage gear… a games room with a PlayStation, snooker table, and darts.

I want a nice, light, brightly coloured study and room. Which has lots of natural sunlight and is pure white in colour.

Do I have a business?

Yes, my Achieve Greatness gym.

My Achieve Greatness gym has a black background logo with white writing.

The gym walls have black colours.

There is a white boxing ring with a skyline view.

We run mens and womens classes.

We train everyone and help them.

We have a meditation and spirituality room.

We have a soup kitchen downstairs for the homeless.

We have a music studio for the youth upstairs.

(Notice how I've gone down to every detail, for what my houses look like and my dream company)

My fridge is full of:

Protein shakes. Green Smoothies. Yakult probiotics. Eggs. Steak and chicken satay and tuna and salmon. Protein yoghurts. Nuts. Pomegranate juice.

Protein porridge. Blueberries. Mangos. The best sports supplements money can buy. Rice. Kerrygold butter, salads. A maid to clean and do laundry.

Who am I in a relationship with?

My girl - she's beautiful, if we argue we fix it that same night, she's a good cook, she's

a good mum, she's smart and wants to achieve greatness too and be nice to people, she wants to make me happy.

Visualise your dream day to day life activities?

Climbing mountains

Riding motorbikes

Mauy Thai boxing

Cinema days in a home cinema

Beach reading and surfing

Content filming , giving my speeches

Training people to be better

Who am I bringing with me?

Me, whoever my girl is

My friends Aaron and Abraham

Brother + Dad

New friends

What shape am I in?

More muscle, 6 pack and bigger shoulders chest

Teeth and eyes in good health

Smelling good with many aftershaves

Nice fashion

If I had all the money. I would create the above, retire my dad, and my Achieve Greatness gym would also take part in charity events. We would try and help the youth. Build up a church.

We would do TED talks and podcasts to try and end racism and try to inspire the world to stop war.

Not just achieving greatness physically in the sense of fitness but also in the sense of worldly events. We would train champions. We would try and put an end to knife crime and have platforms for the youths. We would try and find the cure for cancer.

But ultimately if I had a family just be that guy who could achieve half of this and my kids would know I tried. Then they can carry the torch.

I'd make my son read the bible. Make him learn boxing and sports. Overall my life would feel fulfilled.

After you complete this exercise, keep this dream life document **safe**. This is the life you want to work towards.

I was once told this quote: “If you visualise and pray daily. The universe will start to give you things you can’t understand.”

This exercise can make you feel **great**. You get an idea of where you want to be. I read it often. The crazy thing about creating this is you start to make your life decisions based around it.

For example, a year after I created this document, my fridge was full of the same exact ingredients on my dream life list, I had a new girlfriend who fulfilled all of the requirements on my list.

I was still hanging around with the same friends on my list as I made a subconscious note that I wanted to bring them with me.

In terms of my day to day activities, I was filming content and training people to be better. I was a qualified PT.

Some targets I hadn't reached yet, such as my motorbike license, and because I was in the UK I didn't go to the beach as much as I'd liked, but the truth is I was **on my way**.

Doing an exercise like this is unexplainable, it sets a **clear visualisation** in your mind; spoken into the atmosphere, you will find that you pursue **qualifications** relating to this dream life, pursue **relationships** relating to it, and make financial decisions based around it.

As we will go through in the next chapter, you will even change your identity based on it.

If you need help finding your purpose, try to consider what you would do if you had all

the money in the world and didn't have to work. What would you do day to day? How could you turn that into a high income skill?

It's not always "what you could do for 8 hours a day and not get bored." I heard that a lot from other coaches. I say this because I am a person with many hobbies.

But not all of them are my true passion. For example I love music, I can do music for 8 hours a day, and enjoy it and not get bored. To the point I could forget to eat lunch if I was busy with music.

But eventually, at the end of the day, I feel like I've stayed inside too long doing music.

I didn't feel **social** in a music studio, mixing tracks for people. I wasn't getting the physical fitness element from the job either. Something felt missing.

Whereas, I can do fitness training all day, not get bored, feel sociable, and like I am outside everyday.

Yes, I face occasional challenges, but overall I also get a feeling of fulfilment, sociability and being out in the world that means I love it more than anything. This is my true purpose.

If you want to learn a bit more about purpose, there is a great author called Corey Wayne and a book called “Mastering Yourself.” He explains how once we find our purpose, and chase it daily, we are at our **most happy**. And how we need to set our lives up so we chase our purpose mainly, over staying in jobs we hate, or doing what our partners or family wants.

We have to find those who support us and go for our dreams. You can also read Psycho Cyberneutics by Maxwell Maltz for more information on **visualisation.**

Well done for completing this exercise!

"Every thought of yours is a real thing – a force."

Prentice Mulford 1834 - 1891

Take pride in yourself

After the basic habit tracker is constructed for my client, and they have **mapped out** their dream life, another way I try to

improve their life in 2 weeks is that I encourage them to think about the dream life they wish to have, and the **person they need to become** in order to achieve that dream life.

I encourage them to consider if they currently have any **limiting beliefs** or have any personality traits currently that will stop them from being that person.

For example, I notice many people who write about their dream lives, picture themselves as happy confident people. Doing well financially and leading a family well are also common wishes.

There are common traits that would hold them back from becoming these type of people. How could you do well financially in

this day and age being bad at technology, being disorganised, being forgetful, how could you reach the upper levels of promotion and do well for yourself without these things?

How could you be a leader without practicing in leadership situations, and how would you lead if you “don’t like the spotlight? or lead your family if you “aren’t really the type to take charge?”

What I am saying is, there are common things people say about themselves that they just repeat throughout life that aren’t necessarily true, or can be changed with **minimal** effort. Literally some of these things can be changed overnight.

Confident traits are important, and considering you have the traits necessary to become that person that will achieve your dream life is important too. Taking pride in that person you are going to become is going to give you the ability to improve your mentality and **actually stick to** your habits.

Take pride in those confident traits that you once felt unconfident about, rewrite your character. You can truly do this in a **matter of weeks**.

Some personality traits take longer than others to change, but for the most part the common limiting beliefs people talk about can be reversed quickly, especially when they realise belief in those traits doesn't serve them.

I was reading the book Atomic Habits by James Clear, an expert in helping individuals and businesses to achieve more by changing their **counterproductive** habits to more **productive** ones.

He was a creator of the Habits Academy which literally worked with Top 500 companies as well as the Military, high level sports teams and numerous high achievers to build habits that benefit productivity.

So pretty much, his whole life's work was based around researching habits. He was explaining that the best way to change a habit is to first ***change our identity.***

I agree with his point of view. It is apparent with lots of people I coach. For example, I

meet so many people in life who say negative things about themselves like:

- I am not a reliable person
- I am bad with technology
- I am bad at sticking to my word
- I'm not really a morning person
- I'm shy and not the talkative type
- I don't like being in front of the camera.
- I have ADHD
- I'm not business minded
- I'm not interested in being a high achiever
- I'm not a person that takes charge
- I don't like the spotlight
- I have no organisational skills

If only I was paid everytime I heard these things!

A lot of times these are things the person has told themselves their **whole life**. Or sometimes their family members just said these things to them so many times that they just believe it to be true about themselves.

How many in the above list of things have I said about myself in the past? All of them. How many of these things do I think about myself in the present? **None.**

How long did it take me to stop considering these things about myself once I realised they didn't serve the person I wished to become? A matter of hours or a few weeks maximum, not a long time at all, and mostly overnight.

The thing I find is. Every single thing on the list above, you can literally wake up one day and just decide not to be those things.

Your Dad telling you for 10 years that he never saw the point in being business minded and that it doesn't run in the family to be business minded is not really going to sound too cool to you when you truly decide your burning desire is to want to be a CEO of a company.

You may realise your family telling you "working out is for vain people and we are a family that plays video games" for 10 years straight isn't as cool as you thought it was if you want a good looking and in shape partner and you see all the good looking, in shape people at the beach generally coupling up with each other.

When you truly make the realization that something does not serve the person you wish to become, it actually doesn't take long to break these thought processes about yourself.

You just didn't consider that you **could,** because you've built these thoughts for years and breaking out of them so fast would be too easy, right? Wrong!

Within seconds you can break out of the category you or others have put yourself in. It all starts when you decide a bad habit is not in your **identity** anymore, and that practicing good habits is **in** your identity.

This is actually a form of positive self-talk. When your mother or your father tell you:

“you’re not good at public speaking. Everyone in this family has always been shy.”

Or: *“oh you would do better in an office job, no one in this family has done physical jobs before!”*

Usually, that person is actually just insecure because they feel that way about themselves or are set in their ways.

They don’t mean to hold you back, but they make it seem as though their experience applies to you. It rarely applies to you.

Not only that, but let’s say your mother always knew you as an unreliable or forgetful teenager. *“You never stick to your word.”*

You may have heard that a lot from your mother.

You might feel like an unreliable person that could never be in an **important position** of responsibility.

You might always feel like an irresponsible child, and your family might reinforce those feelings by never letting you take responsibility for things.

You might go through life refusing to believe you are suitable for management positions, because you feel like you wouldn't operate responsibly.

You may feel you would be too forgetful, based on what someone else has repeatedly made you believe about yourself.

But here's the thing, people usually remember the old version of you until you present them with the new.

They don’t see your **2 years transformation** where you have made great improvements, not yet. It takes them a while to catch up, and whilst they catch up, you can’t let an old version of you that they bring up cause you to get knocked off your self belief in yourself.

People such as your family, unless you are fortunate enough to have extremely positive family members that are maybe in the coaching field themselves, are not going to see your potential as much as is actually there.

When it comes to a mother telling you that you “are” a forgetful and disorganised person, the “are” part is not true. That was an old version of you. That’s a version of you with no potential.

A young immature version of you. People around you will box you in to that old version and reinforce it about you, and you will reinforce it about yourself.

This way you end up categorising yourself as this type of person, and accepting it as part of your identity. Even if you are actually extremely capable of being the complete opposite.

This is bad, because you are never working on your weaknesses, you are just accepting them as “part of your identity.”

But what if I told you that mostly all of those weaknesses I listed above, you can just decide one day that no matter what someone else thinks about you, you are no longer that person anymore.

How I Changed My Identity

I remember one day, I had a shocking realisation. I realised I had a girlfriend, the years had flown by. I was 26 but it had felt like just yesterday that I was 21.

Things were getting serious in my relationship, and I realised how **expensive** relationships and starting a family actually was.

My girlfriend at the time asked me: "realistically how much do you earn monthly, and how do you propose we can build a life with each other on such a wage."

"Because Tommy, rent is this price, kids are this price, a car is this price and holidays are this price. I've seen my mum and dad live without much money, and trust me life is really **hard** without it."

I remember thinking that I wanted to provide for my family one day, have a car and house and nice things. And that this mid twenties life plan of being on minimum wage and travelling the world with no big dreams or idea to seriously consider my finances and future career path, could not be forever.

Things got real. I wanted a management position and to earn good money, and I needed to be the type of person to **get things done** in order to achieve that.

I decided that same day that I was a responsible person, that I was a leader, that I wasn't forgetful, that actually I was very sharp and on the ball.

I decided I was a guy who got things done, and who didn't slip up. Who was **a man of his word**. No matter who knew me as the complete opposite.

No matter who knew me as that "forgetful drinker in the pub on the weekend," or anything else negative that would not serve me.

I removed anything about myself that I knew deep down was negative self talk. I promised myself I would take pride in this new version of myself and believe in it 100%.

The funny thing is anyone who came into my life after that day, **instantly believed it about me.** I started to become that person genuinely. I took up mature behaviours and habits very easily as I considered them part of my *identity* now.

It was the people that knew me **from before** I changed my identity, that of course didn't believe me.

They took a long time to understand the changes within me. But eventually they accepted them too once my consistency got **too loud for them to ignore.**

I pretty much went from telling myself I had ADHD, to simply understanding that for me to be an elite operator and to start a successful business, I needed to be a person who was focused and didn't get distracted.

No excuses, I just told myself I was a person who could focus for hours because I knew I wouldn't survive in the competitive world of business otherwise.

When I realised as an online fitness coach that I wanted to reach more people with my work, and realised social media was the way forward, I had told myself my whole life that I was "not good with being on cameras."

With no acting experience, I woke up the next day, told myself: "I am good on

camera." I went to the park and went jogging with my camera out, speaking into the camera confidently.

I became that person overnight that was running past other people and not caring what they thought. My dream life and my belief in it was so strong, that my identity change was rapid.

Even though it was my first day doing it, people asked me "oh so you make videos?" And I just said "yeah I do." This was me now, it was part of my *identity.*

For example if you looked at social media videos I posted when I had 200 followers, they seem a lot more confident than a normal person just starting out.

In my mind I had millions of followers and had been doing this for a long time, when I really hadn't, but I just acted that way.

We need to understand the subtle difference between being humble and holding ourselves back. Sometimes the most humble thing we can do is accept the fact that if we are too shy we are not going to get anywhere and that we should present more of a **confident** character.

Being humble is accepting weaknesses in our character too and that which we need to work on.

I know that sounds backwards to a lot of people, but it is true. In environments like social media, the person who is too humble and believes they are "new" and "taking it

slow" and learning doesn't present themselves with a lot of **confidence.**

The person who gives themselves permission to be confident and records daily with utmost confidence acting like they have been recording online forever, doing the same kind of videos that all the big names are doing, instead of being shy, does so well.

You will often see someone who is scared to approach the big topics or sound too qualified hold themselves back, whereas a new person is who simply gets stuck in, seems to do really well and get the rewards.

The best thing you can do, is to change your identity to the person you know you need to

be, in order to achieve your best and be the happiest version of yourself.

Not the version your **family** want or expect you to be, nor who your **friends** want you to be. Think of the most high achieving version of you, that version is a morning person! It's not they "try" to wake up in the morning, they simply do, because they know it's necessary.

They don't try to be courageous, they are courageous. They don't try to quit smoking. They aren't a smoker.

This person is great with technology, they are a person of their word, their habits are on point, they accomplish whatever needs to be done with maximum reliability.

If you simply believe this about yourself, tell yourself this is the person you are and need to be, and start doing them **tomorrow**, you will have already become that person by a larger percentage than you think.

Most of the above thought processes are literal overnight changes where all you have to do is decide what type of person you are and believe it. Don't worry if others don't believe you yet, focus on convincing **yourself**.

After changing your identity, and taking pride in it, you will consistently stick to your habit tracker and the self improvement habits listed on there. Because you understand deep down that if you really need to focus to achieve your wildest dreams, you will. If you really need to wake up early,

you will. If you really need your habits to be on point, you will ensure they are.

We are so capable of doing all these things, and our family members or friends sometimes are hard on us, they tend to remember that **one time** we made a mistake to call us unreliable, or that **one time** we didn't wake up on time, to make it seem as if we are lazy.

But they forget the other **100 times** that we woke up early, the amount of times we got things done efficiently. Or they make you believe you need to be a negative person because they are themselves. The person who knows you best is actually you, so don't be put off.

Change Your Identity To The Version Of You That Takes Pride In Everything

I am now going to give you a few common changes to your identity that CAN for the most part be changes that can happen very quickly.

These changes allow you to take pride in everything you do. This will benefit your mental health and overall view of yourself.

As long as you choose to believe these changes will assist you to become a high achieving person and can picture in your head why they will do so, you are likely to follow them!

Be real with yourself, is the person who achieves your dream life a **looser**? In 99% of young, smart and sane peoples answers, it is going to be "**no!**"

We can blame our **genetics**, we can blame our **environment**, we can blame our **personality**. But ultimately life won't listen to us **talk** about those things and spare us, all life will listen to is did we change our personality to become the person we needed to be in order to **achieve** our dream life.

The best thing you can do for yourself in life from here on is to consider yourself:

A person of your word.
A positive person.

A reliable person who gets things done effectively, who doesn't slip up and gets things right.
A leader.
A person who can accomplish whatever they want.
A person good at anything they put their mind to.
A person who will conquer anything they need to be good at to achieve their dreams.
A confident person.
A professional person who gets things right and doesn't slip up.
A tidy person.
A person who takes pride in their appearance.
A person with positive habits and mindset.
A focused, non distracted, mature and successful person who cares about their future.

A person who has charisma, who doesn't mind being the center of attention when it comes to influencing others towards positivity.

Become this person as part of your **identity**, and you will see your life change. Practice it first with new people, and you will see how quickly they believe it.

The above **mindsets** for the most part are that of a confident and reliable leader that is statistically proven to be capable of creating a solid financial future and being well liked and respected by their friends and family. Which is what most people tend to want.

These people win, and that is how life works.

Make the change! Don’t let those that already know you knock you with their comments, they will try and make you believe you are still that **old version** of yourself at first. They may say things referring to the old you.

This is almost life's way of testing you to see if you believe what they say, they are testing you to see if you go back to your **old ways.**

But if you **stand firm,** eventually everyone around you will see and accept who you really are. And most importantly of all, you will see yourself.

You will also start to see how other people talk bad about themselves, and see themselves in some of the limiting beliefs we spoke about above. It will frustrate you

because you know deep down, it's changeable in a short time period.

It's usually a person trapped living in a version of themselves that **others** wanted them to be, or convinced them that they were.

A version of themselves **others** built, or the old version of them from 5 years ago that they somehow **still** believe they are.

Not the version that **they** truly decided they wanted to be if they really thought about it. Not the version that has the confidence to see the potential in themselves based on their actual ability in life.

You decide who you want to be. From here on out, I want you to first change elements of your identity to most of the **traits** listed above, and any others you feel deep down you always wanted for yourself, and don't let anyone take this identity away from you, even if you make **mistakes** at first when adjusting, even if people ask you: "*but what about yesterday and all those times you weren't like this*?"

Tell them: "**I'm a new person now**. I decided that for my future I needed to change, I can and I will, and I want you to judge me on the merit of my actions **today**."

Protect Your New Identity

If people don’t believe in your new identity, then that's OK. You don’t need anyone's **permission.**

As long as YOU see the best in you, as long as YOU believe in your identity, the version of you **others** create will not matter as much.

You will start to hang out with those who respect you and see the best in you anyway.

And over time, if your belief about yourself is consistently stronger than your family and friends version of beliefs about you, they will eventually **give up** and accept your new identity.

Your version of yourself needs to be stronger than their version!

This is known as holding a strong frame. Basically, someone tells you “your not a confident person.” And you say “yes, I am.” And they say “no your not!”

“Even the other day you got up on stage and you were scared to speak! I heard it in your voice!”

But you don’t seem to care and double down: “i’m a confident person, I'm the most confident person in the world.”

There is **no answer they can give you** that will make you change your mind and make you unconfident, even if they have a point.

Even if they are presenting you with a million reasons why your not confident, you don't care. You are stubborn.

You are in a **battle** of holding frame. As long as you have the stronger frame, the stronger will, and truly believe in what you are, and sit there and assert yourself enough times, eventually the other person will give up.

Sometimes you might even deep down know you aren't the most confident, maybe you aren't yet the best public speaker, but you want to get there one day, and you know you aren't just going to let someone else affect your positive self talk, you amusedly still just stand firm and bypass any reason they throw at you.

Show them you don't care, show them you won't budge. You generally believe you are the best.

Too many people have problems being assertive in this world, too many people have weak frames.

But it is a great skill to have to be able to be **unshakeably** confident in yourself, and not let someone else be able to knock that. Simply for the reason that if you want to wake up daily and set yourself goals that are a little too high, or believe in yourself a little too much, you have the right to be able to do that.

Those are the kind of people that make it in life anyway. Your unshakeable self confidence is one of the most important

things you could have, never let someone **take it away** from you.

Sometimes holding a strong frame can simply be an exercise in not allowing someone to take away that type of thinking from you. Reminding someone else you aren't like others.

Especially in a world where everyone tries to make it seem like your dreams are **too small**, or you shouldn't have an "almost too high" level of self confidence.

Even if you are the skinniest kid in the locker room, if you believe you are the strongest person in the world and say it with all your heart, and simply laugh and act like all the reasons a person is giving you as to why it is

not true don't really matter, then you will win the battle of frames.

People that are able to do this consistently honestly just do better in life. They are masters at creating their own destiny and loving themselves with humor.

Of course, address your weaknesses, be realistic about areas you need to improve. No one is perfect. But those that wake up with extremely high levels of self belief and love for themselves, are destined to do well.

The thing is about life is that unconfident people, will often see that you are a confident person, and try to test you to see if they can knock you.

They want to see if it's really true, so they will present you with a million reasons why you're not cut out for something.

They might sit there for 5 minutes, 10 minutes, a week or two trying to **persuade** you. They might even have solid evidence as to why your goals are too high or you aren't who you say you are.

But once they realise they are arguing with a person who simply doesn't listen to reason, once they realise that you are literally a brick wall of positivity and self belief that will be extremely confident no matter what they say, they eventually **give up**.

This is a battle you should always try to win with people who try and drag you down, especially when it comes to believing you are

a positive, effective person destined for greatness.

It's simply good for your positive self talk and your self belief to think highly of yourself. Some people may think it is being cocky.

But in this competitive world, the people who have stronger frames and self belief always do well.

The kind of person who can be amused and stand firm despite people giving them 100 reasons why they can't do something, why they aren't a good fit for a particular job, why they aren't strong or they aren't cut out for something.

Let me tell you, that kind of person who can stand firm, and assert that they are the best at everything when someone is trying to persuade them otherwise, will do extremely well in life.

The person who is humble and caring towards others, but who also knows they are genuinely heading for the stars.

They think they have the potential to be the best, without feeling above others. They will never say someone else can't do something, because they will rather just be focused on the fact that they themselves can.

They will never try to make someone else believe they can't win, but they will simply believe they themselves can win and focus on themselves.

They know how to repel any haters with an unshakeable self belief, because they won't stand for negative talk. They have control over how they feel and it will be positive.

Even if deep down their goals are a bit unrealistic, they simply enjoy having a really high level of self confidence and I want you to have the same.

I find there is a slight difference between not being humble and this kind of confidence. You want to uplift others too and make them believe they can do anything, you admit your not perfect, and your fortune can get taken away at anytime.

But you just hold a level of confidence that is slightly optimistic, and you most definitely

believe in your ability to do great things even against all odds, you are the type that believes in miracles and optimism and definitely not the type to let someone else say whats possible or not about you in negative directions.

I'm not saying that if you have never set foot in the gym you need to change your identity to a 4 times national champion bodybuilder and believe it.

Of course you need to go in and learn the gym and these things take time. But **I do** want you to have a high level of self confidence, and walk around as the most positive version of the person you are, with big ambitions, and never let someone take that away. You'll get a feel for when negative people are trying to drag you down.

Limiting Beliefs That Are Good To Change

One thing I want you to do for me is to start today, and change your identity in a number of areas that will really benefit you.

In terms of the short term, what I want you to change overnight:

I want you to consider yourself a person that is positive.
I want you to consider yourself a person that is a high achiever.
I want you to consider yourself as a person who wins.
I want you to consider yourself as that CEO type person who doesn't slip, who is reliable and gets the job done.

If you are a follower I want you to wake up tomorrow and consider yourself a leader.
Being a follower will rarely serve you.
If you are messy I want you to consider yourself tidy.
I want you to start seeing yourself as a person of your word.
I want you to see yourself as a person who looks after yourself and takes pride in yourself, and takes pride seriously.

These are for the most part ***identity shifts*** you can actually instantly make. They may take a long time to strengthen fully, but there's nothing logically stopping you from deciding to be this kind of person tomorrow.

Do that for 6 months to a year straight and there won't be any doubters left.

Those are the things I want you to change about your identity now if you haven't already. That's the key to self confidence.

In the longer term, in the next ***6 months:***

If you are bad with technology, maths, or literally any topic you always considered yourself bad at, that you deep down know the best version of you will need to achieve their dream life then:

I want you to sit yourself down and tell yourself you need to be **good** at this subject in this day and age for your success, and therefore as a successful person you will learn it and are capable of it. Then work

towards being acceptable at this skill in the next few months.

There are some things that you can pay others to do, but things like technology or things crucial to your success in the modern day world, you need to simply **remove your excuses** and learn.

If you have not been a **consistent** gym goer (for longer than 6 months) then I want you to consider yourself as someone who is now actively working towards taking care of your body and who **seriously cares** about this.

If you have ADHD as I did, no matter what teachers or your family told you, I want you to see yourself as a **focused** person.
Changing your diet to help you with your

focus, take 2000mg of Cod Liver Oil daily, 5g Creatine daily, and Vitamin D3 10,000 iu daily.

If you have **ADHD**, start to meditate as this will teach you to focus and direct your thoughts away from distraction, and you will be able to catch yourself slipping more often.

Reading physical books also helps your **attention span.**

If you are shy I want you to see yourself as **confident**.

If you aren't business minded, never went to business school, or had family that did so, I want you to work towards **reading** business books and becoming so in the next 6 months.

If you are not a good **public speaker**, I want you to take a look at the book Talk Like Ted by Carmine Gallo, so you can learn some extra techniques to come across better in this regard.

If you don't really like "**being the centre of attention**." Try and consider yourself a more charismatic person. Try to post more on social media or start a hobby like YouTube and try to get more involved in conversations to see yourself as the opposite. Charismatic people do not avoid the attention of others.

If you feel like you are weak, constantly getting stepped on, or scared to speak out and defend yourself, I want you to learn

some **martial arts** and at least in the next 6 months start to teach yourself boxing and how to hit the punch bag at a minimum.

Now, something **amazing** will happen. When you change your identity to this gym loving, confident, charismatic and business minded CEO level organised person, you are way more likely to stick to your self improvement habits.

And then the more you stick to your self improvement habits, the more they truly become part of your **identity**.

You're somewhat **faking** it until you **make** it at first, but not for long. I want you to truly believe you are this new person as of now. Because deep down you truly are, you are

capable, and you need to start seeing it within yourself.

Nearly everyone is actually capable, it's just those who do not *see* it within themselves, will never *become* it.

You need to see yourself as a person who can decide to make **whatever changes** they want to in order to shape the life they want, and a person who is then able to **stick** to those changes.

"I am" vs "I'm trying to."

A key difference when you change your identity is to make statements such as "I am" rather than "I'm trying to be." Let's say you

change your identity from a person who is **"trying"** to go to the gym to a person that "**goes** to the gym daily with no excuses." For 6 months straight you go to the gym, it will now reinforce that about your identity.

You believe it about yourself now, at first you didn't as much, only a little but, through consistently repeating the habit for 6 months you are certain.

Then after 6 months comes 1 year, not only does being a person who "goes to the gym daily" become part of your identity, but you become "that person who goes to the gym daily and is really strong."

What comes next? After 2 years of consistency, you become "that person who

goes to the gym daily and is so strong that they train others."

This kind of person at this stage simply wouldn't miss many days at the gym at this point. Going to the gym has become too much of a repeated habit and part of who they are.

And it all started from deciding they were a gym goer. When all their friends thought they sounded too confident or didn't believe them.

There was no "I'm trying to." That gives you an exit plan. Remember I said life always seems to reward those who give themselves permission to be confident and take charge? Who boldly assert themselves?

The person that proudly says: “I’m a gym goer now” is likely to do well and believe it.

Have strong momentum and belief in the first few months, that's all you need.

So now, you understand the importance of building your identity as a person who gets things done. To a person with great habits, to a person who has pride in themselves.

You see that it's sometimes necessary to be a stubborn person, that confident people tend to win, and defending that confident identity when others challenge it is necessary sometimes.

You see that you’ll probably win more at life if you have an almost unrealistic level of self confidence, and should try to become that

person who will defend this new version of themselves from anyone who tries to interfere.

This is because others in the world will accept average, but you deep down know that those that do well, are extremely self assured.

Love yourself and see the best in yourself more than others around you do, it's normal others are biased and don’t see the positives about you as much as you.

People often get the balance wrong between giving you credit and criticism. Only coaches and trained professionals seem to get this balance correct in life.

But you know the truth about yourself, the positives about yourself, never let your own perception of yourself slip. Remind yourself of this fact. Be kind. We are usually better than we think.

Now you have accomplished a few things, you have built a healthy habit tracker that you can stick to with low effort and you have mapped out your dream life.

You have promised to set a strong identity for yourself. You have promised to hold an identity where you ***take pride in yourself and believe in self improvement.***

You have set an identity which will serve you to achieve your dream life and get all the best out of all this life has to offer.

You have promised to yourself to defend this identity from those that try to make you believe otherwise.

Now, in a short time, you have laid a very good foundation for your mindset to improve. With this foundation, you will have a better chance of sticking to your routines and goals.

This is why I do this section first before even covering nutrition or fitness, because I want you to become the type of person that sticks to fitness!

Daily Routines

When you start to see yourself as having the numerous qualities to your identity that we set for you in the above sections, you will also be more likely to understand why I am about to propose the following routines for you.

You will understand the **why** behind what you are doing and be able to clearly visualise why they will help you, because you will likely be able to picture the high performing version of yourself that you are trying to become doing these daily.

Now it is time to discuss routines in further detail. What kind of routine will a person who takes pride in themselves keep?

Sure, they would keep the basics of the habit tracker and the 4 non-negotiable habits we added. Those are our **bare minimum.**

Without overwhelming you, I am going to give you an idea of things you can slowly add into your day.

These are **great routines** for someone who wants to become a person that has a **positive mindset.** I have had success implementing them into the lives of the clients which I train.

A good morning regime:

- Wake up.
- Say 1 Positive Affirmation.
- Make bed.
- Shower.
- Shave.
- Apply aftershave and deodorant. - smell nice and take pride in it.
- Vitamins :
- Cod liver oil 1000mg x 2
- Vitamin D. 10,000iu
- Zinc + Magnesium
- Brush teeth and use a tongue scraper
- Get dressed.
- Gratitude Journalling
- Read One Page Of Book
- Short Meditation

If not working and it's possible -

- Short Walk Outside / Morning Jog
- Morning Workout / Movement

Good evening regime:

- Wash face
- Brush teeth
- 8 hours sleep
- Positive Visualisations of Achieving Your Dreams

If you want to supplement in the evening you can take a magnesium tablet and L-Theanine for assisted sleep.

Avoid caffeine 6 hours before bed.

If you read before bed, try to read with the **dark mode** enabled if you are using a phone or kindle, and use a low light setting.

Evening Journalling

You may journal an optional entry in your journal where instead of **gratitude,** you write down your **wins of the day,** in terms of what you are proud of yourself for.

You can also reaffirm your ultimate goal to yourself in this journal session. This refers to your ultimate dream.

The more times you write down and affirm your ultimate goal to yourself, the more you become sure of it.

The more you have an idea of where you are going in life. This technique keeps you grounded and focusing on what matters day to day.

I got this journaling technique from the property tycoon businessman Grant Cardone, who is a multimillionaire. He says:

“Who is going to win and keep their day to day activities focused and relevant to their goals more? The guy who writes down their goal **once** a year? Or the guy who writes down their goal **365 times** a year? Or even double that.”

I do this often. I must admit, that after a busy day, sometimes I don’t journal my ultimate goal or my wins, instead I think of

these things in my head as a way of getting to sleep.

I do it this way to keep my mind occupied and avoid the distraction of Netflix or other things people use in the night time.

I find I get a better sleep if an hour before bed, I reflect on my wins of the day and reaffirm my ultimate life goal to myself instead of watching screens. I even have an **audio recording** I made of my life goal that I would play for myself.

Then if I am still awake, I do positive visualisations where I visualise myself achieving my dream and each step I will take to get there. I think vividly how it will feel to win and achieve my dream.

This often knocks me out in a few minutes and I find it better for me than if I was watching Netflix or movies.

Try to remember that the above examples of routines are showing those ideal, perfect days where you remember to do all this and everything goes well for you time wise.

Many days are simply so busy, that some days you may miss an affirmation, or forget to wash your face, or not do an evening journal in favor for working more on your business.

If you are working hard, becoming a successful person, putting in work in the gym, then actually yes, you may pass out completely from tiredness before doing a lot of the evening routines.

This is ok, the more we implement the more these routines become normal, and this is an example of a good day.

I suggest always having the non negotiables from your habit tracker complete, and I try to schedule doing all my important stuff in the morning that I really don't want to fall asleep and skip.

I never go over 6 things on my habit tracker. And things like brushing my teeth I don't put on because those are things I'm definitely going to remember to do anyway.

My non-negotiables at the moment are:

Gratitude Journalling
Exercise

Reading
Meditation / Prayer
(Always these 4 no matter what)

Drink 1L Water
Work 8h Per Day (5 Days Per Week)

These are the things I believe give you the most bang for your buck. You may have to tweak things slightly. For example I don't put "taking vitamins" as non-negotiable on my habit tracker, even though I do them daily.

This is because for some reason I never forget to take them. They are on my cabinet and as soon as I go downstairs in the morning I walk over to them and take them.

I take them all in the morning and they are near my door, so I never leave my house without walking past them and taking them. As I take them in the morning I never fall asleep at night forgetting to take them.

You can add to your tracker too but keep it at 5 - 6 habits. If you find yourself getting overwhelmed, just take it back to that basic habit tracker at the start of the book with the 4 habits.

For example, you might not need the work 8 hours a day tracker because you work an **office job**, you are going there to work 8 hours anyway. I work on business on my laptop at home, and not at set times on a rota, so I need the reminder.

Everyone is different, you may need to set the taking vitamins habit if you forget to take them. Just try to keep the 4 non negotiable self improvement habits no matter what.

If you follow that tracker alone, take your vitamins, and follow the morning routines, you will be ahead of 90% of people in terms of your mindset. You can try to include the evening routines too if you feel like you need more.

More actionable steps to take pride in ourselves:

- Keep a haircut often.
- Trim your nails.

- Have showers often and take pride in it.
- Apply fragrance every time you leave the house even if you aren't going anywhere of note
- Look your best every time you leave the house even if you aren't going anywhere of note
- Start to take the gym seriously
- Dress in good clean clothes.
- Practice a good morning and evening regime.

Other ways to look after yourself:

- Always attend the dentist.
- Always go to your eye tests.
- If you have acne or bad skin, go to a dermatologist. 10-20mg of the drug Accutane once a week can assist you.

Brush your teeth twice a day, and use a tongue scraper. Wash your face morning and night.

If you need further help with improving your mindset and routine, I have done a lot of life coaching, where I have helped a lot of people significantly improve their mental health scores. The topics I specialise in are:

- Daily Habits & Routine
- Meditation
- Gratitude
- Fixing Overthinking
- Fixing ADHD
- Productivity
- Depression
- Anxiety
- Positive Visualisation
- Positive Self Talk

- Mental Health
- Finding Your Purpose
- Confidence & Self Esteem

If you feel like you need help with any of these topics, reach out to book a call with me and I will see how I can assist you.

Chapter 2: Common Mindset Issues

The rest of this book will focus on common mindset issues and some actionable advice to improve in these areas.

Self Talk / Self Image

"A man cannot rise above how he sees himself."

"A woman cannot rise above how she sees herself."

James Smith grew up in a family that owned land, built businesses, and won often. James grew up in an environment where success wasn't just encouraged—it moved around him daily. The gates of his family's estate would open each morning, revealing a long driveway leading up to a house that felt more like a castle than a home.

Conversations about business and growth were constantly happening around him. At

the dinner table, his father didn’t speak in hopes or possibilities, but in certainty. “You’re a Smith. Winning is what we do. Coming first is what we do.

This wasn't arrogance. It was certainty. It was permission. By age seven, James didn't wonder if he could achieve things—he assumed he could. His ceiling wasn't set by his talent. It was set by his belief.

Now consider someone else. Let's call him David. He grew up in a family that valued hard work, honesty, and humility. His parents worked steady jobs. They didn't aim high because they believed "people like us don't." At the dinner table, the message was quieter, but it landed just as hard: "We're not entrepreneurs. We're regular people. We survive. We settle. That's just who we are.

David wasn't told he was incapable. He was never explicitly discouraged. But he was never *encouraged* to be confident, to be outspoken, to consider himself the best at anything. His family called it humility. It was actually permission denied.

By age twenty-five, James had attempted five business ideas and failed twice. He kept trying because his self-image said: "Smiths succeed eventually." David had the same potential, the same intelligence, maybe even better instincts. But he never started the first business because his self-image said: "People like me don't do that."

The brutal truth: James's advantage wasn't money or connections. It was *belief*.

His family installed a self-image of capability so early that it became invisible to him. He didn't think about whether he could win—he just assumed it.

David's family accidentally installed the opposite. They weren't cruel by any means. They were just limited in what they could imagine for him. And he inherited that limitation.

Here's what matters: **Your self-image isn't fixed. It was installed. And it can be reinstalled.** We usually inherit our self talk (the way we talk about ourselves) and our self esteem from past experiences and it usually starts from the childhood.

Maybe you grew up like James—granted permission to believe in yourself, told you

could do anything, surrounded by people who hyped you up. If so, you're ahead. But many of you grew up like David. You were taught humility when you needed ambition. You were taught to settle when you needed to aim. Your family called it wisdom. It was actually fear disguised as modesty.

In today's world, that exact confidence—that self-belief, that willingness to call yourself the best and *mean it*—is often the only difference between people who change their lives and people who stay stuck. This section will help you to build your self-image.

4 Steps To Improve Your Self Image

Tip 1: Do Things For Your Future Self

The act of doing things for your future self is very good for building up self love. Even the process of staying consistent with what you say you will do, can help you in the process of building self love.

Everytime you stick to your workout, everytime you complete an entire day where you have done everything in your habit tracker, every time you complete positive habits that the you in 5 years time is going to thank you for, you are building self love and self esteem.

Tip 2: Speak To Yourself Kindly

There is one promise that is the most impactful promise you could make to yourself when it comes to fixing your self esteem. The promise to always speak to yourself kindly, even if sometimes others don't.

The way you speak to yourself matters. Promise to always speak to yourself kindly.

I've created a self talk audio for you to hear the type of things you should be saying to yourself. You can access it at achievegreatness.gumroad.com

Things like positive affirmations when you get up in the morning can really help. In

terms of how you speak to yourself, you never want to tell yourself things like:

- *"I can't" do something.*
- *I'm bad at this.*
- *This is impossible.*

The idea behind"positive self talk" is that you shouldn't really be saying anything negative about yourself at all.

The only time I really say negative things about myself is when I answer what my weaknesses are in a job interview, and it's always with the strong belief that I will conquer that weakness one day.

In my first book in this series, I explained how those that are unbreakably confident and a measure above average in terms of

being self assured, are the people that win in life.

The balance to strike is that you should speak to yourself so kindly, and hype yourself up so much, to where it may sound slightly cocky if someone else was to hear you.

Even if you are a humble person, you want to be slightly above average and ideally a good measure above average in terms of your self confidence.

I’m not saying you have to go and shout that you're the best at everything so that the whole street can hear, that would annoy people. But in terms of how you speak to yourself in private, you should definitely think you're the best and that there’s no one

greater. That’s what strong self talk looks like.

Get used to speaking to yourself in a positive and extremely confident light. There's something about faking it until you make it that will eventually allow you to become this person.

Good self talk sounds like:

- I’m the best.
- I’m the strongest.
- I love myself so much.
- If I can’t do something, I will learn how to do it and become the best at it.
- I have potential to be good at anything I put my mind to.
- I am a quick learner and can make the best out of any situation.

Any time you detect a weakness in yourself, you should affirm to yourself that you have the potential to become great in this area. Work on it. Learn to hype yourself up, as if you are already the best at it. Never let someone else dictate what you are good at!

There's always an opposite angle to your weaknesses. Find it! Maybe you mess up a lot on a particular combo in your boxing class.

Almost hype yourself up to yourself as though you are becoming the best and don't let anyone laugh at you. Remain strong willed.

Either your the best at something if you are good at it.

Or you have the **potential** to be the best if you currently aren't good at it. There's never any : "I can't" involved in your self-talk.

Find reasons why your the best at everything even if everyone else would question It. Find reasons to have supreme confidence at everything you do, and don't let anyone take it away from you. Craft a character that is unbreakable.

Even when you deep down know you aren't the champion of the world at something, for the sake of positive self talk, you can humorously say you will get there one day.

And lets be real, its healthy and self assured to beleive that if you truly worked hard and gave your all to most things in life, you could achieve them.

So set your goals high even if you know you are slightly far off and believe you are the best. You don't have to be a narcissist, but if you don't talk to yourself nicely and believe you can do anything, who else is going to?

Tip 3 - Protect Your Standards

Self-esteem is built by what you **tolerate**. What you allow into your life teaches your mind what you believe you deserve. If you stay in poor relationships, disrespect, toxic environments, and self-sabotaging habits, you will start to lower your self esteem.

Every time you accept **less** than your standards, you lower your internal value.Raise your standards.

Protect your peace. Walk away from what weakens your identity.

You can actually build self esteem by walking away from situations that don't serve you. Especially when you walk away from disrespectful situations, such as relationships, you can boost your self esteem and self love by so much.

Self esteem can also be boosted simply by removing yourself from negative people in your life who break you down, and by spending time with those that build you up. It sounds obvious, but spending time with those who see the best in you, can really boost your self esteem.

Even someone else telling you "you can do this." or seeing potential in your personality

or talent, can boost your self esteem. Surround yourself with people that build you up and walk away from people who don't respect who you truly are.

Tip 4 - Reminders Of Greatness

Reminders are a super effective tool. Keep a journal of any successful moments you had. Or even keep a notes page of reminders on your phone , with all of your wins, successful moments, strengths and the kind, respectful, positive things people said to you.

Keep reminders of anytime someone noticed greatness or potential within you. Anytime someone said you were good or great at something. You can look back on this list anytime you doubt yourself.

Tip 5: Journaling Exercise For Improving Self Image

Step 1: Read the chapter in my first book entitled Dream Life Exercise. Or visit achievegreatness.gumroad.com and download the "Dream Life Exercise" PDF.

Step 2: Use the PDF prompts to journal your dream life in vivid detail.

Step 3: Journal the type of person you need to become to achieve this dream life. This is going to give you clarity on the ideal version of yourself that you will need to become in order to achieve your goals.

Step 4: Form a table with a line down the middle. On the left side of the table, journal the answers to these two questions:

"Is there anything you were constantly brought up to believe that would get in the way of becoming the person who would achieve your dream life?

"What went on in my life that is the reason why my self esteem isn't as high as it could be?"

Step 5: On the right hand side of the table, write the ways your dream character would likely think about these things. The opinions they would have. It's likely they would think the total opposite.

Spend some time going through each reason on the left hand side of the table (reasons why you have low self esteem) and then on the right construct the opposite view, the view that the most successful version of yourself would have.

Challenge those thoughts on the left and identify the positive ways your dream character would act instead.

How To Improve Your Self Love In 20 Minutes

I wanted to go into further detail on this topic, so here are 7 further tips to help you to improve your self love.

1: Self Love Journalling Prompt

When you journal in the morning as part of your routine, instead of doing your gratitude journal and writing 3 things you are grateful for, switch it up for two weeks.

Write down **3 things you love about yourself** in your journal instead.

2: Self Love Journalling Idea 2

Write down every morning:

- One thing you love about your body
- One thing you love about your personality
- One thing you love about what you have accomplished

3: Self Love Journaling Idea 3

Write down every morning for a week:

- 10 ways I'm the best and 10 strengths.

4: Write A Love Letter To Yourself

Write a letter to yourself, thanking yourself and explaining how much you love yourself.

Maybe you love yourself for staying consistent. For always believing in yourself. Maybe you love yourself for the work you put in a few years ago that got you to where you are now.

Really sit and think, and eventually the words will flow out onto the page, and you will realise there is a lot you love about yourself.

5: Speak To Yourself With Love and Respect

Talk to yourself only with love and respect.

Repeat the affirmations:

"I am as precious as any other person."

"I am going to be the greatest of all time."

6: Achieve the Body You Actually Want

"Become the person you said you were going to be."

This is going to help you to love yourself a whole lot more. Work with a trainer or seek mentorship, and simply stay consistent every day with your fitness until you love your body.

7: Look Good, Smell Good Everyday

Keep your hair cut and everything nicely shaven.

A small step, but I do this a lot. Even if I am not going out anywhere nice, I still shave and wear cologne.

It is simply the habit of someone that loves themselves to look after themselves. Never let this slip, even though it seems like a small thing.

If you read the *Self Esteem Workbook* by Glenn R, you realise that grooming yourself

and dressing well works very well for this kind of thing.

There's something about holding yourself to a high standard that just **works**.

Final Thoughts On Self Love / Self Esteem

Self-esteem is really **valuable** to build. It helps you develop real confidence and move through life in a stronger way.

There will be moments where you have to build yourself up, hype yourself up, and stay mentally sharp to secure a bright future.

Positive self-talk and a strong self-image are what help you do that.

A lot of people focus on solving mental barriers such as depression or anxiety, and then focus on getting into shape. And yes, that takes them maybe 60% of the way to a good life.

But you can still feel **negative** even when all of that is in place.

Confidence, self-love, believing in your ability to do anything—to lead, to inspire, to create the life you want—that's where you start to live a full life. Life opens up after you reach this level.

Being "not depressed" or "not anxious," is really just the **baseline**. And I can relate to that, because sometimes life throws us a curveball and we have to take things back to basics.

Everything could be going great, and then something goes wrong and we have that bad day again where we feel like we are back to **square** one. This can happen thousands of times over the course of our life.

But when we do bounce back, the goal is more than just settling for "OK."

The bare **minimum** won't drive you to the life you really want to live. We all want to feel fulfilled and happy beyond just surviving.

We want to genuinely love ourselves and work towards **supreme** confidence in all that we do. Imagine living with self love consistently, year-round.

The difference between people who actually build this life and those who don't is simple: **action.** Daily action.

If you struggle with self love or the way you talk to yourself, then start taking **action** and begin the exercises I've shown you.

That's what's going to move you toward a better version of yourself. It takes practice and time.

Once you take that step in the right direction with your self-talk, and once you learn how to build up self-love and maintain it, you start to feel **amazing**.

Learning to be friends with yourself and not enemies with yourself is an amazing skill to have. Hype yourself up in times of great difficulty. Know how to have a sense of humor when things don't go your way, and don't let things knock you into believing you are not capable of the very best.

You will eventually find it hard to go back to negative self talk because you will love the feeling of being your own number one supporter.

Whenever you need a boost, the exercises above and the way you speak to yourself will be what bring you back into alignment with your true self.

Depression

Depression is a tough area to coach, because it can have many potential causes. With most other life coaching issues, there are a handful of key fixes I know will reliably work. Depression is different. It rarely bends to a single solution.

People often need to apply multiple lifestyle habits and mindset shifts — and crucially, get all of them working together at once — before they see lasting change. That process takes time. But it is absolutely worth it.

Therapy and medication are legitimate options for many people, and the first step should always be a conversation with a medical professional. What I want to talk about here is everything that sits alongside that. Because medicine is one piece of the puzzle — an important one — but it is not the whole picture. The small habits we build to achieve greatness into our daily lives are just as important as anything a doctor can prescribe.

Depression can often be understood as a case of more things going wrong in your life than right. More negative inputs than positive ones. And that means it can be

shifted — not overnight, and not with one magic fix, but through the consistent, deliberate stacking of better choices.

Even if your routine is flawless, life will still occasionally throw something at you that knocks you sideways. Trauma doesn't care how many self-help books you've read or how perfect your routine is. That is OK and happens from time to time. It happens to the best of us.

But when we follow specific success strategies to build positive momentum into our lives, not only do we achieve happiness and minimize day to day chances of depression, but we have the best chance of successfully navigating those truly difficult moments in life, and the bounce back is a lot easier.

You would be surprised how fast a bounce back could be when the correct areas are addressed.

Depression is so complex precisely because the causes are so varied and so personal — but I have found that once those causes are genuinely identified and addressed, depression can resolve itself faster than people expect.

Sometimes it happens in a matter of days, usually in cases where negative life circumstances suddenly improve. Other times, it takes longer to feel fully yourself again, in a slow build up of positive habits and lifestyle changes.

Both are normal. Whether it's trauma, poor lifestyle, a lack of purpose or confidence,

some way, some how, you can figure out a way to grow. You can figure out the rignt way to live your life and achieve happiness.

What follows are the principles I return to again and again with clients. Apply them. Stack them. Give them time. And you will learn what it takes to motivate yourself day in, day out, week after week, month after month, year after year against any symptoms that don't serve you in life.

Wake up every day and apply your best foot forward, and you will land exactly where you need to be.

10 Tips To Help With Depression

Tip 1: Depression Is A Case Of Positive Momentum

You cannot fully protect yourself from the fact that life, at times, will be brutal. That is simply the deal.

"We can never 100% protect ourselves from the fact that sometimes, life can throw us one big roller coaster ride that causes our mental health to slip."

But mental health is about momentum — and momentum can be built.

If you invest consistently in positive habits and daily self-care, what you are really doing is charging a reserve battery. So when the hard times hit — and they will — you have something to draw from. You are not

starting from zero. You have 200 days of solid **routine** behind you, and habits that have been wired in don't simply vanish the moment things get difficult.

Think about it this way: if you have one terrible day in a week, but the other six days were lived well — exercise, purpose, connection, discipline — how much damage can that one bad day really do? You stay afloat. More than afloat.

If you build positive momentum so far in one direction, choosing to be consistent with positive habits and self care daily, then when the negative life events happen, you have so much **positive momentum** built up in your life, that you are able to stay positive.

Essentially your battery of positivity is fully charged, it might get drained down to 70 or 80%, but because you are fully charged, and

full of forward momentum, you won't hit 0% and shut down.

Outside of genuine unresolved trauma, serious grief, or severe life circumstances, I have found that depression is — at its core — largely a **lifestyle** issue. That is not a dismissal. That is actually good news. Because lifestyle can be changed.

Let's build yours into something that makes depression hard to sustain.

Tip 2: Setting Up Your Lifestyle To Be Depression Proof

If someone doesn't go to the gym for a few days, doesn't practice positive habits,

doesn't have a good routine, stays indoors all the time, smokes drinks or uses drugs, they are **very likely** to tell me they are depressed.

They often tell me they are only drinking, smoking, and staying indoors because they are depressed. But really, it is because they are doing these things that they are depressed.

They create an endless cycle within themselves.

The fix is this:

- Direct the person / yourself away from substance use.

- Directing the person/ yourself to a healthy diet.
- Direct the person / yourself to work out daily. BOTH Cardio and Weight Training
- Direct the person / yourself to leave the house daily.
- Directing the person towards a habit tracker, ideally with 4 non negotiable habits of:
- Reading 1 page minimum daily.
- Meditation 1 minute minimum daily.
- Exercise in any form daily, even the bare minimum.
- Gratitude Journalling Daily (3 things you are grateful for)

- Direct the person / yourself towards a positive morning and evening routine where there is an established ritual of gratitude or positive self talk. For example, gratitude journaling in the morning, and then in the evening time there is the option for positive manifestations and listening to a positive self talk audios.

- Direct the person to consume positive things, positive music, and great self help books.

- Construct an audit of what you / they actually follow on Instagram, what you / they watch and consume in spare time. Limit anything negative that doesn't serve positive thinking.

This is all scientifically proven tips that when added together, form the basis of a very positive routine that will benefit mental health and reduce the chances of depression.

Tip 3: Find Your Purpose

If a person tells me they **hate** their job, they will likely also tell me they are depressed. Depression can be an issue with a Lack Of Purpose.

I encourage a person to find their purpose and work towards a consistent job in a field they love. This can be a **big** win.

I have actually created an entire separate section on Lack Of Purpose as I felt it was

deserving of more detail. See the section on "Lack Of Purpose" for valuable insights on how to deal with this issue.

If a person starts a new course, a new **direction** in life, a new university degree or a new start in a new area, I have found their depression can almost **disappear** overnight. They get excited and engaged with a new chapter in their life!

Do not doubt the power of **committing** and **applying** yourself to something new. Sometimes it's that feeling of waking up excited, following a new dream or purpose, that can completely remove depression from your mind.

Challenging yourself to be a better person, and employing yourself in something where

everyday you are busy following your dreams, can really help.

"Purpose is rocket fuel. working towards something you believe in, something that challenges you, something that feels like it matters — is one of the most powerful antidepressants in existence."

It is scientifically proven that those who stay **busy** in their day to day, as long as they are working balanced shifts with a reasonable job satisfaction, are less likely to have depression than someone staying at home with no employment or daily goal.

Humans have a need for relaxation and self care at times, however:

We do not want to sit down with no purpose and do nothing!

Many scientists find that what is even **more likely** to help with depression than even a job with a medium high satisfaction, is a high satisfaction job working towards achieving your dreams that you are confident you have been put on this planet to do.

Seek to find **this**, and getting up out of bed in the morning becomes easier, and the days become full of joy and even though there is hard work to be done.

General life satisfaction, knowing where you are going in life, and being **self assured** of your life vision, is one of the best things you can do to destroy any negative forms of doubt, overthinking and depressed states of mind.

Tip 4: Become A Person Of Your Word

I would always encourage depressed clients to become people of their word. This can **really** help. Setting yourself targets and being a person of your word and fulfilling them can help you a lot.

This builds up an **identity** within you of being **strong**. The more you find yourself sticking to your word, the more you say you're going to do something and you **truly** believe it.

You end up becoming someone who says they are going to do something and then does it, and this brings a very **powerful** feeling.

You begin to hold yourself in **high regard**, and love yourself, and believe you can do things. And this is deeply connected to

depression, because at the core of a lot of depression is a person who has stopped believing they are **capable**.

They don't trust themselves anymore. So when you start becoming a person of your word, you start to **trust** yourself as a person who can actually conquer the challenge of depression too.

This act can even build **self love**, you believe in yourself and don't ever see yourself as a failure. You believe in your ability to get things done.

This is all great, even for helping you believe in your ability that you will bounce back and do the work to gain control of your mental state again.

Tip 5: Regular Movement

Move your body, and construct your life in ways that this is a regular occurrence.

Regular exercise has effects comparable to medication for depression. I myself, as a very positive person in a good place in my life, would still likely feel a minor depression coming on if I didn't workout for more than a week.

"Your body is designed to be used. When it isn't, it communicates that clearly."

Even 30 minutes to 1 hour of Zone 2 exercise per day, is enough to act as an antidepressant. Zone 2 exercise is where you go to about a 7 out of 10 intensity.

Essentially a light jog that somewhat challenges you, but doesn't **exhaust** you, for half an hour a day.

Zone 2 exercise is great. But what is even more important is weight training. If you add in weight training as well, you are doing something further for your body.

Weight training is going to release **hormones** within your body. This is the style of training that when you miss for more than a week, you start to feel that slow, sluggish, tired feeling.

You start to feel something is wrong. If you don't believe me, try it. Commit to the gym for 6 months, become a regular goer of the gym, and then try to not weight train for 2 weeks straight. You will feel a difference.

Start with light movement, and continue to build your intensity daily.

Tip 6: Seek Social Connection

Direct yourself to a social life. Seek social connection **even when you don't want to.** There will be many times you don't want to.

In this situation, repeat to yourself: "Make the effort."

Humans are **wired** for connection.

Depression thrives on isolation. Seek out friends and join a class. Do the work on this even when you don't want to. Isolation is one of the key accelerators of depression.

Tip 7: Take Action

Depression thrives on **inaction**. Inaction and sitting there sad doesn't help in the long run if it is all you do for long periods of time.

It is OK to be **sad**, and process traumas and difficulties, but when we sit there for prolonged periods of time without taking action, it doesn't make anything better.

Forming solutions and taking action are what put you on the path to the life you deserve to live.

Beating depression isn't just about **one** magic habit fix, it's about stacking many scientifically proven habits together to build your momentum over time.

This momentum will reach a point one day where its hard for you to feel negative for

long periods of time, because your life is **overall** so positive.

You probably are not going to want to do all of these habits **all the time,** but it is the stacking of these selected habits consistently that will bring results.

Depression isn't just a switch that flips between "im depressed" and "im happy."

Momentum takes time to build in either direction. The **more** areas of self improvement that you have worked on, the **more** momentum you build.

Areas such as:

- Improving Self Love
- Improving Positive Self Talk
- Working Towards A Positive Dream Larger Than Yourself
- Daily Habits Tracker
- Working On Discipline
- Sticking To Your Word
- Daily Weight Training
- Daily Zone 2 Exercise
- Self Development Books And Courses
- Improving Confidence and Public Speaking

- Consuming Positivity
- Self Care
- Meditation
- Martial Arts

These are all ways of charging that **positive battery** within you, of pushing your momentum towards a great attitude and life.

There is always **something** in that list to work on, make sure you put your head down and work hard!

Tip 8: Not Having 100% Motivation In The Beginning Is Common

If you are reading these tips or trying to help someone with these tips, if the person in question feels 100% motivation and really excited to start their journey to better mental health, that's great...

But the **reality** is, most people with depression don't feel too motivated to make these changes in the beginning.

Feelings of intense motivation are not **guaranteed** at all, and these feelings can be slow to build in the beginning. But that is OK. A slow start is actually common and normal when it comes to feeling motivated during depressive episodes. What is **important** is to start.

Action comes **before** motivation, not after! Some days motivation will magically come to you and shoot you out of bed in a good mood.

But most days we have to **create** our own motivation. We have to actually get up and push ourselves hard on many days.

This is one thing I noticed in my own life. I have my habit trackers set, and I don't actually feel **motivated** to do my tasks most of the time.

But once I do them, I get that **satisfying feeling** of seeing everything ticked off by mid day.

I **then** feel the motivation. After. I feel motivated by what I accomplished, and then that leads to more motivation to do more amazing things, and I can enjoy my day!

The motivation will come more strongly **after you complete the tasks.** After you successfully produce the feeling of a hard days work that has been completed, you then feel motivation to do a little more that day.

A few days and eventually weeks like that can lead to motivation becoming a more consistent feeling. And that is ideal for your mental health.

You can actually get addicted to that good feeling of a productive days work. But it still comes and goes for everyone.

Motivation is really unlikely to arrive in the early stages of depression, but rather it is built up by constantly attacking what you don't want to do and realising your life is actually better because of it.

Get **addicted** to ticking off your tasks and making a positive change to yourself. Give it a chance.

Motivation even for a normal person isn't **constant**. But it is at least **present** some of the time. For a depressed person, it can often be **nonexistant** in the beginning.

This is ok, take a big brave step to do what you **don't** want to do and stick to your newly created habits for a few consecutive weeks, motivation will return.

These habits will get easier over time, in the same way going to the gym gets easier after the first 3 or 4 sessions.

The initial period of settling into these new routines and pushing your comfort zone is hard, but you can expect to see slow results

in as little as 2 weeks. Stick with it, because you are on the verge of changing your life.

The days of challenging yourself. **conquering** your fears, and completing all the hard work you didn't want to do consistently over multiple days are going to make a big difference.

Then the motivation will come. The happiness will come. The change will come.

Tip 9: Pick Pride Over Motivation

Motivation can be a great feeling and we all want more of it. But as I said, even for a normal person with great mental health, motivation doesn't always come.

I want you to consider picking pride over motivation always.

If you look after yourself, stick to your word and complete your tasks, even when you don't feel like them, you will be left with a great feeling. That great feeling is being **proud** of yourself.

If you complete your tasks even **without** motivation, you build an extreme amount of pride over time. You build pride and strength of character by doing difficult things that put your life in a better position, despite the challenges you face.

A lot of people get **depressed** when they give up doing all of the stuff they know they should be doing for themselves. The basic things they know they need to do to look after themselves.

They avoid the hard stuff, and wait for motivation to come instead of doing the uncomfortable things they know they need to do.

It leads to them feeling that they aren't **proud** of themselves anymore especially when they aren't even doing the basic tasks to look after themselves.

Once they start to look after themselves even when they have to push through great difficulty, they build that pride again.

Pick pride over motivation and do the hard things. The feeling of pride is a powerful **antidepressant**.

Tip 10: "You get out what you put in."

The more you work on yourself, the more you are going to see incredible results,

No situation is stronger than a made up mind to put in the work, no life is too far off course to be steered back.

Every single type of person **can** turn this around. I have seen it with my own eyes. Rock bottom can become the **foundation** for something **extraordinary**.

You cancome back from rock bottom with more than you started with. You can return a thousand times better.

No one said this will be easy, but the results are worth the discomfort. If everyday is the **same** for you and nothing changes, it is lifes

way of telling you that it is time to make a change.

You need to **work hard**, as well all do in life, to drive yourself closer to the outcomes that you want to see.

Everyone is working at something. Your challenge to work on is currently your mental health. Positivity takes work and a lot of people don't realize this. But it is those that go through experiences such as depression, who actually find a deeper **treasure**.

Because when they come out the other side, they usually are the people who take working on positivity every day the most **seriously**. People who have been through a great deal and come out the other side usually don't

mess around with the idea that mental health should not be worked on.

They put the work in towards their mental health more than others, because they don't want to return to the place they have came from, and eventually they become some of the **highest achieving** people in the world with **above average** mental health.

Nearly every successfiul life coach I ever met always had a backstory of depressive times and lows, challenge simply improves us as humans.

You can come out the other side taking your mental health and positivity so much more seriously, or you can stay average.

Decide which person you want to be. Positive options are on the other side of action.

Some people work hard at sales, some people work hard at becoming rich, but those that find the consistent time to work at building positive mental health with 100% of their power, are those who unlock the key to **happiness** long term.

If you commit to the success strategies listed above, and work to 100% of your ability, you will achieve **great** things, not only in your mental health, but in your life thereafter.

The most **important** thing to do is get up and look at what positive things you have to do

today to move you closer to where you want to be… and then have the courage to start.

Only focus on the best things you could possibly do today to build you towards where you need to be in life. And focus on the best things you could possibly do tomorrow too. Keep this attitude every day for the rest of your life, and you will end up in great places.

Don't worry about slow starts, don't worry if you feel like a beginner everyday, just practice developing your skills, talents and positive mindset, and watch the results flow into your life.

"Action is the foundational key to all success."

Task For Getting Back On Track

If you **combine** seeing yourself as a person of your word, looking after your body, exercising regularly, eating well, sleeping well, practicing positive habits and routines in the morning with things like gratitude journaling and meditation, you have a strong chance at **mastering** your thoughts.

If you promote **positive** self talk and take up positive manifestation at night, if you take up the positive life direction of gaining meaningful employment, reading self improvement books, and doing the healthy things for yourself, you will see amazing progress.

I suggest a quick **routine** for those who want some **actionable steps** to get back on track. If you want a simple starting plan.

Start with this daily baseline:

10 - 20 minute walk with positive music playing (sunlight)

Shower + get dressed properly and apply cologne even if you are not going anywhere nice (pride)

Weight training workout at the gym minimum 30 minutes. (endorphins and hormones)

Apply the habit tracker from my first book:

Gratitude journaling - 3 things grateful for minimum

Meditation - 30 seconds minimum

Reading - 1 page minimum

Exercise - 1 repetition minimum

1 social interaction (even small - ask someone how their day went)

Try to sleep at a consistent time

Do this for 7 days and you will feel a shift.

Final Thoughts: Positive Momentum Equals Success

With the knowledge that you can go through depression and come out the other side as an achiever of amazing things in life, and as a person who takes even better care for your mental health than when you started, I want you to ask yourself one question.

Which kind of person do you want to be? Will you be the kind of person who looks after your mental health and takes it serious? Or the person who stays the same.

Action changes everything. I hope this chapter helps you to gain some ideas of how you can build immense momentum in your mindset. There is further help for each and every common life coaching issue in this book that can help you to build ultimate progress in your mental health.

Consult the other sections of this book, to fix overthinking, anxiety, to process your traumas, fix your attention span, and you have the best chance at bringing yourself or another through!

I want to end by saying, you make a really brave choice to want to help someone here,

or to even help yourself here! The person you become after putting in the work daily, is going to be proud of the work you put in today.

Make the right choices, and become someone who made the decision to become their absolute best. Wake up every day and do your best.

Despite the ocassional trauma coming along that we need to work through and take time to heal from, hapiness is a habit that can be cultivated and

We should all strive to achieve the very best state of mind and truly find happiness.

Lack Of Purpose

"A day without purpose is a day wasted."

The important thing in life is to have a **goal** in life, something you enjoy. A purpose doing what you love has been scientifically found to be a magic cure against depression, low self esteem and a large **variety** of other life issues that I commonly coach.

It is scientifically proven that you will become less depressed, and that all other life issues are 30% less likely to affect your mental health, if you are waking up in the morning with a clear purpose in mind and following it.

Viktor E Frankl was a psychiatric doctor who worked with a lot of patients. He was actually a survivor of some of the most **brutal** concentration camps of World War 2. He dealt with many other survivors and helped them improve their lives after the war through therapy.

It is safe to say Viktor had seen a lot of **depression**. Frankl himself said he noticed a trend in depression amongst his patients. Those that had employment, were 50% less likely to be depressed than those that didn't.

Having something to do, something to wake up to in the morning, even if it was hard, tough work, reduced depression in a **majority** of cases.

Now as we imagine, if a person really hates the job, that can only last for so long, and they still may feel a sense of **sadness**.

But if that person then enters a job that highly satisfies them, their levels of happiness go up by a larger percentage.

The final layer to this, is that if a person finds a job that no one can pull them away from, a purpose so great that they truly believe in, a job they can wake up to every day 100% certain that was the job they were put on the world to do.

The chances of depression become almost **nonexistent**.

People were able to lose family members, go through break ups, go through chronic pain, and still managed to feel satisfied in life.

They tended to actually have better **relationships**, because they were working towards what they loved and this allowed them to be in a better mood for their partner, they tended to have better **concentration** spans, and they tended to have significantly better mental health.

So how do we find it? The main **question** I would ask someone struggling with this is:

“Ask yourself, if I had unlimited money in the bank tomorrow, and I didn't have to work, what would I work on every day?”

That can give you a solid answer. Some people will say: “I wouldn’t work. I would do nothing.” But I try and get them to look **deeper**. If they did have to work, but they could choose the job what would it be?

Many people go to the gym, but they go to the gym with the “result” in mind to get in shape. They are doing it for the results, not because of a love for the gym.

Whereas, some people go to the gym simply because they love it and find it fun. They would do it anyway without the results.

They have what is called a core desire to go to the gym.

Try to think of something you would still do in your day anyway, not just for money, not

for results or because it keeps you healthy. What would you simply do anyway?

A good indication you have found your purpose is when you can answer this question with a yes:

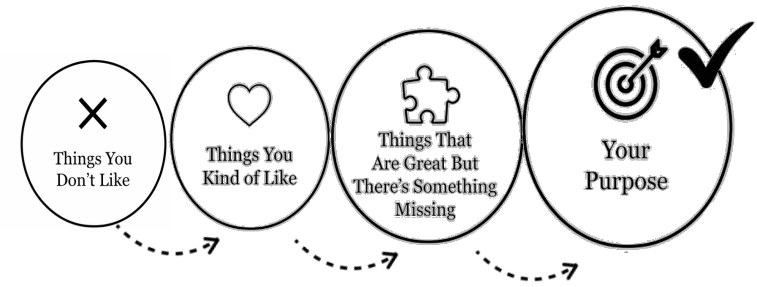
Do you wake up every morning excited to go straight into this thing, or you literally can't sleep because your so excited to work on it? This is a sign it is your purpose. I am going to give you 5 tips to help you make sure you are building towards your purpose.

5 Tips To Find Your True Purpose

1. **Pick the thing you enjoy the most at this current time in your life and start to build on that**

The thing you enjoy **the most** is important here. Don't go for something that you "kind of" like.

The Stages Of Finding Purpose



The **true** purpose of your life isn't just what you enjoy. We enjoy many things. I enjoyed playing music for example. I actually thought it could be my purpose for a while.

I did a music degree and got quite good at playing. Music appealed to my creative side which I always had. I could sit and play piano for 8 hours straight every day.

Some people say “pick the thing you can do for 8 hours a day and not get bored.” Ok, that's a good start. I had this focus. But I wasn’t 100% happy. Something didn’t feel **right**.

I couldn’t help but feel a lack of physicality, I love to be physical daily, and I often felt a little **isolated** playing music, I was in dark music studios, mixing songs, with no windows
I started to feel like.. Music was enjoyable, and I could focus on it for

hours, it wasn't **terrible**, it was actually quite good, and a real hobby.

Life wouldn't be **bad** pursuing a career in music, but was it really my true passion? In life, do I want to go for "not bad" or "my ultimate dream?"

I asked myself: could I do music even if the money wasn't good? And it didn't seem enough for me. Financially, physically, and mentally I wanted more.

It's crazy how what we feel is our purpose can be influenced so much by our childhoods.

I believe if I had the upbringing of someone whose whole family were musicians, who led me to believe from a young age that I would

always be a musician and it was my destiny,
I would have actually taken the music route.

But my experience was different.

I remember my mother had always predicted
in my future that I would help people.
I also had a bunch of teachers who noticed
my talents for creative writing.

One teacher would always put her hand on
her head and bless me, saying a prayer for
me and telling me I would write amazing
books one day.

This was enough for me to feel like I needed
to **switch** paths away from music.

I got tired of the lack of money from music. So, I then tackled another piece of the puzzle when it comes to finding a purpose. **Money.**

I switched into IT. I enjoyed it. The feeling of creative problem solving with all the code across my screen was good.

The feeling of being able to relax and sit down and work from home was good. And financially I would have been set if I pursued this path. This was a **better** choice than my previous choice.

But again, there was something missing. There was no physicality, and I didn't have that feeling of helping people truly. It wasn't just about helping people, but I asked myself: "is this the problem I truly want to be

helping people with for the rest of my life? Code on a computer?"

To some people the answer is yes, and that is amazing. Again, this career is actually very enjoyable and rewarding. It is high;y intellectual and without coders we wouldn't be able to solve some of the worlds biggest problems. It wouldn't have been a bad life.

However, after a long journey of experimentation, it was finally fitness coaching that I gravitated towards.

I had already at this point been waking up everyday for about a year, writing books about life coaching, going to the gym and pursuing my Personal Trainer qualifications.

This was all after days working in IT and offices.

Here is a tip for you: If you are tired from a days work, and you still find the energy afterwards to work towards something else, and you would rather work towards that something else then to simply the read resources that would progress you in your current career, its a good sign that whatever you are doing after work is where you actually want to end up.

I remember I used to hide under the desk at work to pursue a better future in the things I actually loved.

Fitness appealed to me the most, I tried to do IT just to keep my father happy. I did all my qualifications, but after every day I just

kept going back to fitness and mindset coaching. I would wake up everyday and feel it was my purpose.

I got my creative side flowing by creating unique fitness programmes for people, and also writing my coaching books. I was writing books and using my creativity like how my school teachers predicted.

I was helping people like how my mother predicted too, and overall that feeling of waking up every day with the certainty that I am helping lives and that I am following the right path has never left me.

Ok, the truth is, of course with starting a business there are times of doubt. Times where the money isn't coming in, you are sleeping on a sofa unable to scrape by,

wondering if you made the right choice to leave your old job. That happens for sure because starting a business and following your dreams comes with setbacks and obstacles.

But overall after a day or so of doubt, after each and every time, I would come back to fitness as my dream. The doubt never lasted long.

I tell you this story so you can understand your purpose isn't just something you like, it is something you love. It has to tick many boxes. Our purpose is a core desire, and it is not to be taken lightly.

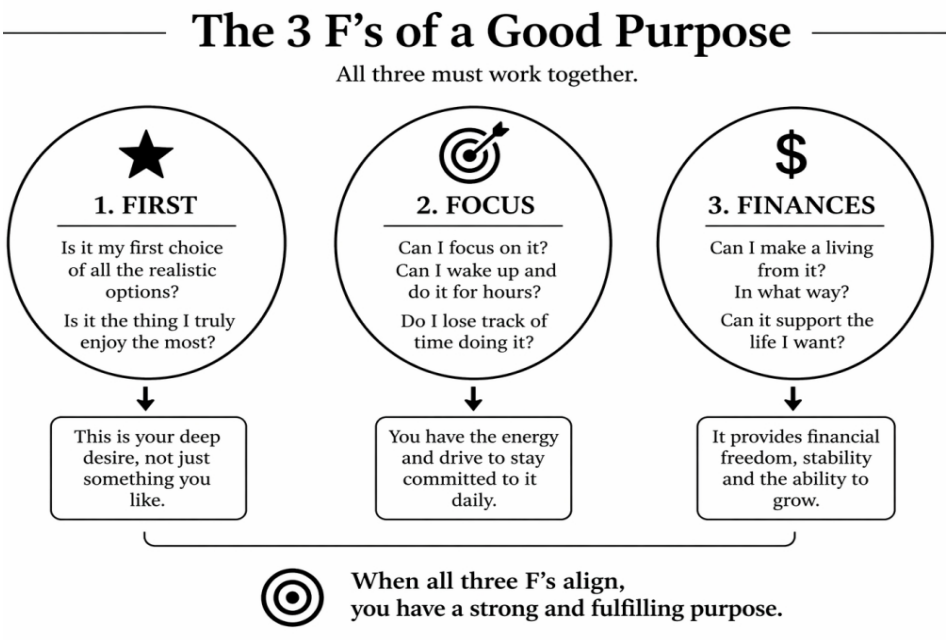
Tip 2: Consider The 3 Elements Of a Good Purpose.

Building on what I am saying above, it isn't enough just to have **one** element in place when it comes to your purpose.

To me the 3 elements of a good purpose are what I call the 3 F's, and all must be ticked:

First: Is it my first choice of all the realistic options? Is it the thing I truly enjoy the most?
Focus: Can I focus on it? Can I wake up and do it for hours?
Finances: Can I make a living from it? In what way?

A passion is just a passion. A true purpose hits you on **all** levels and completes the three F's above.



Ask yourself if you can wake up daily and **love** it. Does it tick every box for you in terms of the three F's above, and can you find a way to do this daily and earn a good living from it.

That is what strikes the balance point of a strong purpose.

The **finances** actually are **important**. Try to do what you love and get paid a lot for it if you can!

Tip 3: Purpose Is Not Something That's Revealed Straight Away

As you can tell from my own story above, it took me **a lot** of testing out what worked and what didn't, before I found myself.

Work hard at the things that truly **inspire** you. Develop your skills and talents every day.

If you can't think of anything worthwhile to pursue or it feels like your interests are pointless, then keep working on the other areas of this book and follow the recommended reading pages, there are some books that may help.

You will get there in the end!

Tip 4: Sometimes Your Purpose Can Change

That's okay. This Is normal. Once every 4 years or so, you may discover that you wish to switch directions in life. Through following your dreams and following your purpose, life sometimes puts in your heart and reveals to you that your true purpose was actually meant to be something different all along.

You then take the skills that you learned working towards your old dream, which you definitely needed to learn to prepare yourself for this new chapter, and are in the perfect position now to chase your newfound purpose.

Nothing in this life is by accident, following your dreams always results in you landing exactly where you need to be, even when the dreams change, there is no wasted time.

You have learned and developed exactly the skills required to achieve the next evolution of your purpose.

Tip 5: You Are Ahead Of Others For Even Caring About This

If you are not sure of your purpose and frustrated that you can't find it. That's actually a **good** thing. Because it shows you care about finding it.

You are probably going to get further than someone who never considered this. The message to you will arrive one day, because you are looking for it with your whole heart, and that is the most important thing, that you care.

Tip 6: It's Okay To Get It Wrong

I know picking a purpose means you almost have to roll the dice and go all in on

something. As a young person especially, maybe your scared of picking the wrong thing to go all in on. Keep on trying things out, but know this:

A focused, disciplined pursuit of any goal is never going to be a waste. Pick what is most inclined in your heart at the time, and the hard work will pay off. Hard work always does. Your core desire will always lead you in the right direction.

Wake up everyday and spend that day doing every task you possibly can to follow your core desire.

Exercise To Find An Enjoyable Career

When I get a client who comes to me with a lack of certainty about a purposeful career that they will find fulfilling in life, there is an exercise I like to use with them. I tell them:

Write out the top 10 activities you love to do the most in your day. The ideal things, projects, and activities you would spend your ideal day doing.

The idea is then to list the top 5 jobs that will allow you to include the most of these enjoyable activities that you love working on in your day to day life, rank them 1 to 5 by how many of these activities this job will let you complete in your day, and strongly

consider the job that allows you to enjoy the most of them at once.

If you don't enjoy what you are doing, you won't tend to be very good at it, or find long term happiness there. We spend the majority of our lives at work, and this way you are spending most of your days doing the most of what you enjoy!

If money is strictly the objective, there is no shortage of careers to suggest. Business Consultancy, Computing & IT, Law, & Finance are jobs I could recommend to a young person. But when trying to find a fulfilling enjoyable career, the above exercise can be a great one to put you on the right path.

Consider if you require socializing or isolation, working on computers or with numbers, or if you need physical or creative work to feel good. This is an ongoing process.

Things can take some time, but work towards finding a job that lets you work on the most of your passions, fits your needs and pays the bills.

The final thing I want to explain to you, is that we live in a world where any hobby or skill can be monetized.

For example, 20 years ago, if you loved basketball, the only option would be to become a professional basketball player and earn a ton, or become a commentator or coach where you wouldn't earn as much.

But, now we live in a world where, a teenager can make internet videos of him practicing his shot into a basketball hoop, and sell courses on the internet to other teenagers to make more than a lawyer would.

There is a lot of opportunity nowadays to follow your passions. It may take a few jobs before you find the right one for you, but if you have been stuck in the same place and know it isn't your dream job or true purpose, as long as you have something else in line that will financially sustain you, take that journey of experimentation over staying in the same place!

If you hate it you can usually always go back or find a similar job in that same industry.

Finding whats best for you can take a while, so it's best to start as soon as possible. You will know when you feel fulfilled.

Life will feel good, you enjoy the job most days, and many days you wake up raring to go, excited to work on upskilling and chasing your dream.

I also encourage young people to be reading business books from when they are very young so they have a greater understanding of the opportunities available to them.

Try to identify the things you are most passionate about and work on them daily. Eventually everything will fall into place!

Overthinking

Why is it that **some** people can put their head on the pillow and fall asleep within minutes, whilst others lie there for hours, **trapped** inside their own heads?
This is one of the most **common** issues I see in clients. Most people have overactive brains, and most tend to overthink at night.

But what if I told you that we can direct our overthinking towards **productive** outcomes and use it as a superpower for success?

I remember a client from Finland who reached out to tell me he was a successful young salesman who was doing well in life.

And he was. He trained consistently, had built a striking physique, was making serious money in business at only nineteen, and — by his own account — was genuinely enjoying the grind. **Sipping sparkling champagne on the balcony, he was enjoying** the good life.

He felt happy. Disciplined. Proud of outperforming most people his age.

However, he said that at night, his **inner voice** got to him. He would often think about the worst possible scenarios happening. He would often think: "but what if I fail?"

He would consider all the negative outcomes. He would ask himself things like: "but what if I can't do this? What if I mess up?"

"What if I'm a fluke and I don't make as much next month?"

I felt sad for him because he was a successful young man with real potential to expand his greatness, but when it came to sleeping at night, his mind self-destructed. He was in shape. He was winning. But his mind wasn't working for him.

So how did I help him?

First, I told him he was a young man with great potential and real discipline across many areas of his life.

I asked him to consider that he had already won half the battle — because he had something most people spend their entire lives searching for. Discipline.

I told him that whilst he applied that discipline to his sales calls and his gym sessions, he could apply that same discipline to his thoughts at night.

I told him he wasn't alone, as a person who suffered with ADHD symptoms my whole life, I too had racing thoughts that never seemed to switch off.

For some people, those thoughts never fully stop. But we can weaponise them — redirect them towards planning, towards positive thinking, towards manifesting what we want, towards productive routines at night.

The answer wasn't to stop his thoughts. It was to redirect them.
The same discipline we need to stick to a fitness diet, or to quit smoking, applies to our thoughts at night.

We have to tell ourselves sometimes: *"Let it go. This isn't serving me."* That can actually take more discipline than going to the gym or losing twenty pounds.

So Where Do We Redirect?

You're probably thinking I want you to lie there thinking about nothing, right?. Wrong. Nobody wants to stare at the ceiling in silence.

We have to direct the mind towards productive routines instead. Here is my step by step guide with 8 steps to prevent overthinking that I gave to this young man..

8 Tips To Prevent Overthinking

Tip 1: Write Down Your To Do List Before You Go To Bed

This stops you lying awake stressing about everything you need to do tomorrow. Getting it onto paper clears the mental load — and this has been scientifically proven to work.

Write it down and give yourself permission to let it go.

Tip 2: Show Discipline And Move On From Negative Thoughts.

Treat this with the same seriousness as your discipline in the gym. Notice you are caught

in a negative thought loop, and make the deliberate choice to move on — even when part of you wants to stay there.

The same way you are disciplined in the gym, you need to notice you are distracted by negative thought loops and make the disciplined choice to **move on**, even if you WANT to think about them.

Most people overthink at night and assume they are broken, or that they are the only people going through this issue. They are not.

It is extremely common. But it does take conscious effort to redirect these thoughts — which is exactly why most people fall asleep to Netflix instead.

The phone and the screen become a way to avoid sitting there in our own thoughts. The problem is that they interrupt sleep and solve nothing.

When really what we need to do is **lie down**, **relax** ourselves, and learn to direct our thoughts, and attention towards positive methods of thinking, not Netflix, not overthinking, but healthy manners of thought. Something productive.

Tip 3: Replace Negative Thoughts With Positive Visualizations Of You Achieving Your Goals

How do we do this? Firstly we picture a memory in our life that made us extremely happy.

It can be any positive memory, preferably an intensely happy one that made us really smile. This is whats known as our "**anchor memory**."

Take the positive feeling of your anchor memory in your mind and take a few deep breaths. When you inhale picture yourself inhaling positivity, and when you exhale picture yourself exhaling negativity.

Try to **smile**, this will boost your mood as you visualise.

Picture the same smile that was on your face and the happiness you felt in your anchor memory and now picture yourself smiling that same smile and

feeling that same happiness as you achieve all your current goals.

When you visualise, you need to visualise **vividly**, down to the **exact actions** you will take to achieve your goals, the sights, the smells, the feelings that you feel.

Visualise who is going to be in the room, visualise what you will say, **don't leave out any details.**

Only visualise things going in the best way they possibly can. Whatever your wildest dream is, picture yourself acting as the perfect character that would achieve those dreams with ease.

My positive **anchor** memory was me sending a football flying into the top right corner of the net, to score the

winning goal in football in my last day of secondary school.

This was the last football match we would ever play in school, and all the boys in my year took me onto their shoulders and I felt like I was surfing on the air, supported by my friends. I felt like a **winner**.

I took this same smile I felt in that moment, and pictured this **same smile** on my face as I achieved my future goals.

I pictured the **same** smile on my face as opened my Achieve Greatness gym, and smiled at my staff members happily as I opened multiple locations across multiple countries.

I would smile that same smile to the cleaners, the staff, talking to everyone and making them feel valued and happy, making sure everyone had development opportunities.

I pictured the clean, hygienic brand new smell of the black leather equipment and my logo everywhere, with big windows to let the sunset through with a skyline view..

That is how **vivid** your visualisation should be. You picture yourself already completing the action — so that when the day actually comes, it feels familiar, as though you have already ran through your dream character achieving victory in this situation in your mind.

Because of this, you have essentially **rehearsed** it in your mind, and are more likely to actually act that way on the day.

Even if you don't believe in these gurus who claim the act of manifestation will result in positive things being attracted to or handed down to you by forces unknown, you can still believe in the **science** behind visualisation.

For example, Conor McGregor used visualisation a lot. He would visualise the day of his fight. In vivid detail and always positively.

From how he would walk out to his music with extreme confidence, to the combos he would throw, to the exact punch he would throw to end it all.

Visualization can also work before job interviews. Visualise yourself going in and shaking the interviewers hand, and them absolutely **loving** you.

Them laughing at all your jokes, and you smoothly saying what the **best** possible version of yourself would say to land the job with flying colors, talking with extreme confidence, clarity, and being well received.

Don't be **humble**, visualise the **best** possible things and exactly what you want out of life. Visualise the exact process you will use to make this happen in as **much detail** as possible.

Only visualise the **positive**.

Scientifically, this is rehearsing and preparing you, you are practicing these situations in your mind and will be more likely to perform in an ideal manner on the day when you have **rehearsed** the **successful behaviour** in your head.

Tip 4: Make a Self Talk Audio Reaffirming Your Ultimate Goal In Life, Play It Back To Yourself, Then Reflect On It.

I took this idea from businessman **Grant Cardone**, who built a multi-million dollar property empire.

He asks: "who is more likely to achieve their goals — the person who writes them down **once** at the start of the year, or the person who reflects on them every single night?"

Having your ultimate goal **fresh** in your mind at all times helps you to take the day to day actions to get there, without getting distracted with meaningless things.

Grant Cardone said he wrote down his goals every night, as well as his personal wins of the day.

I take this concept a little bit further, firstly as I go to sleep I reflect on three things I am proud of.

It could be basic things like going to the dentist or booking a doctors appointment, these are **genuine** wins for me as they can be boring to do sometimes and I put them off often!

Instead of writing down my goal, as I am bed and winding down, I listen to a recording that I recorded of myself.

It is a self talk audio on my phone of me reaffirming my ultimate goal to myself.

I play it back at night and reflect on it before I sleep.

It reminds me of **where I am going** and winds me down at the same time. Make your

own. They are one of the best tools I know for ending the night well.

Tip 5: Manifest Everything You Want - Not What You Fear.

Thinking about what you want is positive thinking. Thinking about what you do not want is fearful thinking.

When you manifest and visualise positively at night, it is a far better use of your time than rehearsing every possible disaster.

Think about your goals as if you already have them. Feel **grateful** for them as if they have **already arrived**.

Ask for everything you truly want and don't be shy to ask for it all. The more power you put into this, the more will come back and the more use you will get out of the exercise.

Manifesting is simply a case of **believing** you have something, you can also use prayer if you are religious. The key is to truly believe luck is on your side.

Tip 6: Try Gratitude

In almost any situation of negative thought spiralling, this technique works as a positive alternative. Simply think of things you are grateful for. Gratitude simply works and is proven to have amazing mental health benefits in almost every scenario.

Tip 7: Remember That Sleep Is Your Duty As As a High Achiever.

A bad night's sleep interferes with the quality of everything you produce the next day.

I took this angle with my Finnish client because I knew he was the type who stayed up working and overthinking — and I knew that producing quality work mattered deeply to him.

He showed great **discipline** against drinking, against missing sessions, against taking the easy options in life. He had to bring that same discipline to his thoughts at night and replace them with productive behaviours.

His response was **immediate**. He saw exactly how the sleeplessness was affecting his schedule, his focus, and his output. That reframe changed everything, and helped him to change his ways.

Tip 8: Identify Genuine Traumas And Work Through Them

Later in this book there is a full section on processing traumas. We need to work through traumas so that we are not constantly thinking of them. Please visit the Traumas section.

Tip 9: Learn Meditation

You can block negative thoughts out entirely, but it takes a great deal of practice. One way of practicing this is Meditation.

Mediation works by focusing on your breath. You inhale the positivity, and exhale the negativity, and simply **focus** on your breath.

When you first start meditation, it is very hard, because your mind keeps drifting back to whatever is going on in the world and your daily life.

Draw your mind back to your breath every time you lose focus. Every time you **successfully** do this, you are training the muscle in your brain to focus in spite of distraction.

Over time you develop the ability to focus more, you can detect when you are getting distracted at work. You can **catch** yourself when you are getting distracted from positive thoughts, as well as when you are spiralling at night into thoughts that don't serve you.

You become very good at “switching off” and letting go.

I acknowledge that for many of us, it feels **satisfying** to "finish" a thought — to resolve our unfinished business, to consider every angle of an issue before we sleep at night.

Some people are even **addicted** to thinking about all the negatives of a situation because it feels to them like a preparation.

But ask yourself honestly: does chronically overthinking at night **actually** serve you?

The truth is, it doesn't feel good, there are clear weaknesses in this approach, and there are better ways to spend our time.

Just because you **want** to think about something doesn't mean you **should**.

The best advice I can give you is to ask yourself: "I want to think about this, but should I? Is it worth it, or should I let go?"

Deep down you know the answer. Meditation will help you to switch off and "let go" in these scenarios.

Make A Promise To Yourself

How I fixed my own overthinking was by making a promise to myself that I would not overthink things that did not matter.

I had a relationship where I would overthink every argument, every text message.

I would sit with my phone and not even press send. And I want to be honest about something — sometimes the only thing that forces a real change is when you have finally had enough.

When I left that relationship, I made a **promise** to myself I would never go back to that way of thinking. I read those old messages months later and barely recognised myself.

I am not saying you need to end your relationship. But sometimes you need to hit a low point before you make the change — or at least be honest with yourself that you have reached one.

So I want you to write down every way that overthinking negatively affects your life. Give yourself a **true picture** of the cost.

If you feel ready after seeing the cost of your overthinking, I want you to make a promise to yourself that you are going to be disciplined starting from today.

Conquering overthinking delivers more than just better sleep. Better sleep means better work, better training, better relationships, and better focus. And it carries over.

If you can **control** your thoughts at night — catch yourself slipping, and set yourself straight — you will find that same ability showing up during the day, which is a great victory.

You will catch distraction at your desk. You will steady yourself before a difficult conversation. You will have more command over what you allow into your mind. That command is going to rapidly develop every area of your mental health.

There are two more rules I would like you to live by whenever possible.

BUCKET RULE #1
You don't get to worry about things that hasn't happened yet.

BUCKET RULE #2
You don't get to worry about things that are out of your control.

Final Thoughts On Overthinking

Overthinking is not the enemy. Misdirected overthinking is.

To conclude — overthinking can actually be a positive force if we learn to target it towards positive plans, business ideas, and visualisations of the future we want.

It takes discipline to redirect negative thoughts. But that is exactly what we have to learn to do.

Through applying yourself, you can direct any racing, hyperactive nighttime thoughts towards more productive uses of your time:

- Gratitude
- Positive visualisation of you winning and accomplishing your dreams
- Self-talk audios
- Positive affirmations
- Manifesting what you want in life and business — not what you fear

Once you get used to applying these tools, it actually becomes something you look forward to.

Your Goal This Week

If you struggle with overthinking, your goal this week is simple: tonight, before bed, write down your tasks, your unfinished thoughts. Get it onto paper. Then pick one technique from this chapter and practice it in place of the overthinking spiral. Just one. That is enough to begin.

This is going to help you spend your evenings **productively**, sleep deeply, and gain real control over something most people once believed couldn't be controlled.

Imagine a world where you have a grip on this. Where you control your thoughts, not the other way around.

Through discipline, maturity, and choosing to direct your thoughts to a worthwhile cause, you will be able to turn your overthinking into a superpower that works for you every time.

Discipline

One good, full, productive day where you did everything you said you would. The day where you did the workout, got the tasks

done, ate well, and went to bed with nothing left on the list. This is a day of **discipline**.

You can have days like this everyday. Discipline is something everyone can build.

I want to tell you something that Jocko Willink — former Navy SEAL commander, one of the most decorated military leaders in American history — said about discipline.

Jocko had trained people from **every** conceivable background. Rich kids and broke kids. Pampered kids and abused kids. Kids from strong families and kids with no family at all. Kids who had grown up surrounded by discipline and kids who had never experienced a single structured day in their lives.

And his conclusion, after years of watching all of them?

Discipline is not something some people have and others do not. It is not a personality trait you are born with. It is built — through consistency — and lost through inaction.

A person can be disciplined for ten years and lose it. A person can be a mess for ten years and build it. It is **never** too late. And it is never permanently yours either. You have to keep choosing it.

This section is going to help you build discipline. Discipline is built over time by applying the correct **mindsets** to your day.

It doesn't make sense to think about doing extremely hard challenges that you haven't

built up to yet, some people try to do too much too soon and burn out.

But, by starting just a little **above** our current level of discipline, and pushing ourselves daily, we can achieve great progress in our discipline levels.

We want to construct healthy targets that are slightly challenging, but that don't ruin your entire month and mental health either! Some people take these challenges to the extreme.
Through practice, you will get better at constructing disciplined goals that you know are healthy for you and that you can achieve without burning out.

We don't all need to be military men who take **ice baths** daily. We don't have to always

pick the **hard** path for the sake of it in life. Don't target things just because they are hard, target them because they will bring you closer to your dreams, hard or not.

You know in yourself, how hard you need to work to achieve your own greatness. You know if you need more or less discipline within yourself, and this chapter is going to help you to build it.

Here are **10 tips** to build unbreakable discipline.

10 Tips To Build Unbreakable Discipline

Tip 1: Kick Start Discipline With An Awesome Morning Routine

A disciplined day starts from your morning routine. It sets the tone for the rest of the day.

The type of day you have when you complete your entire habit tracker before noon and have all tasks completed is a **different** kind of day.

You end up not even **wanting** to relax after, you actually get the energy to become even more disciplined and to do even more. From the moment you wake up, the discipline is live.

Do not stay under the warm covers negotiating with yourself. Get up and move. Work out early if you can.

Write down your most important tasks the night before and blitz through them the moment the day begins.

If you consistently execute a good morning routine, you are well on your way to becoming disciplined at least 50% of the time, as you will spend the first half of your days in a disciplined manner!

Tip 2: Discipline Applies To Everything You Do

Discipline is not just the gym. It is your diet, your sleep, your reading, the quality of work you produce, the partner you are, the promises you keep to yourself and to others. Your morning and evening routine. It bleeds into everything.

To build discipline in your diet, eat clean food, avoid sugar — it is addictive and drains you faster than almost anything else. Fast until later in the day if it works for you to loose weight.

"The body can go 30 days without food, you can go 8 hours without it."

To build discipline into your gym routine, make your workouts progressively harder. Show up on the hard days that you don't feel like it and go through the motions!

A workout attended is better than no workout.
Apply discipline to everything. How you answer your phone and get back to people in a timely manner, your routines, your habit

trackers, your to do list, and your family priorities.

When your day is done, you will feel something that an easy, slow, comfortable day almost never produces — genuine satisfaction. A rewarding tiredness. The quiet pride of someone who did not waste their hours.

You will grow to **love** it.

Tip 3: Don't Give Yourself An Out

Do not give yourself an out. Track things such as lifts in the gym, your diet, habits completed and tasks completed, as well as monthly goals.

You are doing this so you remain accountable to yourself. Broadcast your goals to others, tell someone your goal and attach consequences — owe people money if you fail.

This gives you accountability. You can recreate "accountability." In the military, people don't want to let their team down. In everyday life, you can seek out accountability partners, track and log your goals, and set punishments if you fail!

Tip 4: On The Days You Don't Want To — Go Through The Motions

On the days you do not want to do something, go through the motions. This means showing up even if your output isn't the best.

Lift the weights. Sprint the hill. Do your work at a reduced version of itself rather than not at all. Seek consistency over perfection.

If you feel like taking a day off, wait until tomorrow to decide. If you still want the day off tomorrow, take it. But, most times you will wake up the next day and the urge will have gone.

Also, once you start doing the action even with the intent to do it half heartedly, you usually end up doing it pretty good.

It's why it's better to show up for a gym session a little sleepy, and get started, because magically they somehow turn into extremely good sessions!

Tip 5: Don’t Hesitate

“No more I'll start tomorrow. No more waiting for the perfect moment, the right conditions. Discipline is everyday.”

Fight instant gratification and immediate rewards for every inch they try to take. When do you start? Here and now.

Stop thinking about things, Stop researching the pros and cons of things, and stop debating doing it. Just do it. Discipline is starting now without hesitation.

Tip 6: Never Miss Twice

One day off is not the problem. But one day can quickly turn into two. Into a week. One

missed workout can quickly turn into 4 missed workouts.

Adopt a never miss twice mentality. If you fall off one day, come back harder the next like you owe yourself one.

"One missed workout is not a failure. Four missed workouts following the first one is a choice."

Stay on guard. Never miss twice, and try to go everyday. It is not always possible to, but if you can without burning out, and realistically most people can, then go ahead and take no days off. But if you do take a day off, never miss twice!

Tip 7: Construct Your To Do List

Build structure. Most people in the military build discipline because they are forced to. They have sergeants, they have set times and set goals and days.

What can really help the average person who does not have the same forced structure, is for them to plan out a disciplined day. Most people just take life as it comes.

They forget tasks. But when you get organized and plan out a disciplined routine daily, with set times to do things, it can really help you.

Decide in advance when you wake up, when you work, when you train. Write down your

to do list with the top 3 most important tasks, and get them done.

Tip 8: Stack Small, Repeatable Actions

Focus on small, repeatable actions. Discipline isn't built by big heroic efforts—it comes from doing basic things over and over.

Pick a few non-negotiables (like 20 minutes of exercise, diet, reading,) and stick to them daily. Repetition is what turns effort into habit. Build things slowly until you are disciplined in all areas of your life.

Tip 9: Know When To Rest

If your body is telling you to rest for several days in a row, listen. That is not weakness — that is the signal before burnout.

The trick to sustaining discipline long-term is to set challenges that are difficult but never so extreme that they break you.

Increase the difficulty by **five percent**, not twenty-five. As long as you are doing something to improve, you remain in control. A progressively harder workout. A slightly cleaner diet. A new monthly challenge.

Tip 10: Progressive Overload

When you take a new recruit into the military, they aren't just disciplined on their first day. They get shouted at and accustomed to discipline across many months.

It will take time to build yourself up to a level where you can get to the gym 5 times a week, eat 100% healthily, and to not take days off. The crazy thing is… what you once thought you would hate…

You start to **enjoy**. I enjoy waking up early for a workout, I enjoy avoiding a doughnut to eat a healthy breakfast. Through progressive overload you can get there too.

The Value Of Discipline

"The person who controls their discipline controls their life — their output, their health, their mood, their direction."

When you build it, you will find that the days that once felt hard become the days you live for.

You will soon begin to see the value in discipline and how it benefits you. Doing hard stuff feels good. Hard times create strong people. You will start to find that the **best** days of your life are not the lazy ones. They are the **disciplined** ones.

I am going to set you some short term goals and exercises to complete to assist you with discipline.

4 Exercises To Build Discipline

Exercise 1: Listen to the audiobook Discipline Equals Freedom.

Something about Jocko Willincks military style upbringing and way of speaking can really help you to feel in the mood to set yourself new discipline challenges.

Exercise 2: Construct Your Own Discipline Challenges

There is a challenge called 75 hard that I use as inspiration for my own discipline challenges.

The 75 hard challenge is 75 days **straight** of:

- Reading 10 pages of a self improvement book every day.

- Two 45 minute workouts everyday (one outdoor and one indoor)
- Following a healthy diet of your choice.
- Drink a gallon of water a day.

I adopt a simpler and easier approach for myself, because my life is already quite busy.

I already follow my AG4 advanced fitness program, which is a high workrate fitness programme designed for athletes, so even sticking to that requires discipline alone.

I would burn out with the demands of the 75 hard challenge alongside my already extensive fitness programme.

I create **reduced** versions of such challenges if I want to work on my discipline.

30 Days Discipline Challenge

- Workout Daily
- Follow Healthy Diet Of My Choice
- Read 5 Pages Of Self Improvement Book Daily
- Spend 5 Minutes Learning New Skill Daily

My current challenge is:

- Workout Daily Using My AG Workout System
- Follow High Protein Diet With No Chocolate Bars (My Current Weakness)
- Read 5 Pages Of Self Improvement Book Daily (A Reasonable Amount Of Pages)

- 20 Burpees Daily (I Don't Like Burpees, And They Tire Me Out More Than Any Other Exercise, So I Am Improving At Them For The Sake Of Discipline)

Can you see how my challenge isn't ridiculous? It's not 10 ice baths a week, with 100 burpees per day on top of my workout programme and already busy life. It's simply pushing my discipline to grow instead of shrink, but in a manageable way. I actually find it better not to burn yourself out, and set challenges that will just **slightly** challenge you.

The challenges that grew me the most, weren't specifically the ones where I put myself through the most pain, but were the

ones most focused on areas I wanted to improve on in my life.

A challenge to run a marathon with no training and put yourself through extreme hardship is cool, and there's no doubt you learn a lot.

I'm not saying don't push yourself and go on adventures from time to time.
But humble challenges such as reading a self development book for 10 minutes a day for a month straight, or keeping it simple by picking:

- One daily fitness target to do daily
- One nutrition target to stick to daily
- One book to stick to daily

These challenges are the ones that developed me just as much.

Your discipline challenge to start with could be even more simple.

Habit Tracker 30 Day Challenge:

Follow a habit tracker for 30 days, with the habits of:

- Gratitude Journalling 3 Things Per Day
- Meditation 1 Minute Per Day
- Exercise In Any Form Daily
- Reading 1 Page Per Day

Sticking to these basics alone can improve discipline in amazing ways.

Exercise 3: Journalling Exercise:

Ask yourself:

Who am I?
What have I learned?
What have I created?
What forward progress have I made?
Who have I helped?
What am I doing to improve myself-today?
To get better, faster, stronger, healthier, smarter?
Is this what I want to be? This?

Is this all I've got-is this everything I can give?

Is this going to be my life? Do I accept that?

Ask yourself those hard questions, and then answer them, truthfully.

Are you spending your days becoming the person you want to be?

Working on your life's work?

Will you look back on days like this and be proud at the end of your lifetime? Or are you wasting them?

Try and set challenges or discipline your life based around becoming the person you want to be.

Not showing off to others, but genuinely focus on the things that will move you forward.

One thing I realized is you don't need ice baths, its alright but really, you should think about the challenges that are actually going to help you follow your dreams.

Does Discipline Have To Be Hard?

People think discipline is hard and they have to hate it. But I want to leave you with a quote.

"Discipline is the enjoyment of life."
You can build your life so you **enjoy** the discipline. When you really don't want to do something, and it's not ticked off your list, doing it is discipline.

Discipline is your diet too, your sleep, not just your gym, your personal challenges, your reading, how much of a good partner

you are, your charity and goodness as a person, everything.

If you asked me to explain discipline it it's most **simple** way. It **is** doing hard things. To an extent. But also doing the things that most benefit you to become who you are meant to be.

It's about doing what's **best** for you to grow.

Before you set a discipline challenge, ask yourself is it just for the sake of it? Will it actually **develop** you in the areas you want?

It isn't pain for pains sake. Before you set a challenge ask are you doing this for your ego or to look cool? Discipline is sometimes doing the boring easy stuff, that you know will put you in the place you need to be.

It isn't always the **big extreme** challenge everyone sees you doing so you can get attention and feel rewarded.

A challenge has to be aligned to build you up to be the person you actually want to be.

The ideal version of myself doesn't put himself through pain for the sake of it. He doesn't take ice baths, or overtrain and do 1000 push ups a day.

He does however train **smart**, consistently, and with his future dream in mind. He constantly builds towards the right areas.

Those days that you tick off all the goals and get so much done, are some of the **best** days

of your life. You will look back on these types of days one day and be proud of them.

Wake up and think of the most **perfect** day that the best version of yourself would complete in order to follow their dreams. And **execute** it repeatedly.

That is discipline done right.

Sleep

Sleep is important for just about everything. For your gains in the gym, for your mood, your performance at work.

Without sleep you will actually produce so many hormones that will delay your progress in the gym.

Tip 1:

You Don't Have a Problem Waking Up, You Have a Problem Going To Bed Early.

People think waking up is the problem. But really they have set themselves up for failure the night before.

They struggle the most with not being able to switch off and pick a sensible bedtime, which in turn throws them off their game the next day.

This then affects their gym performance, their work performance and overall mood **drops** significantly.

The most important part of sleep is what you do to prepare the night **before**.

Once you have made your preparations to sleep, you have to be **strict** with yourself.

Avoid thinking about relationships, your to do list, or work no matter how much you want to.

If you really want to sleep well, then you have to understand that time during the day should be set out for things like processing traumas or difficult life events, making big life moves or plans, but when you are trying to sleep, you have to be **strict** with your own mind.

This is how you stop yourself from getting overstimulated.

Tip 2: Use Positive Night Time Habits That Relax You.

Switch out habits such as **overthinking**, or doing more work, and use habits such as positive visualisations (explained in the overthinking section) gratitude and meditations.

You can use the app Medito to play sleeping music and relaxing meditations. **Wind down** routines are very important.

Tip 3: Lower Your Heart Rate

We want to avoid **overstimulation** before bed. For example, binge watching high action bank robbery dramas on Netflix before we go to bed, or adrenaline pumping horror movies is not the best choice. Reality TV and dramas are too **engaging**, as they are designed to keep us hooked 24/7.

Go for nature shows, travel shows, on a low volume, or shows that we have seen so many times that we **know** the endings. This means our brain is not as interested.

Reading books is proven to be an effective **sleep aid**, and those that read tend to fall asleep easier than those that don't.

It is a good idea to pick a book that is quite boring actually. Find a book that is just interesting enough to where you don't hate it. If it excites you too much, you will **never** get to sleep.

Don't read something with **high emotional content**, or something too mathematical.

Avoid:

- Thrillers
- Horror
- Dark Fantasy

- Anything Complicated

Good Genres:

- Fantasy
- Non Fiction History Books

Tip 4: Switch Off Your Work Brain

To sleep, you need to switch off your "work brain." Have tomorrow planned out and have all your tasks written out in a journal or on your notes app.

This is so we don't stay up all night planning what to do the next day. Our mind knows we have it planned and under control.

Writing a to-do list journal for the next day has been shown in studies to be the top journaling technique for sleep.

Make the hard decision to not do any more work. Switch off "work mode." Be **disciplined** to know you will produce more work tomorrow.

Ask yourself:

"Would I rather do 5 extra hours of work now when I am tired and unproductive, affecting my work day for tomorrow and resulting in more bad work?

Or is it better to get some sleep and keep the quality of my work high?"

It's usually better to just get the sleep so you can continue to output high quality work in all that you do.

Tip 5: The Sleep Stack

A good sleep stack to boost your sleep is:

L-Theanine
Pistachio Nuts (Contain Melatonin)
Magnesium 400mg
Chamomile Tea

Melatonin 0.5mg (Optional - For The Really Sleepless Nights)

Tip 6: Use Light To Your Advantage

Firstly, when you wake up early, step outside into the sunlight if possible first thing when you wake up. This **signals** to your body that this is the natural time to wake up.

Actually go out into the direct sunlight.

Studies have shown that when taking a scanner that measures the amount of light your exposed to, even on a cloudy day, stepping outside into direct sunlight will give you **100 times** the sunlight rating that you would get staying inside.

When it comes to night time, be mindful of keeping the lights on as they are artificial lights that signal to your body to stay awake.

Blue light is especially a type of light that keeps us awake, and is commonly used by our iPhone screens and TV's.

I switch all my phones to low brightness and "**Night Mode**" which is a special mode that turns the screen orange, using orange light instead of blue light, to help you sleep.

Select red or dim orange style lamps over powerful white lights, or blue lights. If you are reading try to read under a dim lamp, or try to read using the **dark mode** on your kindle.

This dark mode turns the screen black and helps a lot with sleep.

Tip 7: Use A Mouth Tape

If you are a mouth breather at night, unfortunately it is shown that it is not as healthy to breathe through your mouth when you sleep.

Try to breathe through your nose with a short inhale and an extended exhale. To fix mouth breathing you can tape your mouth shut with a “micropore tape” from Amazon.

This is shown to boost your sleep quality by approximately 30%

Tip 8: The Bed Is For 2 Things:

Sleep and Sex.

Essentially, we want the bed to cue us for sleep. If we do too many other things in bed, then our brains don't have an **idea** that it is time to sleep.

Tip 9: Avoid Naps

If you're having trouble sleeping, napping is simply not a good idea, it adversely affects our sleep cycle.

We build up a "sleepiness" chemical called adenosine from the moment we wake up. More adenosine = more sleepy. Napping lowers adenosine levels.

Tip 10: Avoid Caffeine And Alcohol

Reduce your stimulant use: Caffeine and nicotine have a half-life of 5–6 hours.

That means it takes 10–12 hours to clear your system completely. Cut yourself off by noon or early afternoon if you want a good night sleep.

Drinking a lot of water can help improve the elimination
of these substances from your body, but not by that much.

Avoid alcohol, it causes nightmares and interrupted sleep.

Conclusion On Sleep

To conclude, sleep is really going to affect your fitness progress as well as your mental health progress, entire books can be written on the reasons why.

Please don't **underestimate** this area of your life and attempt to hit it with the same discipline as your gym and diet programmes. My recommendation is to follow the steps in this chapter, and treat night time as a relaxing time, not a time for overthinking or anything too intense.

Remember that fixing your sleep is going to give a large percentage boost to your productivity and mood, giving you a better chance to succeed in nearly every aspect of your life.

Imposter Syndrome

Have you ever walked into a room and felt like you had no right to be there?

That feeling has a name. **Imposter syndrome.**

The voice that tells you that you are a fraud, that someone is about to find you out, that everyone around you is more qualified and more deserving.

It is one of the most common things I see in the people I work with. And most of the people I work with allow it to hold them back way more than necessary!

Four People Who Almost Let It Stop Them

John

John recently found out he had a child on the way.

He had been waking up everyday with a love for fitness, and even though he was offered a job in his old field of computing that paid more, he wanted to inspire his future child to follow their dreams, so he decided to go with his passion for fitness.

Deep down, John had a drive that would completely out match anyone.

He would do all the reading required of him, he would train from sunrise to sundown, and simply had the type of **personality** and passion to become one of the best trainers in the city.

John applied straight for the **best** gyms in his city. He knew he wanted to train amongst the best.

With a child on the way, he knew that he couldn't be working in a small gym with no **progression** opportunities, he wouldn't be able to make it work for his child on a minimum wage.

John went straight for the **best** gyms. John was simply the kind of person at this stage in his life who would commit to a company for the long term, commit seriously to the development opportunities available, and outwork everyone.

He had only held his fitness training license for 4 months, but had taught boxing training for 5 years.

John knew he had a special gift for connecting and training people, and learned quicker than other people, but as he stepped into the interview room alongside the other applicants, he **doubted** his ability to train as well as those who had been in the business for 10 years.

He stood against these other trainers with a long list of credentials, forgetting that his own unique background could be a breath of fresh air to the company.

The voice started: “you shouldn’t be here. You haven’t earned this yet.”

John trained his clients with upmost passion and in a unique way that would in fact be valuable to a company.

He suddenly got the feeling like he **shouldn't** be in the room, based on his lack of experience alone.

What John could not see was that the company were not looking for the most experienced trainer.

They were looking for someone humble, coachable, and ready to **commit**. John matched that perfectly. He got the job.

The imposter syndrome was present — but he stayed composed, tried anyway, and it changed his life.

Billy

Billy was a talented left handed boxer who had been boxing for only **2 years**. He had won a lot of amateur fights, and made an exceptional transformation.

Billy used to be overweight, and went from fat to a fit boxer.

He had recorded his journey of his weight loss on YouTube.

Billy noticed lots of left handed people were responding to his internet boxing videos of him punching the bag for weight loss. People were impressed with his technique, as well as the videos of his 2 amateur fights.

Billy's audience were asking him to film online courses to help them. They kept asking the same thing: *"where are the tutorials for us? There is nothing out there."*

There aren't many videos on the internet for left handed boxers, and Billy had a lot of information that would be critical to this audience.
Billy didn't see it this way though. His imposter syndrome kicked in and told him that he didn't have the authority to make a course because he wasn't a pro boxer yet.

He sat on it for a month, feeling like as an amateur he didn't have the authority yet to release what he wanted to. Billy decided to battle with these thoughts and released the course anyway.

The course went viral, made him £100,000 in his first 3 months, and he received messages from countless people thanking him greatly for the information.
The truth is through his **transformation**, Billy had learned information that was a **treasure** to his audience. The knowledge he thought was ordinary was **gold** to the people who needed it.

Kelly

Kelly was a finance director who had produced some of the best work of any manager at her bank in the USA.

Kelly was in a job interview for a slightly larger bank. Kelly had a **photographic** memory when it came to numbers, and quite honestly would have been a **better fit** at this bank than any of the other applicants. As she sat across from applicants who had worked for slightly **larger** firms, in slightly bigger titles, a bead of sweat ran down her forehaead. I shouldn't be here.

She was wrong. But imposter syndrome does not deal in facts. It deals in feelings.

Nick

Nick Mira was simply a teenager in his room, first discovering how to **produce** music. He barely knew how to operate a mixing desk or the functions of the music programme he was using when he first started.
What gave him the **confidence** to post music tutorials? He didn't have the attitude that he was "the best" music producer with the most information.

He simply had the attitude that he was sharing what he learned as he went through his journey, and this attitude was beneficial enough for **thousands** of young teenagers across the world.

I saw Nick's transformation in real time, as thousands of teenagers across the world started to follow his label "Internet Money" where he aimed to **show** young people how to make money on the internet through selling music.
Nick overtook the older generation, who knew more about him when it came to mixing desks and composing music in general. How did he do that?

His first beats were not the **best** by any means, but making his tutorials and having the courage to post his journey helped him to make money selling tutorials to others.

It was almost like he was learning the producing software as he went, whilst also showing others and helping them to learn.

Nick got more exposure, moved into villas with other musicians, and placed himself in an environment with other young musicians who believed in his cause.
Nick had a lot of talented guitarists and musicians emailing him for collaborations, also with the dream to make money on the internet.

He had built connections with good musicians, and this allowed Nick to **organize** everything together to create hits for top artists across America.

My point in telling this story is that there were many talented teenagers around that time who had better music hidden away on their computers...

Who simply didn't involve themselves in the process of putting themselves out there, and in return, they never got to sit in the same rooms Nick did.
They never got the same exposure to the industry, and never maintained consistency.

All because they didn't believe they could start something, whereas Nick had a plan, executed through **imperfection**, and eventually built something great.

Why Imposter Syndrome Lies To You

Imposter syndrome **holds you back** by asking questions designed to stop you before you start.

"What gives me the authority to do fitness content when I don't look like Arnold Schwarzenegger?"

Hint: People buy most and relate most from everyday transformations and not those on steroids. You are still valid.

"What gives me the authority to approach and talk to this girl or guy I don't know at the pub?"

Hint: That girl or guy likes you, and you may be the perfect partner for them if you just got out of your head and talked to them.

"What gives me the authority to apply for a job when I don't meet every requirement?"

Hint: Job descriptions are wishlists, not entry barriers. Many employers hire for potential, attitude, and adaptability — not perfect CV matches.

"What gives me the authority to start a business when I've never done it before?"

Hint: Every business owner was inexperienced at some point. The first version of most successful businesses was built by someone figuring it out in real time.

“What gives me the authority to share advice when there are people more qualified than me?”

Hint: Fresh perspectives often come from those without long term bias. You may see solutions others have stopped noticing.

"What gives me the authority to share advice when there are people more qualified than me?"

Hint: People don't only learn from the most qualified — they learn from whoever explains things in a way they can actually understand.

“What gives me the authority to try something creative when I’m not “naturally talented”?”

Hint: Most creativity is repetition, not talent. Early attempts are supposed to be average — that’s the entry price of improvement.

"What gives me the authority to start training others when I'm still improving myself?"

Hint: Teaching accelerates learning. You don't need to be finished to be useful — you just need to be a few steps ahead of someone else.

By teaching or learning from mistakes in places that are beyond us, this **accelerates** our learning.

I want you to realise that imposter syndrome doesn't allow us to reach our true potential — it makes us miss out on opportunities to become our best.

Some practical tips to consider:

Tip 1: There Is Someone With Less, Doing More

There are people less talented than you, more stupid than you, who are earning more than you, just because they took action Whilst you sat there and thought you weren't good enough.

Tip 2: You Are Likely Exactly What Someone Is Looking For

There are companies that would be blessed to have you, you are exactly what they are looking for.

But they will never get the blessing of working with you if you doubt yourself.

Tip 3: What Seems Like Common Knowledge To You Is Gold To Other People

You are biased because you live the same life daily.

A boxer uses the same 5 punch combo and thinks it's basic. But really, that is **amazing** to an average person.

A gym instructor does 40 push ups, meanwhile someone who is new to working out is amazed they can even do 1.

A top salesman can persuade someone to buy something within 5 minutes — he uses a script he learned off by heart where he has an answer to everything.

Every objection a customer could have, he finds a way to smoothly get around. To him it's just another day, but to a newcomer to the company, the way he speaks is like **magic**.

We all have skills that we think everyone else has. When really others find these skills magical.

Tip 4: Imposter Syndrome Is A Good Sign

Imposter syndrome is a sign you are doing something right. You are pushing yourself outside of your comfort zone.

It may be hard, it may seem **slightly** above your current level, but it is always worth a try. You don't have to be the best, you just need to start.

When it comes to applying for jobs, employers don't always want the best in terms of **credentials**, but the best fit personality wise.

When it comes to selling products, people do buy from people who are at the top of an industry, as they have credibility.

But in many industries, someone too far above them in terms of credentials alienates the buyer, because the buyer cannot **relate** to them.

People feel too far away from stages that are too advanced for them, and tend to buy mentorship, advice and products from people who are 2 or 3 steps **ahead** of them.

They can relate more to someone close to their level, rather than someone who is 5 steps ahead from them. At that stage the gap in understanding is too great.

In fact you can often get a lot of sales by teaching a concept in a way that is more **simple**, or more **friendly** than someone else. That's why you don't have to be a professional boxer to teach the sport, you could be an amateur that is simply more friendly and has a more **simplistic** style of explanation. Many people will gravitate to you more than a professional with a more **complicated** teaching style.

The same way in a job, employers may not always go for the most qualified applicant, but who they feel would **fit** most into the team. No one wants to come to work, where we spend 80% of our lives, and have to deal with someone they don't get on well with, even if they have the best credentials.

The feelings of why would anyone listen to me, of not being good enough, of being an imposter — we must **overcome** that. And the sooner the better.

Remember:

"Success often comes less from talent, and more from the willingness to act despite doubt."

3 Exercises To Beat Imposter Syndrome

Here are 3 exercises you can use to challenge imposter syndrome.

Exercise 1: Things I'm Doing That I'm Not Ready For - Journalling Exercise

Complete this sentence 10 times:

"I don't feel ready to ____, but I'm doing it anyway because ____."

Exercise 2 - Collecting Evidence That You Are Who You Say You Are

Write down:

- 5 things you've achieved (big or small)
- 5 skills you've developed

- 3 times you helped someone else improve

Then ask:

"If this was someone else, would I think they're a fraud?"

Most people immediately realise the answer is no.

If the answer is yes, ask yourself:

"Whats the worst that can happen if I try anyway? Will I actually loose anything or just improve massively by throwing myself in the deep end?"

"Will I Improve more by going this route or by staying in the same place, not taking action."

"Do I accept that if I am scared to put myself out there, or challenge myself with a growth mindset, I will probably not do as well as

those with less who do put themselves out there?"

Employers and people in general are more impressed by those that try and have a growth mindset, so remember to never count yourself out!

Exercise 3 - The "They're Not Special" Lens

This is blunt but effective.

Think of someone doing what you want to do.

Ask yourself:

- Are they actually more capable than me?
- Or did they just start earlier, put themselves out there more, and stay consistent?

- Are they perfect? Do they have bad days? They may have done this longer than me, but does that mean they will burn out before me?
- Do I have more drive than them because of this?
- Do I bring a unique angle?

This removes the illusion that others are uniquely qualified. When you actually think about it, everyone in a room is going to have some weakness.

I know it sounds harsh, but you could even sit and think of other people in your field who are competing against you.

Deep Down, they probably do have undeniable weaknesses, ask yourself if you really Believe they are as perfect as the image of them you have in your head is.

We are all unique and going on our own unique journies, we all have streengths and weaknesses, meaning we are all valuable.

That person with 10 years of experience could be burning out with an attitude that is growing worse and worse every day.

For you not to try would be a crime to yourself and to the people or companies you could help or provide a great service for.

Final Thoughts On Imposter Syndrome

The information provided in this chapter will help you to focus on catching the best opportunities for yourself rather than overthinking.

Being a little “out of your depth” in life never hurt anybody, it’s usually round about exactly where you want to be to succeed.

Set yourself the goals that are **impossibly possible**, just beyond possible but still in reach, and you will achieve them.

You will one day become an authority in areas you never imagined and incredible opportunities will reach you, all from **taking action** and taking the **decision** to believe in yourself.

Imagine that life where you are **one day** teaching others what you are unsure of now, laughing at how far you have come, and proud of yourself for taking that step.

Let's take the steps together to stamp out imposter syndrome, and achieve what we know we deserve in life.

Anxiety

Two people were victims of a car crash. Jenny was a person who had anxiety. She locked herself indoors.

She listened to advice online such as “take your time,” “heal when you’re ready,” and “be kind to yourself,” so she didn’t push herself to go to the gym even though she knew she probably should.

She thought that she was being kind and patient with herself.

Over time, it wasn’t just the gym she was scared to go to. She was scared to leave her house. She had got so used to staying indoors. The voice in her head telling her to stay there all the time won.

Her life became very limited. Jenny was kind to herself and took her time, but misinterpreted being kind to herself as taking no action.

Terry was a person who also had anxiety from the event. Terry knew he didn't want to go out. But his therapist told him he couldn't withdraw.

His therapist told him he had to do the things that scared him in order to get through.
Though this triggered panic attacks, Terry's therapist reassured him that this was normal.

Terry was kind to himself, going to yoga, painting classes, and not living a crazy life, but slowly pushing himself more. He had the

occasional night out with alcohol-free drinks, went to the occasional boxing class, and attended support groups.

He found a good balance of pushing his comfort zone and relaxing activities to ensure stress didn't get too high.

He ensured he always pushed himself to do the basics that were going to keep him out of the house and in shape.

Though the panic attacks were bad at first, and he sometimes felt like he was moving towards them instead of running away, eventually they became less and less.

Terry regained control of his life, hit records in his gym sessions, and realised that the

alarms going off in his head were simply ringing for no reason.

It was simply a life event that had knocked him, but through being kind to himself, staying active, and attending support groups, he realised the world wasn't all so bad.

This chapter is about anxiety and how to slowly move towards resolving it without hiding.

Move Towards Anxiety, Instead Of Fighting To Avoid It

The book that helped me to understand "moving towards" anxiety the most was Route 91 by Dr Sheva Gaed. I had some

clients that had PTSD and anxiety disorders and this book really helped me to help them through.

Some people give very one dimensional advice when it comes to anxiety. You will often hear:

"Take your medication"
"Stay indoors until you feel ready"
"Go easy on yourself and don't expose yourself to any triggers."

I think this advice has some truth to it but is also dangerous.

There's nothing wrong with being kind to yourself, but by playing it safe, staying indoors, and staying put until you feel "ready" with no action on your part, can

result in cases where people lose all momentum in their battle against anxiety.

Some people are not active enough in their battle against anxiety, they let their anxiety consume them, and end up never being "ready" to make a change due to constant avoidance of what they actually need to do.

What if we are running away from what we should be moving towards?

Most of the qualified advice given to tackle cases of anxiety explains that, to manage anxiety, instead of running away from it, or trying to fight it, we should learn to accept it and relax into it. We should not practice avoidance of these feelings.

Through leaning into our anxiety, and experiencing it enough times, we often realise that it cannot kill us, and then by that realisation, the anxiety often fixes itself.

It is only through the correct mindset and a willingness to move forward can we do this.

Here's the truth, with anxiety, you do have the choice of never facing up to it, you have the choice of trying to completely avoid any situations that cause you anxiety. This is called "avoidance" by therapists.
But, if you take the choice not to face your fears, you can quickly reach a point where you are so anxious you cannot even leave your house. You tell yourself: "I'll be ready to conquer this tomorrow."

And if you have reached this point, staying at home, not going out, telling yourself you will move forwards tomorrow, without a plan of immediate action, you are in the danger zone.

Tomorrow never comes for a lot of people. Especially when they do not have a solid plan.

When you reach the stage of not leaving your house and avoiding everything, anxiety has completely won. Some people stay waiting to "get ready" to beat anxiety for years.

Not only that, but staying in their house and not leaving means a person gets used to being inside. This may start with just one day inside.

Then two, then, the anxious voice in their head telling them to stay in grows stronger, the habit to stay inside is reinforced. The more days they stay in, the more the habit is built. The anxious voice becomes more real over time, and the longer it is consistently listened to, the harder it becomes to ignore.

The anxiety gets worse due to no social connections, no walks in nature, no exercise, or contact with support groups or friends.

In this situation, anxiety becomes out of control, and before a person knows it, what seemed somewhat conquerable beforehand, becomes a real disability keeping them indoors. At this stage anxiety is really hard to break free of as you have already set habits that are keeping you at home and isolated.

Staying isolated and hiding from anxiety is the worst thing you could do.

The Concept Of Exposure

What actually helps anxiety is the concept of "exposure." where you slowly expose yourself to situations that cause you anxiety in order to face your fears.

A book that explains this concept is Route 91, written by Shiva Gaed who was a therapist that helped patients through anxiety and PTSD.
Shiva ended up being a witness to the Las Vegas mass shooting where she witnessed many people who were shot and killed. This was a traumatic event which gave her PTSD alongside many other people.

To prove that her therapy techniques worked, Dr Shiva used her own techniques on herself, alongside a bunch of other survivors from this event, to heal herself of her own anxiety attacks and PTSD.

Shiva successfully created a help group for survivors of the Vegas shooting and helped them get their lives back by involving them with her methods.

Of course after a mass shooting, many patients anxiety levels were extremely high. It was normal for the survivors of this event to not want to go out of their homes. They would avoid loud places. Everywhere seemed dangerous to them.

But Shiva was an expert on PTSD and anxiety. Shiva said that there needs to be a safe “bare minimum” that is to be committed to to ensure a person with anxiety doesn’t fall completely off track.

No matter how many panic attacks happened, she encouraged her patients to leave their homes. At the very minimum she encouraged them to go to the gym and exercise, to go to the shops, and go to work.

You see, as I said earlier, if a person gets to the point where they avoid all public places, they don’t work out (which is necessary to produce the chemicals to reduce anxiety and depression) and they avoid all social interaction, they shortly become not only anxious, but depressed too.

Once you build that habit of avoiding life for too long, and feeling scared of the world, it is so hard to break.

I myself have had clients who fell into this rut. They accepted without any give or take that they were scared of the outside world, and took active avoidance of it.

These clients really struggled, for years as a result of this decision. I noticed that pattern very commonly, as did Dr Shiva Ghaed in her book.

The clients who at least tried, who pushed themselves daily, who exposed themselves gradually each day more than the last to the outside world and to their trigger situations, showed excellent transformations. Many of

them were completely fine within a year in most cases.

What Does The Danger Zone Look Like?

You have reached the point where you are codependent on someone else to leave the house. This looks like only leaving or feeling able to go outside when someone else is with you.

You have reached a point where you aren't taking a responsibility to at least exercise, go to work, or leave the house for support groups and sociability.

You totally avoid public places.

If anxiety has got to that point, for you there is only one thing left for you to do. And that is act.

How do we go about doing this?

One step at a time.

The Value Of Facing Our Fears

The most problematic reactions when it comes to anxiety are avoidance behaviors, as they interfere with recovery.

People build avoiding the things they need to do to be happy into their personality and avoiding becomes their default. The first thing Dr Shiva did was reassure her fellow group members that she was following her

own guidance, and shared personal examples of "exposure" activities to help them understand the value of facing their fears.

She let them know to start small but to take action. Maybe they didn't feel ready to go to the thing that gave them EXTREME anxiety to begin with..

Maybe not a big concert, festival, fair, or amusement park. But she told them to start smaller, with slightly less anxiety provoking activities.

"Start with Walmart, IKEA, or Costco. If that's too much, start with smaller places where there are other people around since that is often what we avoid."

The same way you start with lower weights in gym and build up your tolerance, you can do the same with situations that make you anxious. Progressively overload your outings. The more you go out and have safe experiences, the more you will have positive experiences and realise the anxiety is unjust.

Here is an exercise:

Write down a list of all the things you think you may be avoiding right now, and then rank each one on a scale of 1 to 10. The “1” is a relatively low or minimal level of anxiety. (avoidance)

The “10” is the highest level of anxiety you can imagine (maybe panic attack zone), and thus you avoid it the most –
more than most other things.

Once you have established the fear hierarchy, start with the activities listed at about a 3 or 4 and start moving up your fear ladder.

The reason we start with 3 or 4 is that these activities will produce just enough anxiety for you to feel challenged.

If noisy crowds or clubs make you nervous, then you go into lots of crowded places until it doesn't
cause you panic and anxiety anymore.

If boxing makes you nervous, you need go to boxing class until it doesn't. You get the idea.

These exposure activities help us to understand the difference between *real* and *perceived* threats. It is like when a person

gets anxiety about public speaking the first time they do it.

However if they were booked in for 5 speeches a day for 2 months, they would likely reach a stage where public speaking became just another normal day to them.

Everytime you go out there, you realise the world is not out to get you.

Every walk in nature you go on, where some dog walkers smile at you and you realise nothing bad happened. Every time you go to the gym, you realise people are friendly. You start to realise the world is fine. You start to realise you can conquer this.

Conquering Anxiety Can Make You Stronger

Once you work your way up your list of anxieties, you will transform as a person. You may find you not only bounce back from this condition, but bounce beyond.

You may become a stronger person, a more grateful person, a person who feels closer to others and is able to help them through their fears.

A person who is able to find the joy in a small walk, and the feeling of walking freely down the street without fear.

You can actually bounce back beyond who you originally were, and become an all around better person, with the experience of

facing your fears successfully. This can lead to feelings of extreme confidence and really turn you into a new person who would smile back at the you who is facing anxiety now, because you are going to grow into a very strong character.

I am now going to give you 8 further tips to help with conquering anxiety.

8 Tips To Conquer Anxiety

Tip 1: Expose Yourself Daily And Progressively To That Which You Fear

Expose yourself slowly to what you fear as mentioned above. We can slowly take small,

but frequent steps to expose ourselves to that which me most fear, to realise there's nothing to fear. Do the opposite of withdraw. (most people withdraw, that's the worst thing)

Tip 2: Helping Others, And Gratitude

Research shows that healing happens rapidly when you help others and engage in lots of acts of random kindness. Healing cannot occur when the opposite happens (arming up, holing in, avoiding others and practicing a negative mindset).

When we help others heal, we heal.. It helps us challenge habits of negative thinking, (about how horrible, unkind, and unsafe the world is) because: "when we show

compassion and kindness we believe that maybe things are not so bad and others may share these values as well."

If we act as strong positive people with righteous values, we know there are others out there too. We must release that other people do good every day for every bad person out there there are those doing good.

It's not that you have to step into bad areas with a gold Rolex on and not keep your wits about you. But you need to acquire a balanced view of the world.

Tip 3 - Get Great Sleep

Poor sleep can impact anxiety by up to 30 - 40% percent. The numbers may be higher

depending on how bad a nights sleep you got. Sleep is very underestimated, not only for general fitness, but for the large amount of mental health issues it can cause if sleep is poor.
Visit the sleep section in this book for an understanding of how to excel in this area.

Tip 4 - Seek Help - Try EDMR Therapy or CBT

Seeking help is the most important tip. Don't delay it, because untreated anxiety can sometimes not get better without professional intervention.

EDMR therapy is a intense form of therapy that really helps if you have a lot of panic attacks, traumas or anxiety considered on the high end of the scale.

I have spoke to clients that have had great results with this therapy. CBT therapy is also a great option.

With correct medication and therapy selected, anxiety is a highly treatable disorder and your symptoms can become nonexistant.

Tip 5: Avoid Caffeine, Alcohol, And Drugs.

Caffeine is a stimulant, and stimulants naturally spike anxiety and make your heart race faster, not what you want when you are trying to keep your anxiety at bay.

Alcohol simply wrecks your mental health in numerous ways. I always noticed whenever a client of mine had a panic attack, I would ask

them if the drank alcohol that week. The answer would be yes a lot of the time.

Drugs such as cannabis, and hard drugs, are a no go for a person suffering with anxiety.

The paranoia that you feel on these drugs after the initial high, causes your anxiety levels to spike.

Tip 6: Challenge Catastrophic Thoughts And Thoughts That Lead To More Anxiety.

People with anxiety tend to think in catastrophic thoughts. Thoughts like:

"My relationship is going to suffer."
"I'm going to loose my job."
"My partner doesn't love me."

Once you allow those thoughts to spiral, panic attacks can start.

CBT is the main tool therapists use to help challenge these thoughts.

Here is an exercise:

Write down a belief that you have been telling yourself recently (that continues to make you anxious).

Ask the questions:

If my best friend or someone I love came to me and made this statement, what would I say to them?

Will I feel the same way about this situation in 10 years?

Will this seem as important or urgent in the future?

Would I lack compassion for my child or spouse as I do for myself?

If I had to defend this belief in a courtroom, would I be able to prove it to a jury? Do I have ample evidence to support this belief?

Do I have any evidence that actually contradicts my belief?

Is this belief a fact or based on a feeling?

Does this thought seem extreme or unbalanced in any way? Is there a middle ground?

Is there a way I can look on the positive side of this thought?

After you identify that a thought is unhelpful, look for ways to reframe it as a positive thought.

Look for ways to look on the bright side, and the best possible scenario instead of the worst.

You can work through your traumas and anxiety inducing thoughts with CBT workbooks. You can also work with a CBT

therapist to explain you want to work on these type of thoughts.

Tip 7 - Read Some Books To Help You Take Action

I have compiled a list of well reviewed books that my clients have used to help themselves through this difficult condition:

DARE by Barry McDonagh. This is the main book most of my clients recommend for anxiety. It identifies with the condition and provides practical examples to help.

Hope And Help For Your Nerves by Dr. Claire Weekes (Audiobook) (Teaches you to ride the wave of anxiety.)

The Anxiety and Phobia Workbook by Bourne (helps with panic attacks. They have a list of affirmations/sayings that you can recite when you feel a panic attack coming on)

Faith G. Harper's Unfck Your Anxiety and Coping Skills: Tools & Techniques for Every Stressful Situation. *Any of her Unf*ck series may fit. They are short reads with just enough science to help with understanding but mostly full of concrete strategies and tips.

"Overcoming Anxiety, Worry, and Fear" by Gregory Jantz (Easy to read and is written by a counselor. Designed to help you isolate the sources of your anxiety and teach you techniques to manage/cope with stress.)

Tip 8 - Balance Your Lifestyle

Even though our aim is to push ourselves to leave comfort zones and conquer anxieties, we must balance this out with self care.

Self care isn't staying at home avoiding everything as we talked about, but you can make sure your life isn't a complete roller coaster of adrenaline as well.

If our life is always loud music, clubs, driving fast, pushing your comfort zone 24 / 7, then you can be facing your fears. But it can lead to even more anxiety.

Where we push for change is very important.

Of course, we want to push for change in areas such as leaving the house, social

interaction, going to the gym, surrounding ourself with people and feeling safe. Phobias in these areas really hold us back.

Any unfounded phobia that holds us back from exercising or functioning as happy people who look after ourselves in our day to day life is worth addressing.

It doesn't mean we have to go above and beyond this, or do crazy things to try and fix these phobias by leading a **hectic** lifestyle.

Do not neglect the side of your soul that needs to be at peace. You'll notice a correlation between how hectic your life is and how much anxiety you feel. Where you choose to push for change is important.

Let's say for example you have some social anxiety. If you choose to combat that by going to loud club environments daily, it is **great** that you are trying.

But if your lifestyle then becomes drinking alcohol, always " switched on" and always in a state of adrenaline activities, you can end up sabotaging your progress.

You could just as easily build social interaction in some kind of class, a yoga class or something similar.

When you take steps to zen out your life, you can notice a reduce in anxiety too. The balance is that you need to be working on your anxieties every day, but don't let that consume your whole life!

We **established** that you don't want to stay at home, but we also established you don't want to have a crazy, no sleep, constantly crazy lifestyle either. High stress lifestyles and high stimulating lifestyles can contribute a lot to feelings of anxiety.

To balance this out:

- Get A Massage
- Try Yoga Classes
- Meditate And Tell Yourself Positive Things
- Light Swimming (Proven To Be One Of The Leading Exercises For Anxiety Reduction)
- Life Journalling With Peaceful Music Playing
- Read A Self Improvement Book

Dealing With Panic Attacks

Manage panic attacks by accepting them and getting stronger at realising they are just adrenaline. Every panic attack you conquer is your body getting used to them and realising they cannot kill you.

Sometimes, when a person's anxiety builds to a certain point, a panic attack happens.

This can be confusing to both the person and the people around them, especially on the first time it happens.

If you are the person having the panic attack, it can feel like you are going to have a heart attack.

Here are some common myths about panic.

"I'm going crazy."

Unlikely. Panic can feel intense, but it's not psychosis. It doesn't involve delusions or hallucinations—just your body's alarm system activating.

"I'm losing control."

No. It may feel that way, but your fight-flight-freeze response is designed to protect you. In reality, your body becomes quicker, stronger, and more alert.

"My body is going to shut down."

Not happening. Your nervous system is built

to activate *and* calm down. Panic won't wear out your body—it's temporary.

"I'm having a heart attack."

Very unlikely. Panic attacks and heart attacks feel different. Your heart rate during panic is usually lower than during intense exercise or a real cardiac event.

"I'm going to faint."

Unlikely. Fainting comes from *low* blood pressure, while panic raises it. You might feel dizzy, but that's not the same as passing out.

Panic attacks are scary, but they aren't dangerous. Now I am going to explain how to deal with a panic attack.

What to Do When Panic Hits

You can have two different types of panic attack. A panic attack that builds slowly with thoughts of unsettlement, racing what if thoughts, and generally worrying about danger or embarrassment. Or sometimes you can have sudden panic attacks out of nowhere where your heart starts to race.

Step 1: Stay Safe

- Sit or lie down safely
- Remind yourself: **"This is a panic attack. It is scary, but not dangerous."**

What to do:

1. **Label the thoughts:** "I'm having catastrophic thoughts. These are not

real danger." Name sensations and emotions: "Heart racing. Fear rising. I can feel this and still be safe."

2. **Use grounding:** Counting down 5-4-3-2-1 helps bring you back into the present. You can also touch an object to make you realise you are still here and can feel your body in the moment. Look around and name 5 things you see, 4 things you touch, 3 things you hear (grounding)

3. **Use box breathing:** 4seconds inhale, 4 seconds hold and 4 seconds exhale
4. **Reframe it:** "This is scary, but my body is safe." "It is just adrenaline."
5. **Redirect attention:** Gentle activity if possible (walk, fold laundry, draw, light TV) or stay still.

6. **Ride it out:** Panic peaks ~10 minutes, then naturally decreases, sometimes you can get repeated attacks and feel hungover for the rest of the day, but tell yourself: “this is temporary, it is going to pass soon.
7. **Optional journaling:** After panic passes, jot down what happened — helps with exposure learning.

How To Respond During a Flashback

Sometimes you will get intense flashbacks if your anxiety is triggered by a serious event. This is when your anxiety matches the description of PTSD.

Grounding Is Key

A. Remind the brain you're in the present:

- Name the room, objects, sounds, temperature
- "I am here. I am safe. This is a memory, not happening now."

B. Mindful awareness

- Name sensations without judgment: "My heart is racing. My hands are shaking. This is a flashback."
- Accept the feeling instead of fighting it — trying to suppress can **intensify it**

C. Body orientation

- Place feet on the floor, sit upright
- Slowly move hands or touch a nearby object
- Anchors you in the **here and now**

D. Breathing

- Box breathing (4seconds inhale, 4 seconds hold, 4 seconds exhale) to calm nervous system
- Focus on slow exhale → signals safety to body

This is an effective way to navigate a panic attack.

On the other side of this, if you are the person trying to reassure someone through a panic attack:

Firstly, They aren't going to die, they are safe.

Never tell the person to "just stop thinking about it" or try to "snap them out" of it.

The truth is... the attack is going to run for a minimum of 10 minutes, and can last up to an hour if there are repeated attacks. It's going to be difficult and uncomfortable at times, and there's no rushing a person through a panic attack.

The adrenaline won't simply stop flowing through there body because you said so. You have to face the fact a panic attack will take time to run it's course and accept that.

My best advice would be to display no panic in your own actions. If you yourself panic when someone else is going through a panic attack, and show it on your face, it will make the person panic more.
You have to strike a balance between caring for them, asking if they are ok, but also

showing that there is nothing scary going on in the room, and that life is continuing as normal.

Don't start jumping around, hyperventilating and mirroring their anxiety. You are this persons rock, showing them calmly that everything is ok.

I understand it can be awkward when a person is not responding to you for half an hour straight, you feel like you are checking up on them and saying the same things for an hour and nothing is working. But there is no rushing a panic attack.

You have to understand that it takes time for them to return a relaxed state of mind. For you, it may feel like an hour out of your time,

where you are going around in circles repeating to the person that it is going to be ok, but for the person having the panic attack it's even worse!

Time goes extremely slow for them. It can feel like an eternity, a 20 minute panic attack can feel like 4 hours for them.

My **best** advice is to make the situation as chilled as you possibly can.

Don't turn off all the lights and all the TV and hide them under the covers unless they specifically want that. That can sometimes signal that "it's panic attack time" and something is wrong.
Almost like you are taking cover and protecting yourselves. Don't signal that anything is wrong.

Go about your moment with this person, without panicking yourself. If they want the TV on you can watch TV, if they want it off that's ok too.

Try to show this person that you are sharing a normal, safe environment and there is nothing in the atmosphere to suggest otherwise.

Also understand the person may need a mixture of comfort and space going through this moment. There is a balance to be found.

You will be able to tell that sometimes the person going through the attack needs space. I'm not saying to ignore the person or leave the room, but go about your business showing them that your still in the room

present with them and near them, and that the day is going on, with no danger around.

Don't sit there tense or awkwardly. Answer some emails on your phone, be nearby for them. You don't want to smother them when you can tell they don't want that.

You don't want to be asking the same question "are you ok?" every 10 seconds and clinging onto them when they are agitated.

In these moments you can simply just watch the TV or sit on your phone, stay near them, and be still. Not panicking, not smothering, simply there.

Of course you don't want to take this too far, and ignore them completely.

Every once in a while, you want to hug them if possible and repeat the following statements:

"I'm here for you."
"It's going to be Ok."
"Breathe with me: In 4 seconds. Hold 4 seconds. Out 4 seconds."
"You are safe"
"Do you know where you are"
"Do you need anything"
"Nothing here can hurt you"
"Take your time, I'm here."

Use their reaction to see if they want you directly next to them, or simply around. If you need to leave the room to get something, let them know so they know you are coming back.

Your job isn't really to snap of them out of this, because panic attacks simply need to run their course.

Your job is to simply be there. Don't think you are doing something wrong if you can't "snap them out of it" because the person will be thankful when you are simply there for them.

Show them that you are present, that nothing bad is in the room, and you are getting on with your day as if there is no danger.

Once they see there is no danger, they start to relax too, but they still need time to come out of the attack.

Final Thoughts - Anxiety & Panic

To conclude, you can tackle your anxiety through a few routes:

- Psychotherapy (councilling)
- EDMR Therapy (seen to be very effective)
- Medication
- Good Sleep
- No Alcohol
- No Drugs
- No Caffeine after midday (12pm) or at all.
- Gradual Exposure To Events That Cause Anxiety
- Social Interaction
- Frequent Exercise
- Tackling Thoughts That Lead To Anxiety

If you feel the symptom of anxiety, I want to tell you it's better to get help rather than try to deal with it all on your own.

Take action sooner rather than later, so you can be the person you want to be! This book can give you some good pointers, but it is important most of all to seek a professional therapist and medical help too if this is a real issue for you.

Take the step you know you need to take. Life will reward you.

Regardless of how long you have been dealing with
anxiety, or when or where or who it came from, it can be changed. I will leave you with a quote.

"We have the power to change our belief systems at any point in our lives. We have the power to change our story."

When it comes to anxiety, action is not always easy. You aren't always going to feel like it.

But if you can just commit to leaving feelings out of it, and go to the gym anyway, or go out anyway, then we have a chance at beating the condition that destroys our chances to experience positive emotions.

Let's just commit to go do the thing that we know will lead us towards our desired outcome of being healthier, happier, more peaceful people.

This rule has been the single most helpful, life- changing rule for most of the clients who have been able to accept it and start changing behavior.

Especially if you have difficulty with the basics. If you have difficulty in social interactions, driving, shopping, and other essential activities of daily living, then mastering this rule may just change your life..
sometimes things feel worse before they get comfortable. Stay in this battle because it will pay off!

I hope this section helps you in your journey against anxiety. You have a greater potential to face this fear more than you know.

“Feel the fear and do it anyway.”

Processing Traumas

Sarah sits on a park bench every Sunday morning with her journal. She's been doing this for three months now. Her friends think she's "working on herself." Her therapist calls it "processing time."

She writes about the same betrayal every week. She cries. Then Monday comes, and by Wednesday, she's overthinking again.

She wonders: is this what healing looks like, or am I just making myself worse?

She wonders a lot of things:

- When she should complain, when she should move on.
- What kind of things to “let go” of in favor of positivity, and what kind of

things she should journal to avoid bottling up.

- She wonders the right way to write about things in her journal to actually allow her to “let go” of such issues, so they don’t return to haunt her.

Many people like Sarah, need extra direction in processing their traumas.

Unprocessed traumas can link to a wide range of other issues such as anxiety and overthinking.. I am going to take you through some ways to process traumas in a healthy way.

A balance point is possible to find. One of the main things I see is people who are confused about what they should process and what they shouldn’t.

They don't know if they should be the type of person who is "positive all the time?" and bottle everything up. Or the person who "lets everything out" at all times and risks building constant complaining and overthinking into their character?

The truth is you can find a healthy balance. It is important for your future. I have helped many people to find this balance.

You see, I find that some people want to be positive all the time, they are scared if they focus too much on negativity or life issues that they will become negative.

Especially in self help books like this, people do get encouraged to think positively, but when does it all become toxic?

When do we actually “let go” of our pains and choose positive thinking, and when do we actually process things?

Here is the basic rule.

If a thought that keeps surfacing is a genuine trauma or a serious life event with real weight — do not bury it. You cannot simply "be positive" your way through something that genuinely needs processing.

Set aside dedicated time, use **CBT techniques**, and work through this properly. You need to process.

If it is a daily stress — an argument, a worry, something that will not matter in six months or a weeks time — the general rule is to let it go.

Use **mindfulness** to feel the thought, "let go" of the thought, remain living in the moment, and redirect yourself towards positivity.

Use CBT when:

- A thought feels **very real**
- You're avoiding stuff because of it
- You've never really questioned it before

CBT helps you **break the illusion**.
Use mindfulness when:

- You're stuck in loops
- You've already analyzed it 100 times
- Your brain won't shut up

Mindfulness helps you **stop feeding the loop**.

Rehearse stress every night and you become a stressed person. Rehearse ease and you become easy-going.

Allowing negative thoughts that won't matter in a week to repeatedly anger you is a one-way ticket to becoming an angry personality with chronic complaining built into your character.

You are training yourself every single day. The question is: what are you training yourself to become?

There are two modes of mental work

1. **Deep processing (CBT-style behavioral exposure or reflection)**
    - Sitting down, facing feelings/thoughts fully

- Working through blame, guilt, fear
- Reframing thoughts until they stop coming back
- This is powerful, but **time and energy intensive**

2. **Mindfulness / gratitude / daily life focus**

    - Not analyzing or processing every thought
    - Letting thoughts exist without spiraling
    - Choosing where to place attention
    - Filling your day with positivity and engagement

- This is lighter, sustainable, prevents overthinking
- Directing your thoughts to positive outcomes and choosing to let go

Y**ou can't live in a CBT mode all day every day** without it becoming unhealthy. Even CBT acknowledges this — exposure and processing are **tools**, not life-long states.

How to know which mode to use

A simple way to think about it:

Signal	Use CBT-style deep processing	Use mindfulness / gratitude
Thought is **stuck and unresolved over a long term period**	✓	✗
Thought is **looping and unhelpful**	✗	✓
You feel **stuck, unable to function**	✓	✗
You feel **drained by overthinking**	✗	✓
There is a **deadline, family, work**	✗	✓

- CBT-style is for **rare, intense unresolved issues**
- Mindfulness / Gratitude = for **daily maintenance, preventing overthinkings that don't serve us**

Why both are necessary

- **Deep processing** helps you permanently resolve things that actually matter
- **Mindfulness / gratitude** prevents "mental clutter" from taking over your life

  Too much of either can be harmful:

  - Excessive processing → chronic rumination, anxiety

- Pure mindfulness / avoidance → unprocessed trauma or unresolved issues

Mindfulness is better for **day-to-day mental hygiene**. Deep reflection is for when the brain literally **cannot relax** until it processes something important.

Daily/ordinary negative thoughts
Examples:

- Someone annoyed you at work
- Minor arguments or misunderstandings
- Small regrets or mistakes
- "I'm frustrated with my partner/friend/family"
- Minor relationship issues

What to do:

- Practice **mindfulness**: notice the thought, don't argue with it
- Practice **gratitude**: shift attention to what went well, the thought will likely pass within the next day.
- Let it **pass naturally**

2. Rare, intense, unresolved thoughts
Examples:

- Death of a loved one
- Major trauma or accident
- Serious betrayal or relationship rupture
- Life-changing regret or failure that keeps replaying

What to do:

- Give yourself **intentional processing time** (set yourself a quite place, 2 hours of your time on a Sunday and work through it)
- **Set a time limit** you think is reasonable (1–2 hours)
- Process: acknowledge, reflect, reframe, accept
- When time's up → **move on to normal life**

The Goal is to resolve the thought so it doesn't keep returning, processing it fully until your brain can let it go.

Finding The Balance

The question I get asked most in this area is:
"Do I just have to be positive all the time?"
No. Know when to process and when to let go.

The trick is to know when to be easy going and when you have an actual trauma or deeper life event to work through. If the latter is the case, that is when you block aside a day, and dedicate it to the issue.

Even then, rest assured you wont be "complaining" or overthinking the issue, but actively trying to use CBT techniques on yourself to find a solution as well as process how you are going to cope with this issue.

CBT techniques to process an issue are as follows:

Step 1: Go To a Quiet Place Where You Can Concentrate

Work through your issue in a quiet place.

Step 2: Identify The Thought Clearly

Write it down in one sentence. Make it specific.
Example:

- “I feel guilty for yelling at my friend yesterday.”
- “I keep thinking I failed my project and I’m not good enough.”

Tip: The clearer the thought, the easier it is to process.

Step 3: Examine The Thought Like a Detective

Ask yourself **CBT-style questions**:

1. **Evidence for it:** What's the proof this is true?
2. **Evidence against it:** What's the proof it's not fully true?
3. **Am I thinking in extremes or all-or-nothing terms?**
4. **Am I blaming myself unfairly?**

Write your answers honestly — no sugarcoating.

Step 4: Explore The Feelings

- Identify the emotions attached (anger, sadness, guilt, fear).
- Rate intensity 1–10.
- Ask yourself: **"What is this emotion trying to tell me?"**

Example: guilt → "I care about my friend and I want to repair the relationship."

Step 5: Reframe Or Challenge The Thought

After examining the evidence and feelings, write a **balanced, realistic version** of the thought.
Example:

- Original: "I'm a terrible friend for yelling."

- Reframe: “I lost my temper, but I usually treat my friends well. I can apologize and repair this.”

Step 6: Acceptance And Closure

Ask yourself journal prompts like:

- “Have I seen all sides of this situation?”
- “Can I accept that I did my best given the circumstances?”
- “Is there anything else I need to do to make this right?”
- Is there a way I can move forwards from this without feeling negative? What way is that?
- “Can I let this go now and move on?”

Step 7: Optional Next Steps (If Needed)

If an action is needed (apology, task, learning lesson) → plan **it exactly.**
If nothing is actionable → practice **letting go**.
After closing the journal → switch attention to something **neutral or positive** (walk, tea, music, gratitude list).

Seek Self Forgiveness and Positive Solutions

Always think of ways to forgive yourself and ways you can move on from a trauma.

If you didn't do your best in one situation, ask yourself: does that mean you're not still

a top achiever overall? You're still on the road to greatness.

Maybe the situation wasn't important to you, or maybe you got distracted by something you shouldn't have.

Everyone gets distracted from time to time—but does that really mean you're an unfocused person, when 9 times out of 10 you're on the ball?

Simply aim to do better next time.

Worksheets that aid this process are often called ABC worksheets or challenging thoughts worksheets. They look like this:

ABC Worksheet

A: Activating Event	B: Beliefs/Thoughts	C: Consequences
What situation happened that triggered thoughts and feelings that made me unhappy or led me to behave in a certain way?	What are my beliefs about the situation? What are the thoughts in my head?	How do I feel right now? How do I want to act or behave?

1. Are my thoughts in column B realistic or helpful?

_____
_____
_____

2. What is the healthier thought I can tell myself on such occasions in the future?

_____
_____
_____

First We Ask:

What situation happened that triggered thoughts and feelings that made me unhappy or led me to behave in a certain way?

What are my beliefs about the situation? What are my *automatic* or *habitual* thoughts that keeping going through my head?

What do I tend to think
in situations like this? How do I feel right now? (Recall the primary *biologically-driven* emotions of happiness, sadness, anger, anxiety or fear, and disgust, as well as more *socially-driven* emotions like shame and guilt).

How did I (or do I want to) act or behave?

Then We Ask:

Are my thoughts in column B realistic or helpful?

Would they hold up in a court of law? If my best friend made this comment, would I agree?

And Finally:

What would be a healthier, more logical/rational, or more helpful thought or belief I tell myself in situations like this in the future?

If you have unresolved traumas, working through them like this with a therapist and in your own time can really help you.

Finally, to resolve traumas you can explore EDMR therapy. It is a newer form of therapy. It is intense, but it is proven to be very effective for working through traumas.

I have received very good reviews on it from some of the people I have worked with who have been through this therapy. If it is available in your country, I suggest you check it out.

Grief And Loss

No matter how strong you are, no matter how disciplined, no matter how much you

have built — loss finds you. It finds everyone at least once in their life.

But there is a way to carry grief that does not break you.
I have extensive experience with this and I want to help you explore the possibility that you are going to come out of grief, grow as a person, and live a very positive life.

This really matters, losing someone can really make or break who you become as a person, we want our lives to take a positive direction over a negative direction in all circumstances. I am going to get into 5 tips to manage grief to help you.

Tip 1: Be Compassionate With Yourself And Others.

Try not to place a timeline or a set of expectations on yourself or others. Grief takes time and everyone grieves differently. Be patient and kind. Remember your "compassion statement."

I am having a hard moment… hard moments are a part of life. May I be kind to myself.

Tip 2: Ride The Initial Few Months Without Doing Anything Stupid

Try not to make irreversible, impulsive, life-altering decisions when you are in crisis.

Wait until things calm down before you decide to quit your job, get married, get divorced, drink heavily, shave off your hair, move out of the country, or anything crazy.

Just wait.

Now — in the early days, the only objective is to get through the initial shock. The first weeks are raw.

Everyone reacts differently. Some people drive around at night recklessly feeling like the wheels might as well leave the road. Others go quiet and stay inside.

Whatever your version looks like, know that it is normal. The best thing you can do in that immediate period is avoid alcohol, keep

up with your friends, and keep moving. Make the healthy choices.

Tip 3: Honor The Person

"You are suffering a loss; if you have lost a loved one, then know that you do not honor them by also forfeiting your life (physically or mentally). You honor them by living, by thriving, and you know in your heart that is exactly what they would want for you."

Tip 4: Don't Try To Do It Alone

We do not succeed alone. We need people, and we heal and process best in the context of our close relationships with other people.

Social support is the key to healing
and recovery, so if you have limited social
support, then find a
group, or seek professional help.

When our minds are closed, we
see no help available even though it may be
right in front of us. But,
when our minds are open, there are infinite
possibilities and plenty of
support.

Tip 5: Don't Feel Guilty About Recovering Fast (or Slow)

The first thing I want to say is this: never feel guilty about recovering. That guilt — the feeling that laughing again means you have forgotten, that building something good somehow dishonours the person you lost —

is one of the heaviest things a person can carry.
And when you examine it honestly, it is the opposite of what they would want for you.

Tip 6: Make A Promise

The most powerful thing I have ever suggested to someone carrying grief is to make a promise. Not a vague intention. A real, spoken, committed promise — to the person you lost — that you are going to live the best possible life in their name.

That you are going to take the love you have for them and pour it into everything you build.

The reason this works is simple. Once that promise is out there, you cannot take it back.

The loss does not disappear — but it transforms. It stops being only a weight and starts becoming a fuel.

Every time you want to quit, every time you feel like giving up on yourself, you remember the promise. You come back to it. And you keep going.

There is no rush, but there will come a day — you will know roughly when — where you feel ready to make that promise.

Tip 7: Understand This Makes You Stronger, Not Weaker

People who have loved and lost deeply often become the most purposeful people in a room. They understand, in a way others do not yet, how finite all of this is. How much

every single day counts. That understanding is painful to earn. But it is one of the most powerful forces a person can possess.

You are only weaker, or broken, or mentally shaken, if you allow the situation to make you feel that way.

Imagine waking up one day — not so far from now — and the image of the person you lost is still there, but the grief no longer runs you. You think of them and smile before you cry. The life you are building has become, in itself, a monument to who they were. And when someone asks what drives you, their name is part of the answer.

That is not a fantasy. That is achievable. One day you will sit there, able to celebrate their life, and feel — for the first time in a long

time — genuinely proud of the person you are becoming.

Make sure to make them proud.

I remember my own story, my mother passed away in the hospital in my early twenties. I made a last promise to her that I would start my charity to help people, that I would be the best man I could be and that I would look after my family for her.

Maybe I had a lot to be guilty about. I was rarely around in her last months. I was off studying caring more about business.

I was a troublesome teenager who gave her too much trouble. My family had to move house because I got into so much trouble in my old area!

It's a deep thing to admit, but I missed the final moments of my mother's life, due to caring for another family member that was overdosing.

In someone else's mind, that might be a lot of reasons to feel guilty.

Nowadays I can go to the church and light a candle for my mother, feeling mentally healthy about it. In fact I am usually in quite a good mood actually.

I used to avoid thinking about the anniversary of her passing, and I would avoid looking at pictures. But joy is now restored to my life.

All that stuff is normal to me and there are no issues. Time really fixes everything, and

you will be able to live a normal and happy life again too. Follow the principles above and keep your head up!

Heartbreak

Heartbreak, surprisingly, can be very similar to grief and loss in terms of the advice I give to my clients. You are losing someone close to you. A lot of the same advice applies. Here are 7 tips to help you conquer this life situation and what to do to come out on the other side smiling.

Tip 1: Get Through The Initial Crisis Safely

Firstly, the first week or month is going to be hard. It can be tempting to go out drinking, to speed your car around angrily at night

with the intention to hit something or run yourself off the road.

It is a temporary feeling, don't make any mistakes in this first week or two. Spend time with good friends, have a talk, focus on work, remain peaceful with your lifestyle and spend some time reflecting.

Tip 2: There Is Always Something Better Coming

You know the phrase, there is always something better coming? That if you loose somebody, life is preparing you for someone better? 9 times out of 10, that is true. Because nearly 95% of the time, if your connection with the partner you just split up with was truly meant to be, it would have

worked and you wouldn't have broken up. Think about your past.

Anytime I have ever broken up with someone, the next relationship was always better without fail. You know more about what you are looking for, and tend to attract it, spending less time messing around.

You also take the mistakes and all that you learned in your previous relationship and use it as a learning experience to make the next one better.

We become more experienced as we go through life and are able to have better relationships if we have a good mindset towards learning and growing.

Tip 3: Accept That Non Compatibility Isn't Failure

This is only a big deal because we make it. But really it's a natural part of life. There are many good people out there.

Some people move far away from each other. Some people have a great relationship and get on great with each other but it isn't the right time.

Sometimes one person wants kids and another doesn't and that's a dealbreaker. There are so many little personality differences that are unworkable between two otherwise greatly respectful people.

Sometimes you just intuitively know that you had the a great time and a lot of love with someone, and there's nothing

particularly wrong with them, but they aren't the "one" for you.

Maybe it's just something about their personality that you know will never change and they aren't a bad person for it but you know it won't work for you!

Humans are very preoccupied with finding "the one." More so than you would think.

I have seen pretty handsome and rich clients that get broken up with and left for people who are not doing so well and not as conventionally attractive. Even people with great personalities and nothing really wrong with them.

Even great relationships with barely any issues can sometimes break up. There is no rhyme or reason behind it.

Sometimes people just see a person that blows them away and find their “one” and it doesn’t really mean that you are incapable or that you aren’t a high quality person.

Especially when you are the one that has been broken up with, you start to feel as though it was you, you start to feel like you lack something.

That maybe the person your partner chooses to move on with is “better” than you.

But don’t hold yourself back and think like that. The same will happen to you one day, you will just “hit” for someone and they will see you as their “one.”

When you are single again, see it as an opportunity of abundance, to search for and discover that personality type that you really want.

You have probably neglected your friends, and haven't dated certain types of people or from certain cultures before, so use it as an opportunity to explore and find yourself.

Tip 4: Be The Type Of Person That Moves On

I commonly see two types of people when it comes to heartbreaks. The "move - on" ers and the ones that stay stuck in limbo for years and years of their life.

It is one of the hardest things you have to do when you decide someone is not a match for you, or if they decide it. The more you go

through this and make the right choices for yourself the easier it gets.

I looked at the difference between the people who get stuck in limbo, and the people who move on.

One difference I find in the people who move on is that they have more life experience when it comes to heartbreak.

They have been through it a few times, to the point where they are able to see it in an adult way—as part of life, not something devastating or personal.

They've usually had a couple of breakups, maybe even positive relationships that ended on good terms due to minor incompatibilities. Because of this, they see the world in abundance.

There are plenty of great people out there, and every relationship becomes an opportunity to find a better fit, to learn what they actually want, and to understand different personality types.

They get back out there fairly quickly, and over time they get positive reinforcement from real experiences—realising that connection is always possible again when they meet someone new.

After two or three cycles of this, they start to fully internalise that this is just a normal part of life.

We go through life, we give our best to people, and sometimes for whatever reason, it just isn't a fit—and the right thing to do is let it go.

It’s okay. Life works this way. We travel through life trying to find our match, sharing love and experiences with different people along the way.

It doesn’t take away from what you had. You can still look back and appreciate it for what it was—a real connection, a real experience, a real chapter of your life.

But not everyone is meant to be permanent in your life, and that’s okay. You can love someone, appreciate them, and be grateful for what you shared, while also recognizing that your path is meant to continue elsewhere.

Keep on continuing to work on your greatest gifts, and your path will lead to greater things.

Tip 5 - Don't Be The Type Of Person Who Doesn't Move On

So what about the people who don't move on?

These type of people usually have a "the one that got away attitude." A "what if" attitude. You don't want to be the "one that got away" type person.

These people don't pull there boots up by the breaches, and adopt a mature stance.

Usually it's their first love. They don't move on for years so they don't have that positive feedback loop of successfully getting into new relationships and seeing that it's ok. Once you actually do it and see it's ok, the whole process becomes easier.

I always hear the same things with these people. “I’m just not ready yet.” “I don’t want to use these dating apps.”

If you are in this situation. You have to take charge of your own destiny. You have to take action and get that first win of moving on. Because after that it becomes a lot easier.

If you don’t push yourself to get that win soon, you can really stay in this hole for a long time. I’ve seen it happen to people for years, and the longer it goes on, the more stuck in their ways they seem to get.

I appreciate your point of view if you are one of these people, because I know it is hard to move on, and I have been there too. But even if you don’t want to, you have to take that step.

Give someone else a chance, even if you have to give yourself a little push at first, even if you are feeling resistance from your mind, you need to give yourself that "push" to move on. That push is going to get you back to where you need to be.

Tip 6: Be Honest About "Staying in Touch"

I think the hardest part for people to accept is this. We always break up with people and say: "oh we will stay in touch." "We will always care"

People don't want to loose the connection sometimes if the relationship was good.

But usually, realistically, you end up barely speaking to that person again. The reason being is when you move on and when they

move on, it rarely becomes appropriate to do so.

Even if you care. Even if you have no issue with them whatsoever. Your new partner likely wants your undivided attention and it can cause problems if you are constantly talking with the old. Adults understand this.

It's for this reason that you have to be real with yourself, you share these amazing and great moments with someone, and that will always be there.

That person will always be there with you and the lessons you learned should make you smile. It's not that you're "letting go" of them as the memories remain, the respect remains, but it is appropriate to let go of the same contact you had with them once you move on.

And I think this is ok once you do it a few times. You don't hate the person, you actually think highly of them. You aren't ignoring them, or being horrible, it's just the way of this life. And adults understand.

Tip 7: Take Action and Move Forward

At the end of the day, this is the world we live in in 2026. We live in a world where you can access a large collection of single women or men by downloading an app.

The people that do well simply download as many apps as they can, make the effort, message and talk to as many people in life as they can, and they move on.

Sometimes you don't want to in the moment, but it's the right thing for you. You don't have to be the most social person in the pub

anymore, constantly going out drinking to meet someone.

There are routes for everyone now to get out there and date and socialise in many different avenues, online and offline.

Throughout this book we always prioritise taking action, and in break ups you have to as well. This is a part of life, and it is ok.

You may not see it now, but this is just another sign from the universe that your great and loving connection with this person is now complete, and it's time for life to teach you something more about love with someone else.

You are going to be ok, life is showing you that your path is with someone else, depending on how you view it, it's not a

negative, it is simply life showing you the way.

Final Thoughts On Heartbreak

This is such a common issue but it hurts a lot and happens to the best of us. Remember 3 things:

1.You have to let someone go to invite better into your life.

2.There will always be one better.

3.Life will still be great and improve with time.

Disadvantaged Youths With Life Issues

I remember sitting there trying to coach a youth who was shouting that no one understood him.

He felt as though his entire situation was unique and he was so angry at his position in life. He said: *"No one knows how it feels — if you grew up in the same environment as me, you would be just like me."*

He didn't think anyone had been through what he had been through. It wasn't until a colleague of mine challenged him and said:

"Listen, you're not the only one who's been through that. Me and my mates went

through the exact same thing, and we aren't here making excuses. We still made something of ourselves — look, here's the proof."

The youth questioned it at first. But once he genuinely saw direct examples of people who had been through similar — or even worse — circumstances, and had responded with a positive attitude, something shifted. He became inspired and took the step to make a change.

There are limits to what someone can do who has no connection to that world. A rich banker from a wealthy area would struggle to reach a group of kids being thrown out of school with very little going for them.

But if that same banker had come from a similar background to the kids, demonstrated how they went through comparable circumstances and came out the other side — those young people would have a far greater chance of actually listening.

Youths from this background are essentially asking themselves four things:

1. Who is this person?
2. Can I truly relate their circumstances to mine?
3. What are they like as a result — could I be like that?
4. What's in it for me if I do change?

This is why **vulnerability** can really help you. To reach these young people, you have to tell them about a time you were in their position.

What you tried to do to fix it, how you felt emotionally.
Paint the story of you trying and failing, what worked and what didn't, until you finally came out on top.

If you can show them that you have been in a truly **similar** position — and they **believe** you — and then show them that you became a positive person and didn't let anything hold you back, it gives them permission to do the same.

If they have been through something you haven't personally experienced, it is not a lost cause. Find them a clear example of someone who was in a similar position.

Ideally someone whose circumstances are close to theirs — the closer the match, the

more it will land. Show them that example, and show them what that person became.

You can show them **examples** of someone who had it slightly worse than them, but I have found sometimes it's best to find a close match to their current situation so they relate more.

These youths are sometimes looking for an easy way out. Maybe their parents stopped caring.

They are looking to say *"I am this way because of my circumstances"* — and they aren't expecting anyone to challenge them on it.

They may have genuinely never realised there are those who have achieved greatness

under the exact same circumstances. Getting them to realise this can instantly **shift** their attitude.

The case studies you present to disadvantaged youths may look slightly different to those you'd use with young people from more affluent areas — but the principle remains the same.

Show them they are not alone in what they are going through, show them examples of others have conquered their situation, and hold them accountable to doing better.

I coached a lot of young people from South London who would say things like *"What would you know about it?"*

They were convinced their area was different and worse — even when I told them I had grown up in South London myself.

They would say *"the crime is different now, it's not the same"* — even though the city was statistically far safer than when I was growing up.

It was as if they needed their situation to be the worst possible version of reality.

The truth is they weren't the **only** kids growing up rough, there were thousands of areas just like South London.

There are lots of youths who grow up around violence or drugs within their family.

The way you address this is important. They are under the impression that their situation isn't normal. They compare themselves to friends from more comfortable backgrounds and feel like they've been dealt a completely different hand. They don't feel "normal."

But once you help them understand that you have helped many people just like them — that this is actually a **common** challenge you have seen again and again — and that nine out of ten people who face it and don't use it as an excuse end up bettering themselves, they start to feel less abnormal.

They start to question themselves.

Could it be that their issue is in fact commonly worked through in a positive manner? Tell them this, tell them the issue is

common all across the world. Tell them that 9 out of 10 people who go through this issue end up bettering themselves if they are not using it as an excuse, and the 1 out of 10 who continue to have a victim mindset don't make it.

Ask them which one do they want to be?

Their situation may not feel normal within the bubble of their school or their street. They may feel completely alone in it.

But in the grand scheme of the world, what they are going through is happening **every single day** — and positive futures are being built from those exact same starting points, every single day.

Make that known. And guide them, step by step, toward the most confident version of themselves.

One last thing to note when it comes to a youth with a difficult background. You may be the first person in their life who has genuinely **believed** in them. Don't underestimate what that means.

Sometimes that one person is all it takes. Sometimes it is that one kind thing you say that can change the trajectory of someone's entire future.

With a disadvantaged youth, show them it is **possible** to change and that you expect it from them. Despite their circumstances, make them understand you have commonly seen those with their exact circumstances

hold their heads up high and succeed. And you believe they can do it too.

Don’t be soft on them, don’t treat them as special, and don’t treat them as different, just let them know it's possible for them to succeed and it’s in their best interest to do so.

After that, all that's left to do is show up for them **consistently** and apply the same principles of good coaching that you would with any other group as mentioned in this book.

As a final note — one that I find genuinely exciting — those who have been through real life issues often make incredible athletes when they apply themselves.

They often go on to be driven in the world of sports or become very charismatic and inspirational figures if they apply themselves correctly.

People from difficult experiences are able to use the pain they went through as fuel, a kind of drive that is rarely seen.

They can withstand discomfort, take defeats on the chin, and they have no illusions about life being perfect or easy.

That resilience, channeled in the right direction, is one of the most **powerful** things you will ever witness as a coach.

Get them to unlock it.

Drugs / Alcohol

"Your life does not get better by chance; it gets better by change." – Jim Rohn

In this section, we'll dive deeper into one of the most important aspects of improving your mindset and mental health: eliminating drug use.

While we've already touched on the impact of what we consume on our well-being, it's crucial to understand how drugs—no matter how casual or recreational—can hold you back from becoming the person you truly want to be.

The Right Time to Celebrate—Responsibly

"Success is to wake up each morning and consciously decide that today will be the best day of your life." – Ken Poirot

Once you've reached a point where your life is stable, where you're happy, healthy, and thriving, you may wonder if it's okay to celebrate with a drink or a rare party.

The truth is, once you've mastered your life—once you've built a solid foundation of happiness and success—you can make that decision for yourself.

But even then, it's crucial to be aware of the dangers and the slippery slope that substances can lead to.

Tackle Drugs Sooner Rather Than Later!

Drugs are one of the first things I try and tackle when it comes to a person's self improvement journey.

The reason being is because drugs dim the mind to the point where a person will struggle to get anywhere without first quitting the drugs. You need the clarity that quitting drugs and alcohol brings.

People on drugs simply don’t remember the lessons learned, they don’t have the concentration level, and they don’t have the drive or motivation to really tackle the deeper levels of my systems.

Our brains ability to concentrate is so deeply affected by drugs, to the point where I have rarely seen a person on drugs be able to concentrate enough to fix any of the other issues on our list with any kind of lasting effort.

Drugs and alcohol steal your motivation, and they steal your dreams.

Once drugs are cleared from the system, it is like a whole new world opens up where people are able to soak in lessons and make progress. Before that, it is like a barrier is in place in those life that will never be lifted until they quit.

There is one certain fact I have seen time and time again, until you quit drug and

heavy alcohol use, you will always hit a brick wall when it comes to your fitness, mental health, and self improvement. Your brain will simply be too depressed to grasp the concepts of self improvement.

Some people will argue and say you can still make progress whilst on drugs and alcohol, and I'm not saying you can't make slight progress in your life, but it will be next to no progress and there will be a barrier that stops you from progressing.

That barrier will prevent you from elevating past a certain point, and that point is very low in terms of the overall progress you can make. You will be stuck on a very low vibrational energy, and you will be limited to a low level of living.

I am going to give you 6 tips for quitting drugs.

Tip 1 - Get Rid Of The Idea That You Have Caused Irreversible Damage

I had a client called Jason who had done drugs for many many years. He had done drugs to the point where, he had sometimes done 10 times the recommended recreational dose of multiple hard drugs, it was actually a miracle he was still alive in his own words.

Jason told me he was scared when he went to the doctor, and said: “Doc, i think I have messed myself up for life.”

What the doctor said to him brought him to tears. He felt instant peace and release. The doctor told him kindly not to give up.

"As humans, we do not give ourselves enough credit for how good we are at repairing and healing the damage done to ourselves. We are one of the most amazing species in the world for repairing damage.

"Our bodies are amazing, when we get a cut, we bleed but then our skin scabs over and heals. However, your brain is the most exceptional muscle in the human body at healing itself."

How is the brain designed? Well I will tell you, it is designed to repair itself and reach a balanced and natural state, just like our

bodies. Our bodies our expertly designed to repair.

There is little damage you can do to a human brain that in most situations cannot be reversed over time, with correct self care.

Jason was still nervous… “What if I have fried all the cells in my brain?” “What if this is irreversible?” Jason had taken 12 ecstasy pills at a party 5 months ago. The recommended dose is 1 pill.

Ecstasy can cause our brain to release all of its happy chemical, and can be toxic in large amounts such as the amount Jason took. After releasing all of our happy chemical, we can get depressed as it takes a while to produce it back.

Jason had taken a HUGE amount. For months Jason was unable to feel happy. He was very depressed and scared. “Doctor are you sure I haven’t messed myself up for good?”

“Look, actually, the brain simply doesn’t work that way. It’s impossible to mess yourself up for good.”

He then told Jason this:

“When you look at a smoker's lungs, it is very hard for them to get their original lungs back.”
“If a smoker smokes for a few years, when we look at their lungs, they may have already lost around 70% of their lung capacity.

When a smoker quits, they can work back to get to around 50% of their lung capacity. However, they will never reach the full 100% that they had EVER again."

"However..." he told me. "The brain on the other hand... is very good at balancing things out for itself.

Whatever drug you take, whatever abuse you faced, we can give the brain a scan now, it may show some signs of trouble.

But in 2 years of good healthy living, the brain will readjust to its natural state, we will scan it and it will be all clear. The brain is a supercomputer and remarkable at what it does."

This gave Jason a lot of confidence. No matter what drug he had taken, or what event had happened in his life, he realised time is the best healer. After this moment as a young man Jason realised all hope was not lost, and he started on his self improvement journey to improve his life.

Tip 2: Cut Down Slowly If Cold Turkey Doesn't Work

When coaching people I have always found value in cutting them off slowly.

Cold turkey can work for some people, and do it if you think you can handle it, but if the cold turkey isn't working, work to reduce the frequency and amount per day. And even the dosage size.

Try and reduce those numbers until it barely makes a difference if you do the drug or drink the alochol or not, because you are barely having any.

Challenge: Use a little less drink or drugs, every day. Even if it is just reducing your intake by 0.1%, going from 2 joints to 1 and a half.

Going from 3 large rollup cigarettes to 2 big ones and 1 small one. Progressively reduce your intake and see the positivity come out in your life.

If you drink daily, select 3 nights to have your glass of wine. Slowly reduce the amount of nights every month. Then reduce the size of the glasses.

Tip 3: Relapsing: A Winning Mindset

One mindset tip I can give to you is in terms of relapsing. This is useful if you yourself have relapsed, or useful to tell someone who has relapsed.
Don't worry. Relapse is a normal part of the process of making a good change. A relapse is really just an opportunity to learn from your mistake.

It is better to relapse one or two times, than to still be taking drugs. You are still making more progress through relapsing than if you didn't try.

It's better to be in the arena fighting than in the crowd watching. One path pushes you toward your best self, the other keeps you on the sidelines as your life stays unchanged.

The mindset to have is: just because you went back to drugs one time and had a moment of weakness, doesn't mean it's the end of the world and you have to take more!

It may hurt slightly, but its time to get back on track. A self victimizing and feeling sorry for yourself mindset is the worst mindset to have in this situation.

As long as you're progressively using less this week than you were the week before and you stick to reducing dosage and frequency, you'll eventually be OK.
Try to adopt a never miss twice mentality. You missed once, but today it is another chance to do our best. Remember you are a champion for trying, let's get back on track.

Tip 4: Read These 2 Books

The Easy Way To Stop Alcohol & The Easy Way To Quit Smoking by Alan Carr are excellent books. Alcohol will steal your motivation. Steal your dreams. Steal your physique.

The danger of smoking is that it is super counterproductive to your fitness, and can cause poor self esteem, you are not respecting what you put into your body, and as long as you continue to destroy your body, you will find it hard to reach the top levels of a positive mindset. Read these great books for tips on how to navigate the process of quitting these vices.

Tip 5: Journalling Exercise

First write down your vices. (Your addictions)

Write down what this vice gives you. (Such as: Cures boredom. Social Confidence. Pleasure. Note that you are usually using a vice to medicate and run from an issue that you should be solving, try to identify these in this section)

Write down everything this vice is stealing from you. (Every way it is negatively impacting your life.)
Write down in detail what your life will be like in 10 years time if you continue this vice.

Write down where you could be in 10 years if you quit, stayed disciplined, and worked on other more productive areas.

This exercise is going to help you to see the advantages of changing versus the disadvantages of staying the same.

Tip 6: You Are Capable of Greatness

"Strength does not come from physical capacity. It comes from an indomitable will." – Mahatma Gandhi

Remember, you're on a journey to become the best version of yourself, and part of that journey is cutting out the things that no longer serve you.

Drugs might have been a crutch in the past, but you don't need them anymore.

You're stronger than you know, and with each day that you stay committed to your goals and your growth, you're proving to yourself just how capable you are.

By eliminating drugs from your life, you're clearing the path to achieving your dreams.

You're giving yourself the mental clarity, emotional stability, and physical energy needed to reach new heights.

You are capable of greatness, and every step you take toward a healthier, drug-free life brings you closer to the person you were always meant to be.

ADHD / Focus

I was diagnosed with ADHD in school.

Teachers always noticed I couldn't sit still.

I used it as an **excuse** and a disability for most of my life.

Until I entered the real world, where I realized I wanted to be successful.

I realised that in most high paying jobs, concentration simply had to be maintained. I would need to learn how to focus in order to be successful. But it was hard.

I didn't know where to begin.

- I knew I wouldn't get promotions in my current state.
- I knew I wasn't finishing everything I started.
- Things seemed to take so long to build, due to distractions.
- My confidence in being a high achiever felt limited, I felt forgetful, and unfocused, not like the switched-on, organized businessman I felt I needed to be to build my Achieve Greatness business idea.

I tried things like coffee for my concentration, which didn't really work. Supplements were a little bit better, not the ones that are marketed to make money and designed specifically for ADHD, but taking creatine, cod liver oil, vitamin d3 and some magnesium made me feel more focused.

Combining this with a solid **fitness programme** and a healthy diet made me feel even sharper.

But, things still were not perfect, as these were only small changes. Fortunately, I discovered what worked.

One thing I have always felt about ADHD, is that it can worsen or improve based on how you **exercise** your brain.

I wasn't exercising my brain like I was my muscles. Since helping myself and other people through ADHD, I have never seen ADHD as something someone is just "born with" that cannot be fixed.

Our brains and attention span is like our muscles, if we use it, it gets stronger.

We live in a world where we scroll on social media, play a bunch of flashing video games and watch TV shows designed to catch our attention.

We don't really comprehend it but we don't use our attention spans much anymore.

Everything in this world is designed to grab our **attention**. Movies cut scenes every 5 seconds with a new explosion.

Social media videos have developed a preference for quick in your face visuals that change all the time.

This isn't in our heads, the average human could concentrate on a basic task for 150 seconds back in 2003. Now that number is

43 seconds. Our lifestyles are full of completing tasks that don't help our focus at all.

If you took one child who read a lot of books, and compared his attention span to a child that played video games, you would see two distinct strengths and weaknesses.

The child that played video games, wouldn't be likely to have a good concentration span, but would have a good reaction time. This is due to them reacting quickly to the images they see on the screen.

The child that reads would actually have a **better** attention span.

Reading books strengthens sustained, focused attention. Video games simply

improve rapid short term attention to immediate surroundings, but again, it is the focused **long term** attention we need to actually concentrate in everyday life.

This is why I believe ADHD can be completely cured or at the very least minimized and directed towards productive things with the right lifestyle.

I don't see it as a disability, and it can even be a superpower if used in the right way... If you point me to a person who played video games their whole life, smokes weed, uses their phone a lot, doesn't **read** or **meditate**, and told me they had been diagnosed with ADHD, I would not be surprised in the slightest.

ADHD is a spectrum, and they have likely placed themselves on a higher end of it by their lifestyle.

But no matter where someone lands on this spectrum, there are always improvements we can make to improve their quality of life and focus.

Here are 5 tips to work towards self improvement in the area of ADHD:

5 Tips To Improve ADHD

Tip 1: Avoid Drugs

Firstly avoid weed and alcohol, this completely destroys what little attention span we have.

Tip 2: Follow Your Purpose.

Those with ADHD are actually able to hyperfocus and concentrate MORE, as long as they truly enjoy the task they are doing.

This means a person with ADHD will sit there shaking there leg, waiting to escape from a conversation they don't find interesting, but when they find it interesting or think it can benefit them in some way, they can remain focused for hours.
It's why you could take a child with ADHD, who cannot sit and listen to their geography lesson in school, but can sit and play the piano for 8 hours.

They can become really great at piano, but due to the ADHD would still have issues because, they would likely play their favorite

songs for hours and not focus on the songs they didnt like.

What I am saying is the ability to **hyperfocus** is a blessing, but we have to find the tasks that unlock it. Those tasks are usually our deeper life purpose.

Then we have to work on staying focused for tasks we don't really like as much to balance things out. I will explain more how to do that in the next tip.

The two examples I have given you so far will help you, but they aren't fixes.

What actually fixed it for me this...

Tip 3: Meditation

This single handedly, helped me the most with ADHD. It improves my concentration and control of my thoughts by actually training my brain to focus.

We cannot improve from ADHD medicines alone, but by actually training the brain and putting in the repetitions to make our focus better.

Meditation allows us to work our attention span like a muscle. To put it simply, a simple meditation flow is this: you breathe in for 7 seconds and you breathe out for 4 seconds. Picture only your breath, you are breathing in positivity and breathing out negativity.

Whenever you get distracted (which you will) and you realise you lost focus, don't feel bad, simply identify that you got distracted and bring your attention back to your breath.

The act of getting distracted, **realizing** you got distracted, and then bringing yourself back into focus again is like 1 repetition of a weight in the gym.

The more **repetitions** you do of meditation, the stronger your focus and attention span will get. Apply it to your everyday life.

I know some of you may doubt this, but I can assure you, you reach a level of attention span that improves your life in every way.

I ended up being able to **identify** when I was getting distracted in classes, or when I was

sinking into negative thought processes or getting angry, and I was able to bring myself straight back into positive alignment.

Don't doubt the power of this skill!

Tip 4: Reading

Reading improves deep concentration. The exact type of concentration you need to beat ADHD.

Tip 5: Reduce Screen Time

If we just sit and binge watch TV, things will never change.

Those with ADHD need peaceful environments. Go to the library to get work done, turn off your phone notifications.

On your phone, when you want to get work done, keep it in the bag. There is a setting on your phone that will show you how much **screen time** you use per day.

On iPhones it literally displays it on your front screen so you always see it once you turn the setting on. Turn this setting on.

When I first used it, I was thinking it would say 30 minutes for my own screen time.

The result shocked me... There were some days it said 5 hours.

This is a really big addiction for many people.

To level up your concentration, actually do periods of deep work, in quiet places and leave your phone out of it. Get that screen time down.

A study took two groups of people, both groups were placed in a room and told to complete some work for an hour.

One group of people had access to their mobile phones, and were able to read messages from friends.

The others smoked weed but were not allowed their phones.

The group that smoked weed literally performed significnatly better and got more work done than those that were allowed the phones.

Practice periods of undisturbed work.

Final Thoughts On ADHD

Even if you have been told your whole life you have some kind of "disability," you should know that you have **unlimited** positive potential.

Many of the most **successful** people carry traits of ADHD and it is not any kind of death sentence on your ability to concentrate for the rest of your life.

Through applying different techniques and committing to the lifestyle changes discussed in this chapter, you may in some cases be able to focus **more** than others.

Especially when it comes to things you really care about and following your dreams. And through training your brain through meditation and removing distractions, you can learn how to stay present during tasks you don't enjoy as much too.

There is great value in following the above steps. You can access more creative power, becoming a person with the ability to finish things, as well as the person who has the ability to focus on demand.
That ability is reachable through practice and commitment.

Imagine who you could **become** if you trained your focus every single **day** for the next year.

Every time you choose to sit down and concentrate, you're getting stronger.

I wouldn’t let a diagnosis hold you back...

ADHD becomes a superpower when that person finds their purpose and combines it with trained attention.

You already likely have the rare ability to hyperfocus to some degree when you really enjoy something. In some cases for up to 8 hours or more.

An ADHD person who consistently practises meditation and deep work over time develops an attention span that surpasses the average person on tasks they don't enjoy. Not just catches up. Surpasses. Because they have been forced to train that muscle harder than most people ever bother to.

And they still have the hyperfocus ability sitting there for when it matters most.

So what you are actually working with is this. A brain that with the right training can outlast the average person on the boring stuff, and then absolutely demolish them on the things it loves.

That is not a bad hand to be dealt. That is actually an incredible one once you understand how to play it.

The goal is not to suffer through a life you hate. The goal is to train the mind, find your purpose, and stack both advantages at once. When you do that, very few people can compete with you.

Life is about playing to your strengths.

In this distracted world, those who are willing to make the minor improvements that others won't, are the ones that end up the most productive.

Use these techniques to separate yourself from the distracted majority, and build your focus.

There's something really powerful about taking something a person has been told is a weakness their whole life — been pulled out of class for, been made to feel broken over, maybe even been medicated for — and showing them that with the right approach it was actually an advantage the whole time.

That reframe is genuinely life changing for the right person reading it. Your brain is a weapon, not a problem.

How to Find The Balance When Helping People

This section is for those who feel they have been burned before by giving too much of themselves and want to learn how to help sustainably.

One thing I wanted to go over is how to help you find that balance between helping someone and knowing when to stop and live your own life too.

Finding this balance is important: you don't want to set yourself on fire to keep others warm. How do I approach this?
Firstly, you need to know as a coach that you can't help everyone.

Even if you are the best coach in the world, there are some people in life who are just too stubborn to change, even the best coaches come across this.

There is no “perfect thing” to say to this type of person, because they are too stubborn and haven’t made the choice themselves to change.

If you hear no “change talk” whatsoever, and that person simply doesn’t care to be helped or coached, it’s sometimes best to detach from them.

If they question why their life is not improving, you just tell them “well its because you didn’t take this step that is necessary” and keep contact to a minimum until you hear the actual change talk coming.

Other times you may be helping people with really hard lives. OR really negative people going through serious bouts of depression.

Perhaps a family member is going through a trauma or drug or alcohol related issue. They show signs of wanting to change when you ask them if they truly are happy with the position they are in, you can hear the "change talk."

This is usually some form of: "I want to change, BUT..."

With these people, the technique I told you in a previous chapter where you hone in on their "change talk" and not on their sustain talk is super important.

Not just for their mental benefit, but for yours too. You need to find the balance between having hours of negative conversations where someone vents with you, and positive productive conversations.

This is so you yourself don't **burn out** helping someone. You see some people are just in a very negative place and you yourself may not wish to spend hours in a negative place with someone.

You want to help them.

Yes you are doing them a service to listen to them, and if they are telling you things, it is a good sign because they put their trust in you. They see you as somewhat of a leader in their life.

But how you respond and react to them and guide them through there issues will dictate whether they simply trust you enough to vent, or whether they trust you enough to actually help them through, seeing you as a true leader.

How do we respond to actually become a leader, to guard our own hearts, and to direct this person towards results?

Given the chance, many people will sit and drone on to you for hours about their negative thought patterns and their deepest insecurities. Again, this can be a good thing because these people have sometimes never had someone listen to them in their lives.

People need to vent, and maybe they never had someone who would give them the time

to listen. Theres likely something about you that they trust, but in this case, given the chance they will probably talk for long time.

You are of course helping them by listening, the problem is they are using you as an emotional pillow.

This can help someone, but it has limits in terms of productivity. There's **listening** and then there's
guiding, forming solutions and directing them in a way where they trust you know where you are going.

We want to guide without sounding judgy, preaching hard, or steering the conversation in a direction that is just too negative.

This takes a lot of finesse.

For example, let's say you have a younger sister who says she wants to change. She is showing change talk.

She has great opportunities in a big city, and many chances at a good degree paid for by the government. She is into modelling but feels ugly sometimes.

The opportunities are there. But she parties and has a lot of limiting beliefs about her looks.

You might feel so angry! You won two modelling competitions when you were younger! You have what it takes to go all the way! You live in one of the biggest cities in the world.

Even if you know their limiting beliefs are total nonsense, to them its real. You getting angry and telling them “you shouldn’t feel this way.” “You have so much opportunity why don’t you see it?” doesn’t help.

Trying to convince someone not to feel the negative way that they feel can come across as preaching, you can say a few kind words about how you feel it may not be true, but if you show visible frustration that person will withdraw as they will feel they made you disappointed and get defensive.

I’ve found you lose energy yourself this way as well, because you feel like the angry preacher, that is going around repeating yourself.

The flow of the conversation simply never goes good when you get angry, or focus too much on the negative sustain talk. I've fallen into that trap so many times.

I have found that
15–45 minutes of focused listening is usually sustainable for helping someone through an issue.

Longer is fine *occasionally*, but not as a regular pattern.

There also needs to be a give and take. If they just vent and you absorb, it becomes one sided. A person needs to meet you half way.

You decide whether you are the kind of person who they vent to for hours, or if you

are the type of person who is listening to them under the condition that they allow you to coach and reach a solution as well as vent.

You don't have to explicitly say this to a person, but it is more from how you direct the conversation.

I myself draw the line if someone would want to vent to me for hours, but not be willing to at least hear my input and advice on how to form a solution. This balance really feels fair and works well for me.

I am going to give you some practical ways to steer the conversation towards a healthy exchange.

Focus On The Change Talk, Not The Sustain

Choosing to tell a person to focus on the change talk, saying: “it’s really cool that you wish to change in this way, and I think you should focus on that!” always directs the conversation back towards positivity and respect.

As a coaching figure in their life and not necessarily a professional therapist, it can sometimes be a better use of your time and effort to redirect towards the positive.

This technique actually helps with your own mental health too and allows you to find a balance point.

You yourself will get tired of going around in circles with someone, feeling like a “nagging” figure in their life, getting frustrated focusing on negative issues when someone simply “just doesn’t get it.”

You also don’t want to be sitting there for hours simply discussing negatives with no solutions. Let a person vent but don’t challenge what you don’t like about their response. It always leads to defensiveness if you challenge too much. Instead focus on what you do like, and lead them in that direction.

You will find that this opens up more positive conversations.

Frustration Is Rarely The Answer

Getting frustrated at a persons lack of progress rarely fixes things.

Don't get frustrated as the person goes around in circles even if you want to. Let's take two replies to a person who is displaying limiting beliefs.

"I want to make a positive change to my fitness and life, I have been doing some home workouts.

Honestly I don't like going to the gym because I feel like people will look at me and I feel like they will judge me and I have that face that scares people away. I don't feel safe leaving the house because I have anxiety.

I feel ugly. So I just stay at home."

This is quite a deep issue with a lot to unpack. Some people will tell you things like this and then also tell you multiple other issues and feelings stacked on top of it. Don't let it knock you. Let's look at the example of Reply 1 below, which is the example of a bad reply.

Reply 1:

What do you mean you don't like going to the gym and you don't like leaving the house! You live in the safest area possible! How can you say you're not motivated to leave your house!

You have all the money that others don't have and a good life! If only you could see your position!

And what do you mean you don’t want to leave the house because you feel like you have a face that people find ugly! You literally look like a model! You need to get a grip, don't think that way!”

And now an example of a better reply:

Reply 2:

Listen, some of what you just said, I can talk all day about why they are not true, or why they don’t serve you, but let's not take hours trying to convince you not to think a certain way.

Instead, let's focus on the solution of you wanting to change, and let's implement some new stuff to help you get there, and I will support you. You will be great at the gym, and I think it’s a great idea.

Those are two totally different conversations. The second one is more often than not what works.

You could then get that person to commit to first going to the gym at least once per week, or ask if they would be open to talk to you or someone without judgement so you could help them see the reality of their limiting belief of being ugly.

In conclusion, it is very valuable to learn a healthy balance if you are the type of person who likes to help others. This can allow you to feel like you are fulfilling that feeling of helping without ever feeling guilty or like you are losing your quality of life.

You get the feeling of fulfillment without any guilt, and have clear rules about where you stand and your limits. This is a great achievement for your mental health.

To find the balance of helping people in need, I try to focus on quick, actionable advice where I focus on the positives of what people want to do and not the negative talk they are telling me.

I give people time but try to do it in short productive sessions. I help people that are

close to me, who trust me and are showing change talk, and if I have the time.

I wouldn’t let someone vent for hours on a regular basis, and try not to get angry at them for the circles they go around in and the promises they don’t keep. As soon as you feel anger, it's a sign that you are over reaching.

It's usually a sign that you’ve focused too much on the negative of the situation and allowed it to drag you down.

Perhaps you've gone on for too long trying to persuade someone on the small things, the negativities, the doubts, the worries, the pain, and that has dragged your emotional state down, instead of worrying about the

productive solutions and the great changes they could make.

As soon as you feel the emotions of anger and stress, it's a sign to spend some time on yourself.

In my first book I set some non negotiables. If you are consistently not taking 10 minutes out of your day to write a gratitude journal, go to the gym, meditate, read a book, and stick to your diet, then it is a sign to take more time for yourself.

You should be ticking off your bucket list targets, financially doing ok for yourself, living a life you consider good, then you can designate more time for others!

Build in a way that sustains you, not depletes you!

End Of Coaching Book - Final Thoughts

I hope this book allows you to be confident in guiding others and allows you to unlock the champion within someone.

I hope you can be a more confident and inspiring person to your family, friends, elderly family members and to young people around you.

People really look up to motivational coaches and those that are able to motivate others in everyday life.

You will start to live a very interesting life of helping people, and your life will tend to be surrounded with people who look up to you.

It is a rewarding life to live.

You can do it! As long as you practice what you preach, people will eventually listen. So keep working on yourself too.

The only thing that is left to do is to keep learning. Learn how to improve all elements of your life so you can pass the information onto others and take joy in helping them.

Your life will attract positive circumstances and many people will be drawn to you.

Watch other motivational people and teachers, take from them the techniques that you like, and follow the next section of this

book for a recommended reading list of how to improve all areas of your life further.

Build your knowledge and pass it on! Always be improving and striving for greatness!

I hope the information in this book has helped you to feel more educated and given you the pathway to unlocking your true potential when it comes to your mentality.

If you feel like you need further help with your fitness programming, your nutrition, or you are in need of further life coaching, please reach out to me on Instagram at @achievegreatnesstraining with any questions.

Based on my availability I offer slots to work one to one with people around the world to help them achieve their best.

I am once again proud of you for making it this far and taking the decision to read this series of books. I wrote these books to inspire all people around the world to achieve greatness in sports and in their dreams.

I always say these books will appeal to a certain type of person, you are special for reading this and have something deeper inside of you for finishing this book series to the end.

I want to stress the importance of making your fitness and mindset journey an adventure that you enjoy, make sure to keep doing a variety of workouts, follow your dreams, discover your purpose and always try to achieve the best you can.

You can get in shape, look after yourself, and inspire others, from any humble beginning. I have given you the tools to do so.

There are few things better than a life of great emotional and physical health, and a positive mentality, waking up in the morning with a sense of peace and a drive to achieve your wildest dreams.

I want you to imagine your life heading in this direction and the joy you will feel daily as you live life at a higher level.

Full of belief, equipped with the tools from this short series, you are ready to achieve greatness in all of its forms.

Thanks for being with me over the course of these books, I am always here to help you. I am proud that you read all that I taught you.

Small healthy steps today lead to giant leaps of success tomorrow. Go out and slowly but surely achieve mastery in the various areas we have covered in these books, to live your best life.

Go out and achieve your everything.

- Coach Tommy

Chapter 3: Aligning Yourself To A Higher Level

Recommended Reading

I want you to go out and start reading self improvement books. Each one will improve your mindset in order to Achieve Greatness.

The journey of learning never stops. Please do not skip this section, and read everyday.

People have a negative mindset about these books, saying that “they never work.”

But self help books are far from a waste of time. You can learn so much and become a very well rounded person when you read this style of book.

The books below helped me to better advise myself and others on topics such as relationships, finances, health and mental issues, & public speaking.

They helped me to ace job interviews, and to make more money, and to help countless others to improve their lives.

To become the most complete person we can be, it is great to have knowledge on more than just fitness & nutrition.

Living a complete life requires a balance of knowledge in all areas. You want to be happy, successful and confident in many of the below areas of your life to have the best life possible.

You can learn a lot from these books such as:

- Knowing how to apply mental health techniques to your life written by qualified therapists
- Techniques to save money by financial advisors.
- Techniques to start your own business and make extra money.
- Techniques to have healthy relationships by qualified experts and marriage councillors.
- Techniques to improve your public speaking by those who have done it thousands of times before.
- Techniques to excel at job interviews, sales, and leadership

I myself don't consider myself beyond such information and I urge you not to consider yourself beyond it either!

I notice a lot the people who consider themselves "beyond" this type of book seem to be negative people on average who stay in the same place in life.

I want you to keep an open mind and keep improving daily in many areas of your life.

I have compiled the below books to help you to improve your life further.

Finance and Business -

Mastering Yourself - Corey Wayne (Finding your Purpose and Career)

The Intelligent Investor - Benjamin Graham (Making Money)
Random Walk Down Wall Street - Burton G. Malkiel (Saving Money)
Millionaire Fast Lane - MJ DeMarco
Rich Dad Poor Dad - Robert Kiyosaki
The Total Money Makeover - Dave Ramsey
4 Hour Work Week - Tim Ferriss
The Laws of Success - Napoleon Hill
What you do is who you are - Ben Horowitz (Building a business)
Win Bigly - Scott Adams (Persuading People)
Simple Path To Wealth - J.L Collins
Richest Man In Babylon - George Clayson
Set For Life - Scott Trench
Personal Finance for Dummies
DotComSecrets - Russel Brunson
Expert Secrets - Russel Brunson
The E-Myth Revisited - Michael E Gerber
Influence - Robert Cialdini

How to Get Rich - Felix Dennis
$100m Offers - Alex Hormuz
Principles - Ray Dalio
The Psychology of Money - Morgan House
Money Master The Game - Tony Robbins

Mindset **-**

How To Win Friends and Influence People - Dale Carnegie
Awaken The Giant Within - Tony Robbins
Discipline Equals Freedom - Jocko Willink (Improve your discipline)
Way Of The Superior Man - David Deida
The War of Art - Steven Pressfield
Thinking Fast and Slow - Daniel Kahneman
Psycho-Cybernetics - Maxwell Maltz (Visualisation & Self Image)
The Slight Edge - Jeff Olson

Can’t Hurt Me - David Goggins
Never Finished - David Goggins
Mans Search For Meaning - Viktor Frankl
Laws of Human Nature - Robert Greene
Meditations - Marcus Aurelius
How To Think Like a Roman Emperor - Donald Robertson
The Way Of Men - Jack Donovan
The Four Agreements - Don Miguel (Positive Mindset, Self Forgiveness, Living Free From Painful Thoughts)

Health -

The Molecule of More - Daniel Z Lieberman
Atomic Habits - James Clear
Why We Sleep - Matthew Walker
Emotional Intelligence - Daniel Goleman
Deep Work - Cal Newport
Think Again - Adam Grant

Easy Way To Control Alcohol - Alan Carr
The Worlds Fittest Book - Ross Edgily
Become A Supple Leopard - Kelly Start
Encyclopaedia of Modern Bodybuilding - Arnold Schwarzenegger

Relationships -

How to make marriage work - John Gottman
Attached - Amir Levine

Sales -

How I Raised Myself From Failure To Success In Selling - Frank Bettger
Influence The Art Of Persuasion - Robert Caldini
The Way Of The Wolf - Jordan Belfort

Public Speaking -

Talk Like Ted - Carmine Gallo (Giving Good Presentations & Body Language For Public Speaking)

Depression -

The Subtle Art Of Not Giving A F* - Mark Manson

Anxiety -

Dare: The New Way to End Anxiety and Stop Panic Attacks - Barry McDonough

PTSD -

Route 91: Healing from Mass Violence and Trauma by Dr. Shiva Ghaed

Meditation -

Eckhardt Tolle - The Power Of Now
Mindfulness In Plain English - Bhante Gunaratana

Chapter 4: Some Quotes to Keep You Motivated

1. "It always seems impossible until it’s done." – Nelson Mandela

When you're facing challenges, it can feel like you’ll never get through them. But once you reach the other side, you’ll realize that what felt impossible was within your grasp all along.

2. "The struggle you're in today is developing the strength you need for tomorrow." – Robert Tew

Every challenge you face today is building the resilience, wisdom, and strength that will serve you in the future. Remember, it's all part of your growth.

3. "Hardships often prepare ordinary people for an extraordinary destiny." – C.S. Lewis

When you're in the midst of struggle, it's hard to see the bigger picture. But often, it's through our toughest challenges that we grow the most. Your hardships today are shaping you into the person you are meant to become.

4. "The pain you feel today is the strength you feel tomorrow." – Unknown

In moments of struggle, it's easy to feel defeated. But remember that every ounce of pain you endure today is helping to build the strength and resilience you'll carry with you tomorrow.

5. "Success is the sum of small efforts, repeated day in and day out." – Robert Collier

Big achievements don’t happen overnight. Success is the result of consistent, daily effort. Keep putting in the work, even when progress feels slow.

6. "You can’t go back and change the beginning, but you can start where you are and change the ending." – C.S. Lewis

The past is behind you, and you can’t change it. But what matters is what you do today. Every choice you make from this moment forward can shape a better future.

7. "Our greatest weakness lies in giving up. The most certain way to succeed is always to try just one more time." – Thomas Edison

Persistence is key. Even when things seem impossible, success often comes just after the moment you felt like giving up. Keep going.

8. “We’re going to wake up this morning and smash it.” - Coach Tommy

Use this affirmation every morning when you think it's going to be a hard day to put yourself in a winners mood.

9. "Fall seven times, stand up eight." – Japanese Proverb

Resilience is about getting back up every time life knocks you down. No matter how many times you stumble, what matters is your determination to rise again.

10. "When you arise in the morning, think of what a precious privilege it is to be alive—to breathe, to think, to enjoy, to love." – Marcus Aurelius

Each day is a gift, and recognizing the simple joys of life can help you maintain a positive outlook, no matter the challenges.

11. "Sometimes the bravest and most important thing you can do is just show up." – Brené Brown

Simply showing up—whether in life, work, or relationships—is a powerful act of courage. Don’t underestimate the value of persistence.

12. "You miss 100% of the shots you don't take." – Wayne Gretzky

Don’t be afraid to take risks and go after what you want. Failing to try is the only guarantee of failure. Take the shot.

13. "You may encounter many defeats, but you must not be defeated." – Maya Angelou
Defeat is a part of life, but it doesn't have to define you. What defines you is your refusal to give up in the face of those defeats.

14. "The only way to do great work is to love what you do." – Steve Jobs

Passion is the key to excellence. When you love what you do, it ceases to feel like work and becomes your purpose.

15. "Don’t count the days, make the days count." – Muhammad Ali

Every day holds potential. Instead of just letting time pass by, fill each moment with purpose.

16. "We generate fears while we sit. We overcome them by action." – Dr. Henry Link

Fear thrives in inaction. The moment you take that first step, fear starts to dissolve.

17. "Your mind is a powerful thing. When you fill it with positive thoughts, your life will start to change." – Unknown

Your thoughts shape your reality. Focusing on the positive attracts positivity into your life.

18. "Perseverance is failing 19 times and succeeding the 20th." – Julie Andrews
Success is often found just after multiple failures. Keep going, even when it seems impossible.

19. "The harder the struggle, the more glorious the triumph." – Unknown
The greater the difficulty, the sweeter the success that follows. Hard work pays off in ways you can't imagine.

20. "Never confuse a single defeat with a final defeat." – F. Scott Fitzgerald

Losing one battle doesn't mean the war is over. Each defeat is just part of the journey to ultimate victory.

21. "Patience, persistence, and perspiration make an unbeatable combination for success." – Napoleon Hill

Success comes from a mixture of patience, relentless effort, and hard work

22. "Don’t be discouraged. It’s often the last key in the bunch that opens the lock." – Unknown

Even if you’ve tried multiple times, the next effort could be the one that brings success.

Achieve Greatness Mindset

1.Working Out Regularly

2.Accepts Negative Emotions but always from an angle of “This Is What I’m Going To Do About It”

3.Always Chasing Happiness
4.Be Unbreakably Positive

5.Does Not Subscribe To The Viewpoint That Life Isn't Fair

6.Will Rise To A Challenge And Take On Anyone

7.Not Displaying Vengefulness

8.Thick Skin - Not Letting Anything Annoy You Even The Most Annoying Things

9.Never Displaying Fear or Nervousness - Fake It Until You Make It

10. Not Staying In Jobs You Hate - Study Something You Want That Will Make You A Lot Of Money

11. Going For What You Want Even If It Doesn't Work Out

12. Never Timid, Never Shy. Good Loud Clear Communication Voice

13. Happy, Upbeat, Excited About Life and Dreams

14. Excited About Job and Wants To Be The Best

15. Sets Boundaries

16. Helps Others

17. Takes Complaints As Feedback

18. Stays Away From Drugs

19. Gets Home And Talks About The Good In The Day Not The Bad

20. Puts in 200% to all areas of life

Final Thoughts: How To Find The Balance

In today's world, it is important to find a balance in your life. You will see that my work ranges from encouraging writing love letters to yourself, to more harsh and realistic explanations that there should be a limit on how much we sit and complain or we wouldn't be able to succeed!

The balance is not going too easy or too hard on ourselves.

I believe that the world rewards positive people who work hard, follow there dreams and who practice grit and determination over complaining. That much is true.

However, I am also the type to take time off work when I feel stressed, who takes 10 minutes early to practice my meditation every morning, who won't go in to work until I do my stretching and relaxation exercises A thought that just came to me as I finish this book is that, in today's world, you are fighting against extreme opinions when it comes to all of this stuff.

We have people who make it seem like we should all be working 60 hours and running ultra marathons after to "stay hard."

But then we have people saying that everyone deserves a medal for trying, or that kids who can't concentrate have ADHD, it isn't their fault, and they should just take medication and "it can't be fixed" giving

them an excuse to not try,instead of accountability and solution based work.

Instead of labelling a lot of people as broken, giving them a get out of jail free card, giving them an “out” from having to improve, we can encourage hard work on their part towards a solution.

We can encourage responsible change and solution based work over saying there is nothing to be done.

It is great that we now have these safe spaces where people can feel supported and come together.

As long as they are used to promote self responsibility, hard work and positive values, as well as the new great scientific research in

finding solutions instead of promoting limiting beliefs or bad attitudes.

This is how we can help people to really achieve their full potential.

I think in the next few years, we will all be able to come together and make amazing changes and achieve great things as a wordly collective.

And that's the values I stand for at AG Training.

There's nothing wrong with pushing yourself or working hard. We need to create healthy balanced versions of ourselves to do well and achieve our best. Finding that balance helps us achieve.

The people that life tends to reward are those who seek happiness and their dreams, who work hard, usually a little or a lot harder than their comfort zone, in a way that brings them the pride of a hard days work, but not burnout or lack of sleep.

They don't listen to extreme opinions, they balance their hard work with positive habits and look after their minds too.

This may not be the most politically correct section of my book but my life experiences dictate that I do think the average person could definitely strive to be slightly "less of a wimp" than they currently are and probably work 25-50% harder than they currently are!

But also many people should practice self care in the right ways 25 - 50% more! It's

important to be healthy! Get good sleep, have positive hobbies, schedule a rest day and recover well.

A balance to strive for often looks like this:

Many days a week you go to bed feeling proud that you did a hard days work and pushed your comfort zone, busy ticking off the items on your to do list that bring you closer to your dreams. Those kind of days are awesome.

But getting good sleep, having a recovery day once a week or month that you don't feel bad about, your body and mind will tell you the frequency that you need these.

If you are truly working at your dreams, you may not need too many, but they are important.

A day in solitude or a day seeing the family is important. A holiday here and there if you feel burnout coming. And holidays don't have to be party holidays or sitting at home eating Twinkies! They can be active holidays too where you do things that keep you fit, active and happy.

Gym rest days are important too: but you don't need to stay in bed all day eating a "cheat meal." You can take active rest, go on short walks, still eat healthy and be slightly active. It's all your choice.

Sleep is important because without it the quality of your work and your mood will suffer.

Holidays are important and rest days too, but they don't need to cause you to fall off.

Family days are important. Days in solitude can really help if you have stuff you need to work through.

To be a high achiever we should be living our days ticking off many items from our lists that help us work towards our dreams, feeling the proud feeling of a hard days work.

But we need to have a life too.

Finding this balance requires maturity and discipline and a bit of common sense.

It’s your responsibility to master this area. Become one of the 10% who actually find a balance in this, and you will achieve a life where you tend not to overthink, and where you simply accomplish your potential every day.

You will have good values and live your life by a balanced code and system, and things will go well for you. Be responsible and get this balance sorted. Don’t go too easy or too hard, be mature, be a high achiever and recover well.

Final Thoughts: You Are Capable Of Greatness

The fact that you read a small niche book called Achieve Greatness says a lot about you, keep going on your journey. Keep on stepping forward into your best self. I hope you connect with some of my principles and use them to improve yourself and most of all enjoy a great life where you reach your potential, where every day is a moment lived to the fullest.

In this series of books you have mastered 3 areas that a small percentage of people truly master.

I hope you use some of my strategies to increase the feeling of achievement within your own life.

You've become a 10% type of person. An achiever of greatness. Or at the very least

you have started on that path of considering what that means and how you can go about achieving your best life, legacy and building the skills to do so. It's a journey worth taking. Thank you for being someone who wants more from life.

Keep in touch. I'd love to hear about your wins. You're going to look back one day and love the journey that you see. Remember, you've always got a coach in your corner.

Until then, with the infinite potential you have, I pass the torch to you. Step up, achieve greatness in the things you love, build your self improvement skills and the skills necessary to live a full life full of passion!

The world is waiting for more people like you to step up and try their best, to practice their gifts and learn how to become positive.

You can become a torch to the whole society in which you live, achieving your best.

Remember the 3 pillars in my books - fitness, healthy nutrition and a positive mindset. With these 3 pillars in place it will feel like There is no mountain too high for you to climb.

I want you to feel that feeling. Alongside the feeling of living a full life and achieving your best in that pursuit, equipping yourself with the mindset that will allow you to do so.

And as you build your mindset, self improvement skills and start to think about how you can best achieve greatness in all your own unique skills and talents, as well as simply building the skills with the intention to live your fullest and happiest life possible, everything else will fall into place.

And you will lead the world and those around you in a positive direction.

This is the values I wanted to promote with AG training.

Step up, work hard, live with passion, chase that happy little feeling of achieving your best in areas that make you happy and healthy. Areas that will allow you to live a full life.

I salute you for becoming a person who supports the values of self improvement and look forward to seeing how you achieve greatness in your passions, health and fitness.

With an attitude of achieving great things in positive areas, everything will fall into place, and you will become a force for good in every life you touch. The world is waiting for the great things you achieve next.

How do we achieve those great things? Simply by intentionally trying. Too many people won't take the path of trying to achieve great things, this attitude gets lost in the buzz of day to day life. But as soon as you make the conscious effort to do so, being that little bit more intentional about what you pursue in life, the great things will come to you.

Be one of the few and far between who have this attitude. The attitude to achieve greatness.

To achieve greatness In fitness, nutrition, in positive mindset, in areas across the world where these topics have a complaint culture and real world issues relating to them. Such as obesity statistics, poor mental health, poor viewpoints of the world.

People doing drugs and watching negative stories on the news with no hope. Young

people believing their background defines them.

Believe you will achieve greatness In any area that you know will bring you a happy life, no matter who tells you that you can't. No matter what the common consensus from the most popular people around you is.

This attitude to achieve greatness is a gift. With it may your world open up, and may your future grow bright. **May you never stop reaching for the best version of yourself.**

Through this book series we have encouraged you to build the habit of achieving greatness in fitness, nutrition and your positive mindset. As well as achieving greatness in the areas that contribute to you living the fullest and happiest life you can.

We touched on relationships, focus, limiting beliefs, and much more. It's not just about earning an Olympic medal or becoming a basketball pro, but for you to achieve greatness in the areas that matter to you when it comes to building a great life.

Your passions, finances, health, talents and gifts. Areas that society or influences around you may sometimes persuade you not to, but that you deep down think you should.

I am proud of you for having the courage to read this book and to learn about ways to achieve greatness in your life.

I thank you warmly for allowing me to be your coach. I salute you for choosing to take ownership of your journey and become all that you are capable of being.

Now go and give the world your best. The power of a positive mindset is yours. And the world is waiting to see what you do with it. You have read these words and understood the ideas and concepts behind achieving great things. In your fitness, nutrition, and mindset. We have even considered how you can change and shape the world with your positive attitude.

Whenever you run into issues you will know how to carry yourself, how to think highly of yourself, and how to chase your dreams whilst loving yourself.

I can't wait to see what you will become as you step out to achieve greatness in everything you do.

“The only person you are destined to become is the person you decide to be.” ~ Ralph Waldo Emerson

“Go confidently in the direction of your dreams.” ~ Henry David Thoreau

“Small disciplines repeated with consistency every day lead to great achievements gained slowly over time.” ~ John C. Maxwell

Achievegreatness.co.uk

TRAINING SYSTEM

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